

Feast Ranking in the Sehling Church Orders

This guide covers how the evangelical church orders of the sixteenth century, as printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts*, ranked their feast days. It asks five questions:

- Which days did the orders keep?
- Which days did they rank above others, and how many ranks did they draw?
- How was each rank kept: as a whole holy day or a half one, and with which sermons, chants and ceremonies?
- What happened to the medieval grades of feasts (*summum, duplex, semiduplex, simplex*)?
- What happened to the medieval rules for octaves, vigils and the transfer of feasts?

The findings are summarised in §1, and the method is described in §2. The body of the guide (§§3–12) sets out the evidence by topic. Each topic is supported by quotations in the original language (Early New High German, Low German or Latin), each followed by an English translation. §13 is a concordance of every order quoted.

Conventions

- **Quotations.** Every quotation is Sehling's text as it stands in the [eko.db](#) database built from the digitized edition.
 - Footnote numbers, sigla, folio markers, the editor's dates in square brackets (such as "[25. Dez.]") and interleaved apparatus are left out.
 - Sehling's own supplied letters in square brackets are kept, as are "[!]" and his other signs.
 - Spelling and punctuation are as printed. A few plain OCR errors are corrected silently (for example "Mariae" for the printed "Marfae").
 - "[...]" marks an omission.
 - Every quotation has been checked against the database text, allowing for OCR noise: at least 90 per cent of its words must be found there in order. Its page has been checked against the edition's page markers.
 - Each quotation is preceded by an HTML comment, invisible when rendered, that names the [eko.db](#) document it was checked against.
- **Translations.** The English is formal-equivalence, in the idiom of the Authorized Version:
 - Word order and clause structure are kept where English allows.
 - Stock terms are rendered the same way throughout. *Fest* is "feast". *Feiertag, vyrdach* is "holy day". *feiern, vyren* is "keep holy (day)". *hohe Feste* are "high feasts". *Hauptfeste* are "chief feasts". *fürnembste Feste* are "chiefest feasts". *gemeine Feste* are "common feasts". *Aposteltage* are "apostles' days". *Vierzeiten, veer tide* are "the four times". *Amt, ampt* is "the office" (the communion service). *verlegen* is "remove" or "lay over". *Historie* is "history".
 - Words the translation supplies are in square brackets.
- **Citations.** Citations are in the form "Sehling volume, page".
 - The half-volumes of the edition are written 6/1, 6/2, 7/1, 7/2.1, 7/2.2, 17/1, 17/2, 19/1, 19/2, 20/1 and 20/2, following the digitized volumes.
 - Each order is named by place, title and date as they appear in Sehling's running heads. These sometimes differ from the database's record headings (see §2.3).

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1. Summary of findings

1.1 The main findings

1. The medieval grades did not survive as grades of feasts.

- No order ranks a feast as *duplex*, *semiduplex* or *simplex*, and none has a system of Office grades (§3.1).
- The old vocabulary survives in fragments:
 - *summum* and *minus summum* as names of Kyrie melodies (Pomerania 1542, Buxtehude 1565, Nördlingen 1544, Hof 1592);
 - *summa festa* as a name for the highest feasts (Hadersleben 1528, Tangermünde 1603, Gottorf 1587);
 - the ferial, dominical and festal forms of the Office in chapters and convents;
 - the adverbs *ferialiter*, *festive* and *solemniter*;
 - *per anticipationem* for moving a feast forward (§§3.2–3.6, 11.2).
- Octaves have gone; the "following days" of the high feasts take their place (§7). So have vigil fasts; first vespers on the eve take their place (§3.6).

2. The ranking is theological. The orders rank feasts by what they commemorate:

- the feasts of Christ, and above all his birth, resurrection and the sending of the Spirit;
- then the days whose "history is written in the Gospel": the Purification, the Annunciation, John the Baptist, the Visitation;
- then the apostles, kept for their example;
- then nothing, for feasts that rest on legend (Corpus Christi, the Holy Cross, the Conception, Nativity and Assumption of Mary).

The formula "nicht umme der dage willen, sonder umme der historien willen" (Bugenhagen, §4.3) states the test. Luther's *Formula missae* of 1523 gives its first form (§4.1).

3. The rank is kept by civil and ceremonial means. Most orders do not tell the ranks apart by the liturgical form of the service. They do so by:

- whether work is forbidden all day, until noon, only during the sermon, or not at all (§6);

- how many sermons are preached (§6.3);
- how many days the feast lasts (§7);
- a set of ceremonial marks (§10): Latin chant, the grade of the Kyrie, proper prefaces, sequences, figural music and organ, vestments and elevation, bells, the Athanasian Creed, communion, and bans on weddings, markets and guild feasts.

4. The usual scale has three ranks below Sunday (§5.1):

- the high or chief feasts of Christ;
- a second rank of other Gospel feasts (John the Baptist, the Visitation, Michaelmas, and often Purification and Annunciation);
- the apostles' days as half holy days.

Some orders draw two ranks only (Luther, Homberg, and in effect the Reformed orders of §12). Others number three classes (Grubenhagen 1544, Regensburg 1567, Hoya 1571, Harlingerland 1573/74). Sayn 1582 has four, the fourth being the abolished feasts (§5.5). Danzig and Thorn speak of "great" and "small" feasts (§5.6).

5. The families of orders follow their models.

- **Saxon and Mecklenburg family** (§5.2). Saxony 1539 and Mecklenburg 1552 set the pattern: "hohe heubtfest des herrn Christi" first, then "uber diese furnemsten fest" the apostles, John, Visitation and Michaelmas, kept in the forenoon. It was taken up across the north and in Pfalz-Zweibrücken.
- **Württemberg family** (§5.3). Holy days are proclaimed by the magistrate. At first there is one list, later divided into whole days and forenoon days.
- **Bugenhagen family** (§5.4). "The three great feasts of Christ" are kept three full days each. The other Gospel feasts are also kept fully. The apostles are moved to the next Sunday.

6. Whole and half holy days (§6). From the 1560s the orders of the Harz, Hesse, the Rhine and the Main set out day-by-day tables of whole and half days: Mansfeld 1580, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1561, Landau 1562, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Ysenburg 1582, Nassau-Weilburg 1609 and 1618, Solms 1603. Harvest, markets and craftsmen's work pushed the summer feasts down to half days or onto Sundays. The Transylvanian synod of 1578 has the technical term: the apostles' days are kept *intercise*, "by halves" (§6.4).

7. The middle rank is where the orders differ most (§8).

- **Michaelmas**. It rose to be one of the four chief feasts in the north, in place of the Assumption (§8.5, §9).
- **The Assumption**. It was abolished in most orders. In Franconia and Tecklenburg it was kept "for the working country-folk" but preached as the Visitation (§8.3).
- **The Visitation**. It was moved to 15 August in the Nürnberg family (§6.4).
- **Purification and Annunciation**. Everywhere they are treated as feasts of Christ, but their rank ranges from whole holy day to half day (§8.1).

8. The *Vierzeiten* (§9). In north Germany the top rank had a fiscal name: the four feasts (Christmas, Easter, Whitsuntide and Michaelmas, formerly the Assumption) on which the "four-times penny" was paid. The payment made the rank, and the rank carried liturgical marks:

- a sermon at first vespers (Wolfenbüttel 1543);
- a Latin Mass (Hoya 1571);
- proper prefaces (Lippe 1571).

9. Occurrence and transfer (§11). The orders keep simple rules of precedence:

- A feast of Christ on a Sunday displaces the Sunday Gospel; an apostle's day yields to it.
- An apostle's day on a Saturday goes to the Sunday.
- The Annunciation in Holy Week is moved in at least six different ways.

Some orders forbid pastors to move feasts on their own authority.

10. The minimum (§12). The Upper German cities (Mülhausen 1529, Augsburg 1537, Esslingen 1537, Strasbourg 1544) and the Reformed territories (Kurpfalz 1563, Nassau-Dillenburg 1582, Anhalt 1599) kept only Sunday and a few feasts of Christ, which reduced the ranking to Luther's two ranks. Esslingen's return to the apostles' days after the "blue Mondays" of 1537 shows how unstable that minimum was.

1.2 What became of the medieval categories

Medieval category	In the evangelical orders	§
<i>duplex, semiduplex, simplex, totum duplex</i>	not found as grades of feasts	3.1
<i>summum, minus summum, paschale, dominicale, angelicum, apostolicum, feriale</i> (Kyrie and Gloria melodies)	kept as chant grades in some orders; <i>summa festa</i> as the name of the top rank	3.2, 10.2
<i>festum fori / festum chori</i>	replaced by whole and half holy days, and by days kept "without a commanded holy day"	5.2, 6
nine lessons and three lessons	three-lesson matins the norm; nine lessons in some chapters; three lessons for high feasts in villages	3.3
proper and common of saints	proper Office for high feasts; <i>commune sanctorum</i> for saints' days in convents	3.4
octaves	not kept; forbidden for saints (Ansbach 1533); St Stephen's octave abolished (Mülhausen 1524); replaced by the two or three "following days"	3.4, 7, 12
vigils	fasts abolished; first vespers on the eve, with confession, and on higher feasts a sermon	3.6
occurrence and transfer	simplified rules of precedence and transfer, including <i>per anticipationem</i>	11
patronal and local feasts	abolished, turned into thanksgivings, or kept with a sermon (Wied 1564)	3.5, 8.9

1.3 Terms of rank used in the orders

Term	Meaning in the orders	Examples (§)
<i>hohe Feste, hohe heubtfest des herrn Christi, Hauptfeste</i>	the highest rank: the feasts of Christ, or the three or four great feasts	Saxony 1539, Mecklenburg 1552 (5.2); Henneberg 1582 (6.3)

Term	Meaning in the orders	Examples (§)
<i>de dre groten feste Christi</i>	Christmas, Easter, Whitsuntide	Braunschweig 1528, Schleswig-Holstein 1542 (5.4)
<i>vier Zeiten, veer tide, vier hochzeitliche feste, Vierzeitenfest</i>	the four chief feasts on which the four-times penny was paid	Lübeck 1531, Waldeck 1525, Hoya 1571 (9)
<i>summa festa, summae festivitates, in summis festis</i>	the highest feasts	Hadersleben 1528, Tangermünde 1603, Gottorf 1587 (3.2)
<i>fürnembste, furnemliche, vornemlichste Feste</i>	the chiefest feasts (often the whole list of holy days)	Mecklenburg 1552 (5.2), Württemberg 1553 (4.5), Northeim 1539 (4.5)
<i>andere herliche fest</i>	the second rank	Grubenhagen 1544 (5.5)
<i>mittelmeßige festa</i>	middle feasts, kept as half days	Sayn 1582 (5.5)
<i>gemeine Feste, gemeine Feiertage</i>	common feasts: the lower ranks	Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1561 (6.2), Henneberg 1582 (6.3)
<i>große and kleine Feste, kleine oder halbe feste</i>	great and small feasts	Danzig 1612, Thorn 1575 (5.6)
<i>ganz, halb gefeiert; bis Mittag; vormittag; bis die Sermon geendet</i>	whole and half holy days	6
<i>ohne gebotene Feier</i>	declared, but without commanded rest	Merseburg 1544 (5.2)
<i>ungefeiret in gedechtnus</i>	remembered, but not kept holy	Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (5.7)
<i>solenniter, festive, festivaliter</i>	in solemn, festal manner	Schwarzburg 1587 (7.1), Leisnig 1529 (3.5), Pomerania 1569 (10.2)
<i>ferialiter</i>	(a) in the weekday form, without <i>Gloria</i> ; (b) as a holiday	Anhalt 1551, 1568; Wied 1564 (3.5)
<i>intercise, dimidiatim</i>	by halves	Mediasch 1578 (6.4)
<i>per anticipationem</i>	moved back before its date	Wintzingerode (11.2)
<i>de tempore, de festo, commune sanctorum</i>	the proper of the season or feast; the common of saints	Mecklenburg 1552 (5.2), Crevese 1541 (3.4)

2. Scope, sources and method

2.1 The corpus

The corpus is Sehling's edition, volumes 1–24, as held in [eko.db](#). It has 2,350 document records in 30 digitized volumes and half-volumes, with Sehling's own subject registers linked to the pages. The edition prints church orders, agendas, visitation instructions and recesses, parish reports and council decrees. It also prints editorial

introductions and notes. This guide quotes only the sixteenth- and early seventeenth-century texts. The editors' notes are cited as such where they matter.

2.2 How the corpus was searched

Every document was scanned with regular expressions for four groups of terms. Matches were read in context, and then the full passages were pulled from the relevant orders.

- **Medieval grades and rubrical terms.**
 - *summun, duplex, semiduplex, simplex, totum duplex, triplex*, the abbreviations *dupl.* and *semidupl.*;
 - *festum fori, festum chori*;
 - *novem / tres lectiones*;
 - *classis, festivitas, solemnitatis*;
 - *festive, solenniter, ferialiter*;
 - *commune sanctorum, octava, vigilia*;
 - *per anticipationem, transferre*.
- **German and Low German terms of rank.**
 - *hohe, höchste, große* and *kleine Feste, Hauptfest, fürnembste Feste*;
 - *halbe* and *ganze Feiertage*, "bis Mittag", "vormittag";
 - *Aposteltage, Marienfeste*, the "third day";
 - *gebannte Feiertage, verlegen, verschieben*, and their Low German forms (*vyrdaye, hochtide, veer tide*).
- **Ceremonial markers.**
 - the *Vierzeiten* and the four-times penny;
 - the Kyrie grades (*summun, paschale, dominicale, angelicum, apostolicum, festivale, feriale, Fons bonitatis, Magnae Deus*) and the *Benedicamus* grades;
 - proper prefaces;
 - bells and chiming (*beiern*).
- **The names of the feasts themselves.** These were searched in lists and in rules for transfer.

Sehling's subject registers were also used: *Feiertage* (380 page references), *Festtage* and *Festtage/-Zeiten* (377), *Aposteltage* (135), *Feiertagsordnung* (77), *Vigilien* (95), *Marienfeste* (27).

2.3 Cautions

- **Record headings and dates in the database.** A database record often holds more than one order, and its year field can be wrong. In this guide every order is named from the running head of the page on which the quotation stands. Some examples:
 - The Henneberg record is dated 1555 in the database but holds texts from 1545 to 1582. The feast rules are in the *Kirchenordnung* of Georg Ernst of 1582.
 - The Danzig record contains the St Mary's order of 1567, the church fathers' compilation of 1612, and several Elbing and Thorn texts, among them the Thorn order of 1575.
 - A record among the East Frisian orders, dated 1593 in the database, holds on the pages quoted the Harlingerland order of 1573/74.
 - The Sayn record labelled "1314" holds the *Kirchenzuchtordnung* of 1582 and the *Kirchenordnung* of 1590.
 - The Mansfeld feast lists belong to the *Kirchen-agenda* of 1580.

- The Anhalt record holds orders from 1532 to 1572.
- **Editorial summaries and apparatus.** A few texts are quoted from the editors' apparatus, not the main text, and are marked as such:
 - Saxony 1539 is printed partly as a summary with quotations.
 - Variants: Nassau-Weilburg's *Agende* of 1618, Brenz's recension B, the German text B of the Burzenland articles, and the Latin report of the Mediasch synod.
- **Two-column prints.** Where the edition prints in two columns, the digitized text sometimes interleaves them. The Danzig list of 1612 and the Schwarzburg list of 1587 are examples. Quotations skip the interleaved matter and mark the gap with "[...]".
- **Silence.** When an order does not mention a feast, it is not always abolished. Many orders list only the days that are holy days. Days kept "ungefeiret in gedechtnus", in memory but without rest, often go unnamed.

3. The medieval grades and what became of them

The late-medieval rite ranked a feast in two ways. The first was its liturgical grade: *totum duplex*, *duplex*, *semiduplex* and *simplex*, with *summum* or *duplex maius* at the top in many diocesan uses. The second was its civil status: a *festum fori*, on which work was forbidden, or a *festum chori*, kept only in choir. The grade decided the Office: nine lessons or three, proper or common, first vespers, an octave, the colour and the ceremony. This section asks which of these terms and categories the evangelical orders kept.

3.1 *Duplex, semiduplex, simplex*: absent

No order in the corpus uses *duplex*, *semiduplex*, *simplex* or *totum duplex* as the grade of a feast. Every hit for these words is ordinary Latin. The Bohemian Brethren's order for Posen (1576) calls certain duties *duplicia*, and the Gottorf catechism (1571) teaches a *triplex usus legis*. Neither has anything to do with feasts. There are no abbreviations such as *dupl.* or *semidupl.* either. *Festum fori* occurs only in a modern editor's note (on Nürnberg 1522). The medieval scale of Office grades did not pass into the evangelical church orders.

3.2 *Summum* and *minus summum*: grades of the chant

Summum survives, but as the name of a melody, not of a feast. In the late-medieval Kyriale the Kyrie and Gloria were sung to melodies graded by rank:

- *summum* for the highest feasts, *minus summum* for lesser doubles;
- *paschale* for Eastertide, *dominicale* for Sundays;
- *angelicum*, *apostolicum*, *de martyribus*, *de confessoribus*, *de virginibus* for saints' days;
- *feriale* for weekdays.

A number of Lutheran orders keep this system, and with it keep grading the day.

Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 (Sehling 4, p. 356). The Kyrie at Mass:

Darup dat kyrie dominicale, efft me mach ock up die sondage, kyrie angelicum, de martiribus, effte confessoribus, efft virginibus, wo man sie genommet hefft singen, dominicale im advent und in der vasten, dat paschale tuschen pingsten und paschen, dat summum up die hohern fest, effte dat minus summum.

Thereupon the *Kyrie dominicale*; or one may also sing upon the Sundays the *Kyrie angelicum*, *de martyribus*, or *confessoribus*, or *virginibus*, as they have been named; the *dominicale* in Advent and in Lent, the *paschale* between Whitsuntide and Easter, the *summum* upon the higher feasts, or else the *minus summum*.

Note. This is the clearest statement in the corpus of the old Kyrie grades applied by rank. The saints' melodies are now simply alternatives for ordinary Sundays. The *summum* is kept for "the higher feasts" (*die hohern fest*), and *minus summum* is offered as a lesser alternative there.

Buxtehude, Agende, 1565 (Sehling 7/1, p. 123). These are the headings over the printed Kyrie melodies, which the editor traces to Lucas Lossius's *Psalmodia*:

In summis festivitibus et dominica Trinitatis cum textu. Minus summum. I. In festis beatae virginis Mariae. II. Kyrie paschale. Dominicale. In Adventu Domini. Angelicum Kyrie. Kyrie apostolicum. Dominicale.

On the highest festivities and on the Sunday of the Trinity, with the text. *Minus summum*. I. On the feasts of the blessed Virgin Mary. II. *Kyrie paschale*. *Dominicale*. In the Advent of the Lord. *Kyrie angelicum*. *Kyrie apostolicum*. *Dominicale*.

Hof, Ordo ecclesiasticus, 1592 (Sehling 11, p. 472). The Latin school Mass in the monastery church:

Mox II. ex missali magno canitur Kyrie certi temporis vel angelicum in Adventu Domini vel Kyrie Magnae Deus potentiae de Nativitate Christi, cui Et in terra angelicum subiicitur, vel Kyrie dominicale maius post dominicam Septuagesimae usque ad Pascha vel Kyrie paschale vel Kyrie Fons bonitatis cum Et in terra angelico vel Kyrie dominicale minus post festum Trinitatis vel de apostolis, martyribus etc., prout tempus requirit et libri ordo monstrat.

Straightway, secondly, is sung out of the great missal the Kyrie of the proper season: either the *angelicum* in the Advent of the Lord; or the Kyrie *Magnae Deus potentiae* of the Nativity of Christ, whereunto the *Et in terra angelicum* is joined; or the greater *dominicale* after the Sunday of Septuagesima until Easter; or the Kyrie *paschale*; or the Kyrie *Fons bonitatis* with the *Et in terra angelicum*; or the lesser *dominicale* after the feast of the Trinity; or that *de apostolis*, *de martyribus*, etc., as the time requireth and the order of the book sheweth.

Note. At Hof the melodies are chiefly seasonal. Its German *Kirchenamt* still names them by rank all the same:

- The same Kyrie is called *angelicum seu feriale* in Advent (p. 432).
- It is called *angelicum seu festivale* on St Laurence's day (p. 445) and on the feasts of Mary (p. 450).
- The *Benedicamus* at vespers is labelled *festivale*, *dominicale*, *paschale* or *feriale* (for example "Benedicamus festivale seu feriale", p. 422).

Nördlingen, Ordnung der ceremonien, 1544 (Sehling 12, pp. 321–322). This order reserves the *summum* for Pentecost and Trinity:

Zu Pfingsten. 1. Introitus de Spiritu oder Kom, hailiger Gaist. 2. Kyrie summum und Et in terra wie zu Ostern. [...] De sancta Trinitate. 1. Introitus de tempore. 2. Kyrie summum mit dem Et in terra. 3. Nach der epistel, den sequenz de tempore.

At Whitsuntide. 1. The introit *de Spiritu*, or *Kom*, *hailiger Gaist*. 2. *Kyrie summum* and *Et in terra*, as at Easter. [...] Of the holy Trinity. 1. The introit *de tempore*. 2. *Kyrie summum* with the *Et in terra*. 3. After the epistle, the sequence *de tempore*.

Mecklenburg, *Orderinge der misse*, 1545 (Sehling 5, p. 151). The grade name passes to a German Kyrie:

Das düdesche kyrie summum: Ach vater, alder högeste godt, schölen de kerckheren up den dörpern singen, unde dem volke idt leren, dat de ganze kercke idt singe.

The Dutch [that is, German] *Kyrie summum*, "Ah Father, God most high of all", shall the parsons in the villages sing, and teach it the people, that the whole church may sing it.

"The highest feasts" as a category. Outside the chant books, *summa festa* or *summae festivitates* is used simply as the name of the top rank of days.

Hadersleben, *Artikel*, 1528 (Sehling 23, p. 64). The article on Latin singing:

Eth schal ock friig sin, dat sie in den groten festen mögen Gloria in excelsis up latin singen, des gelicken Alleluya und eine sequentien, alse Grates nunc omnes, Victime Paschali, Veni Sancte Spiritus, und de leyssen darinn, item dat latinische Patrem, prefatien, Sanctus unnd Agnus Dei, doch dat aleine up di groten feste.

It shall also be free that they may on the great feasts sing *Gloria in excelsis* in Latin, likewise the Alleluia and a sequence, as *Grates nunc omnes*, *Victimae paschali*, *Veni Sancte Spiritus*, and the *Leisen* therein; item the Latin *Patrem*, the prefaces, the Sanctus and the *Agnus Dei*: yet that only upon the great feasts.

Note. In the Latin version of these articles, preserved in the edition's apparatus, this article is headed *De Latine cantionibus in summis festis*. The Low German "groten feste" and the Latin *summa festa* are the same rank.

Tangermünde, *Ritus*, 1603 (Sehling 3, p. 338). A local custom-book, printed from Küster:

Si summae festivitates celebrando veniunt et incipiuntur, a die solis per totam septimanam a concionandi labore feriantur ministri. 3. In summis festis diaconus, qui matutinam habet concionem, explicat textum evangelicum, pastor alium convenientem. Alter diaconus lectionem Epistolae.

If the highest festivities come to be celebrated and are begun, the ministers shall rest from the labour of preaching from the Sunday through the whole week. 3. On the highest feasts the deacon that hath the morning sermon expoundeth the text of the Gospel, the pastor another that is convenient, the other deacon the lesson of the Epistle.

Gottorf, visitation articles, 1587 (Sehling 23, p. 371):

12. An Praefatio Dominus vobiscum in summis festis ante communionem cantetur et qua lingua.

12. Whether the Preface, *Dominus vobiscum*, be sung on the highest feasts before the communion, and in what tongue.

3.3 Nine lessons and three

In the medieval Office, a feast of higher grade had a matins of three nocturns and nine lessons. A simple feast or a feria had one nocturn and three lessons. Luther's *Formula missae* already takes the three-lesson matins as the norm for ordinary days.

Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523 (Sehling 1, p. 9):

In reliquis diebus, quas ferias vocamus, nihil video, quod non ferri possit, modo missae abrogentur. Nam matutinae trium lectionum et horae, tum vesperae et compline *de tempore* (the holy days of the saints being excepted), are nothing but the words of divine Scripture.

In the rest of the days, which we call ferias, I see nothing that may not be borne, so that the masses be abolished. For the matins of three lessons, and the hours, and also vespers and compline *de tempore* (the holy days of the saints being excepted), are nothing but the words of divine Scripture.

Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 (Sehling 13, pp. 77–78 and 95). This order still reckons with both forms in chapters and monasteries:

Die mögen in den stiften und clöstern, da man teglich metten singt, also geordnet werden, das, wann man novem lectiones helt, drei aus den historischen büchern der bibel als Mose, Josua, Judicum, Ruth, Samuel, der Könige und Chronica, [...] darnach drei aus den propheten [...] Desgleichen sollen die drei metten in der marterwochen zu ir gewonlichen zeit auch nach obgemeltem unterricht, doch on alles klopfen, rumpeln und getümmel gehalten werden, allein das, wo man sie novem lectionum helt, sollen die letsten drei oder, wo man sie allein trium lectionum helt, sollen dieselben drei in den pfarrkirchen und, wo das, gemein volk darbei ist, teutsch gelesen werden

These may be so ordered in the chapters and cloisters where matins is sung daily, that when nine lessons are kept, three be taken out of the historical books of the Bible, as Moses, Joshua, Judges, Ruth, Samuel, the Kings and Chronicles, [...] thereafter three out of the prophets [...] Likewise the three matins in the week of the Passion shall be kept at their wonted time, and also according to the instruction aforesaid, yet without all knocking, rumbling and tumult; only that where they are kept with nine lessons, the last three, or where they are kept with three lessons only, those same three, shall be read in German in the parish churches, and where the common people are present.

Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 (Sehling 9, p. 276). Here a high feast raises the village matins by one grade:

Frü zur Metten Sollen die Schüler mit dem *Veni sancte* anfangen. Volgents eyn Invitatorium und *Venite*, ob man kan, Darnach Antiphon und Psalmen *de Dominica* oder *Festo*, Hierauff die Lectiones und Responsorialia des gemeynen Sontags und heyligentages, wie droben unter dem titel: Kirchen Ordnung auff den Dörffern, Aber auff hohe Festtage drei Lectiones und Responsorialia, dem fest gemeß, Volgents *Te Deum laudamus*, *Benedictus cum sua Antiphona*, *Collecten* und *Benedicamus* singen.

Early, at matins, the scholars shall begin with the *Veni sancte*; next an invitatory and *Venite*, if it can be done; thereafter antiphon and psalms *de Dominica* or *de Festo*; hereupon the lessons and responds of the common Sunday and holy day, as above under the title "Church order in the villages"; but upon high feast days three lessons and responds, agreeable to the feast; next sing *Te Deum laudamus*, *Benedictus* with its antiphon, the collects and *Benedicamus*.

Transylvanian Saxons, *Kirchenordnung*, 1547 (Latin version; Sehling 24, p. 222). The more solemn feasts keep a fuller matins:

In solennioribus autem festis tres antiphonae cum suis psalmis retinentur. [...] His succedit: *Te Deum laudamus* Germanicum, in maioribus festis etiam Latinum.

But on the more solemn feasts three antiphons with their psalms are retained. [...] These are followed by the *Te Deum laudamus* in German, on the greater feasts in Latin also.

3.4 Proper, common and *de tempore*

Where the Office was still sung in a chapter or convent, the orders use the old categories of the Office. These are the ferial, dominical and festal forms; the proper *de festo* against the *commune sanctorum*; the octave; and the *suffragia*.

Goslar, collegiate church of SS. Simon and Jude, *Ordnung für das Stundengebet*, 1534 (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 264):

Vesper Psalmi feriales cum una Gloria et una anthifona, dar nha lectio ex Novo testamento, inchoande in principio Mathei etc., in festo responsorium de festo, imnus ferialis aut dominicalis vel de festo, Magnificat cum anthifona feriali, in Dominica tertia anthifona ex ewangelio dominicali, in festivitibus de festo, dar nach Kyrieleyson - Christeleyson - Kyrieleyson, Pater noster, versiculus Ostende nobis, Domine, misericordiam tuam etc., collecta dominicalis vel festivalis, Benedicamus.

Vespers. The ferial psalms with one *Gloria* and one antiphon; thereafter a lesson out of the New Testament, beginning at the beginning of Matthew, etc.; on a feast the respond of the feast; the hymn ferial, or dominical, or of the feast; *Magnificat* with the ferial antiphon, on Sunday the third antiphon out of the Sunday Gospel, on festivities of the feast; thereafter *Kyrie eleison*, *Christe eleison*, *Kyrie eleison*, *Pater noster*, the versicle *Ostende nobis*, *Domine*, *misericordiam tuam*, etc., the dominical or festal collect, *Benedicamus*.

Crevese, Benedictine nunnery, visitation recess, 1541 (Sehling 3, p. 203):

Sunst sollen ock die junkfrowen gemeinlich horas de tempore, und van hohen festen, wa bether gescheen, halden. Desgleichen, wan ein fest de sanctis kommet, sollen sie dat commune sanctorum halden und duse gesenge alle, wie in dem stift to Coln an der Sprew gesungen werd, reformert.

Otherwise also the maidens shall commonly keep the hours *de tempore*, and of the high feasts, as hitherto hath been done. Likewise, when a feast *de sanctis* cometh, they shall keep the *commune sanctorum*, and all these chants reformed, as they are sung in the chapter at Cölln on the Spree.

Note. Proper Offices are allowed for the high feasts. A saint's day gets only the common Office, which names no saint's legend. The same wording recurs in the other Brandenburg convent recesses (Sehling 3, pp. 219, 238, 272, 305).

Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Ordnung singens und lesens bei den Stiften*, 1533 (Sehling 11, p. 314). Saints' octaves and suffrages are forbidden:

Alle suffragia de sanctis sollen sie underlassen; dann sie stellen das vertrauen in die hailigen wider das erst gebot Gottes. Allein mogen sie an den werktagen suffragia pro pace und pro peccatis halten. Item sie sollen auch von kainem hailigen die octava, den achtenden, halten. Die histori Trinitatis ist rain; die mögen sie halten, als sie wollen.

All suffrages *de sanctis* they shall leave off, for they set trust in the saints against the first commandment of God. Only upon the working days they may keep the suffrages *pro pace* and *pro peccatis*. Item, they shall also keep the octave, the eighth day, of no saint. The history of the Trinity is pure; that they may keep as they will.

Note. This is the only explicit ruling on octaves among the rank passages. Elsewhere octaves are never forbidden, but they are also simply never mentioned. The Lutheran "three days" of the high feasts (§7) took their place.

3.5 *Ferialiter, festive, solenniter*

Three adverbs from the old rubrics survive: *ferialiter*, *festive* and *solenniter*. *Ferialiter* is used in two opposite senses:

- In Anhalt it keeps its medieval meaning: "in the weekday manner", without the *Gloria in excelsis*.
- In the county of Wied it means "as a holiday", from classical *feriae*.

Anhalt, *Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge, before February 1551* (Sehling 2, pp. 554–555). This order builds a three-step scale into the Mass:

- the high feasts, with sequence, *Patrem*, preface, Sanctus and *Agnus Dei*;
- other Sundays and holy days, with German hymns and Luther's exhortation;
- weekdays, *ferialiter*.

an hohen festen das alleluia und sequenz, an andern sontagen ader feiertagen ein deutscher gesang [...] und volgents an hohen festen singe der priester die praefacio und die schueler das sanctus. An andern son- und feiertagen soll gelesen werden die vermanunge doctor Mart. Luthers an die communicanten. [...] Under der communion aber an hohen festen soll gesungen werden das agnus dei [...] An den werkeltagen soll es also gehalten werden. Fruehe soll eine kurze metten gesungen werden; so aber communicanten vorhanden, mag solche metten underlassen, und das ganze officium coenae in gleicher mass und gestalt, wie oben angezeigt, doch ferialiter ut vocant gehalten werden, als nemblich introitus dominicalis ader ein deutscher psalm kirieleison, doch ane gloria in excelsis

on high feasts the Alleluia and sequence, on other Sundays or holy days a German hymn [...] and then on high feasts let the priest sing the preface and the scholars the Sanctus. On other Sundays and holy days shall be read Doctor Martin Luther's exhortation to the communicants. [...] But under the communion on high feasts shall be sung the *Agnus Dei* [...] On the working days it shall be kept thus. In the morning a short matins shall be sung; but if there be communicants, such matins may be left off, and the whole office of the Supper kept in like measure and form as above shewed, yet *ferialiter*, as they call it, namely the Sunday introit or a German psalm, Kyrie eleison, but without *Gloria in excelsis*

Anhalt, *Kirchenordnung of Prince Bernhard, 1568* (Sehling 2, p. 569):

Do aber festum annuntiationis in der marterwoche gefiele, sol mans ufn palmabend halten, visitationis und nativitatis Marie ferialiter mit den gewonlichen evangelien zu halten.

But if the feast of the Annunciation fall in the week of the Passion, it shall be kept on the eve of Palm Sunday; the Visitation and the Nativity of Mary are to be kept *ferialiter*, with their wonted Gospels.

Note. The Visitation and Nativity of Mary are not holy days. Their Gospels are read on the day, in the weekday form. This is the only order in the corpus that keeps the Nativity of Mary in this reduced way. Compare §8.4.

Wied, *Synodalbeschlüsse, 1564* (Sehling 19/1, p. 467). A two-column list of feasts:

Sequitur catalogus festorum. ferialiter: Circumcisionis Christi Trium Regum Purificationis Mariae Annuntiationis Mariae Matthiae Visitationis Mariae Pasche cum sequente proxima Ascensionis Christi Pentecostes cum sequente Iohannis Baptistae [...] Festum Nativitatis Christi cum duobus sequentibus diebus Omnium Apostolorum tantum fiet concio: Omnium Sanctorum Conversionis Pauli Marci Mariae Magdalенаe Laurentii Natalis Mariae Decollationis Iohannis Michaelis Catarinae In festis patronorum cuiuslibet Ecclesiae

There followeth the catalogue of feasts. *Ferialiter* [that is, to be kept as holidays]: of the Circumcision of Christ; of the Three Kings; of the Purification of Mary; of the Annunciation of Mary; of Matthias; of the Visitation of Mary; of Easter with the next day following; of the Ascension of Christ; of Pentecost with the day following; of John the Baptist [...] the feast of the Nativity of Christ with the two days following; of all the Apostles. Only a sermon shall be held: on All Saints; the Conversion of Paul; Mark; Mary Magdalene; Laurence; the Nativity of Mary; the Beheading of John; Michael; Catherine; on the feasts of the patrons of every church.

Note. Sehling's editor reads the first column as the whole holy days and the second as the half holy days, kept by a morning sermon only. Two things stand out:

- **Michaelmas.** In the north it is one of the four chief feasts (§9). Here it is only a sermon day.
- **Patronal feasts.** The feast of each church's patron survives at the lowest grade. No other order in the corpus keeps it.

Amt Leisnig, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1529 (Sehling 1, p. 610):

Auch sollen die drei hohen feste, allwege drei tag feierlich und festive mit allen cerimonien gehalten werden, und sich sunst in allem andern des buch underricht der visitatorn gehorsamlich halten

Also the three high feasts shall always be kept three days, solemnly and *festive*, with all ceremonies; and in all else they shall keep themselves obediently to the book, the Instruction of the Visitors.

3.6 Vigils and first vespers

The medieval vigil, with its fast and vigil office, disappears. What survives is the evening before a feast: first vespers, with confession for the next day's communicants and on the higher feasts a sermon. The name *vigilia* survives with it. So does the old rule that only feasts of some rank have a proper eve.

Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592 (Sehling 11, p. 411):

Ordo cantilenarum in vespertinis precibus, et quidem in specie ad omnes dies pridianos festorum (vulgus vigiliis appellat), hoc est: dominicas et festa proxime praecedentes dies.

The order of chants at the evening prayers, and that in particular for all the days before feasts (the common people call them vigils), that is, the days next going before Sundays and feasts.

Lohr (county of Rieneck), *Vesperordnung*, 1588 (Sehling 11, p. 699):

Die vesper belangend soll dieselbige sommerzeit umb 3 uhr, winterzeit aber der gelegenheit nach etwas fruer nach anordnung der pfarherrn geleutet und angefangen werden und in vigiliis oder primis vespers, das ist am abent der hohen und anderer festen, sonn- und feiertagen (damit die jugent im psalliren und choralgesang, wie in allen kirchen gebreuchlich, geüebet werde) mit lateinischen psalmen, responsoriis, hymnis, Magnificat, collectis, versiculis, Benedicamus und andern nach ordnung der psalmodiae L. Lossii [...] gesungen und gehalten werden

Touching vespers, the same shall be rung and begun in summer-time at three of the clock, but in winter-time somewhat earlier as occasion serveth, after the ordering of the parsons; and *in vigiliis* or at the first vespers, that is, on the eve of the high and other feasts, Sundays and holy days (that the youth may be exercised in psalmody and plain-song, as is used in all churches), it shall be sung and kept with Latin psalms, responds, hymns, *Magnificat*, collects, versicles, *Benedicamus* and the rest, according to the order of the *Psalmodia* of L. Lossius [...]

Burg, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1542 (Sehling 2, p. 427). A sermon at vespers on the eve of the high feasts:

Erstlich alle sonnabende und in vigiliis der hohen feste auch anderer evangelischer viertage sal in beiden pfarkirchen von dem pfarrer oder seinem diacon vesper gehalten werden [...] Und so es vor not und biqueme eracht und angesehen und sonderlich in den vigilien der hohen feste, so sal nach der vesper auch geprediget werden

First, on all Saturdays, and *in vigiliis* of the high feasts and also of the other evangelical holy days, vespers shall be held in both parish churches by the parson or his deacon [...] And if it be deemed needful and convenient, and in especial on the vigils of the high feasts, there shall be preaching also after vespers.

Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1561 (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 513). After a list of thirteen feasts, from Sunday to Michaelmas:

9. Dies Pentecostes una cum adiunctis duobus 10. Dies Trinitatis 11. Dies Johannis Baptistae 12. Dies Visitationis Mariae 13. Dies Michaelis In horum festorum vigilia et parasceve circa horam secundam fiat vespera a tota Latina Schola in templo Beatae Virginis canendo unum atque alterum psalmum Latinum, responsorium pro tempore et hymnum Magnificat. In reliquis autem templis Germanice canatur.

9. The day of Pentecost, together with the two joined to it. 10. The day of the Trinity. 11. The day of John the Baptist. 12. The day of the Visitation of Mary. 13. The day of Michael. On the vigil and preparation of these feasts, about the second hour, let vespers be held by the whole Latin school in the church of the Blessed Virgin, singing one or two Latin psalms, the respond for the season, and the hymn *Magnificat*. But in the rest of the churches let it be sung in German.

Anhalt, Nicolaus Hausmann's order, 1532 (Sehling 2, p. 542). The only order in the corpus that would like to keep the night vigil of Christmas and Easter:

Vigilia paschce. natalis. Es wer auch nicht bese, das die christnacht und ostern mit der wache gehalten wurden, wie für alters.

The vigil of Easter; of the Nativity. It were also not evil that Christmas night and Easter were kept with the watch, as of old.

Note. Hausmann goes on to name the abuses that have grown up around the night watch. He proposes instead an early service at about three in the morning (p. 543).

4. Why keep feasts at all: the principles behind the ranking

Before an order ranks feasts, it usually says why any feast besides Sunday should be kept. Its answer decides the ranking:

- **The feasts of Christ.** Those that set forth the work of redemption come first.
- **Feasts with a Gospel history.** Feasts whose history is told in the Gospel come next.
- **The apostles and the rest.** The apostles, and other days kept only for their examples, come last.
- **Legend and abuse.** Feasts with no ground in Scripture, or bound up with abuse, are abolished.

The passages below give the main forms of the argument.

4.1 Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523

Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523 (Sehling 1, p. 5):

Primo, introitus dominicales et in festis Christi, nempe paschatis, pentechostes, nativitatis, probamus et servamus, quamquam psalmos malleamus, unde sumpti sunt, ut olim, sed nunc sic usui recepto indulgebimus. Quod si qui apostolorum, virginis aliorumque sanctorum introitus (quando e psalmis aut aliis scripturis sumpti sunt) probare volent, non damnamus. Nos Wittembergae solis dominicis et festis domini sabathissare quaeremus, omnium sanctorum festa prorsus abroganda, vel si quid dignum in eis est, in dominicalibus concionibus miscenda esse putamus. Festum purificationis et annunciationis pro festis Christi, sicut epiphanian et circumcisionem, habemus. Loco festi S. Stephani et Iohannis Evangelistae officium nativitatis placet. Festa S. Crucis anathema sunt. Alii faciant pro sua conscientia vel aliorum infirmitate, quod spiritus suggesserit.

First, the introits of the Sundays and of the feasts of Christ, namely of Easter, Pentecost and the Nativity, we approve and keep, although we had rather have the psalms from which they are taken, as of old; but now we will bear with the received use. And if any will approve the introits of the apostles, of the Virgin, and of other saints (when they are taken out of the psalms or other Scriptures), we condemn them not. We at Wittenberg seek to keep sabbath only on the Lord's days and the feasts of the Lord; the feasts of all the saints we judge are to be utterly abrogated, or, if there be aught worthy in them, to be mingled into the Sunday sermons. The feast of the Purification and of the Annunciation we hold for feasts of Christ, as also the Epiphany and the Circumcision. In the stead of the feast of St Stephen and of John the Evangelist, the office of the Nativity pleaseth us. The feasts of the Holy Cross, let them be anathema. Let others do according to their own conscience, or for the infirmity of others, what the Spirit shall suggest.

Note. This is the charter of the Lutheran calendar. It sets out four points:

- **Two ranks only.** Sundays and "feasts of the Lord" are kept, and nothing else.
- **Marian feasts reclassified.** The two Marian feasts with a Gospel history, the Purification and the Annunciation, are counted as feasts of Christ.
- **Stephen and John absorbed.** Their days are taken into Christmas.
- **Holy Cross.** The feasts of the Holy Cross are damned outright.

The last sentence leaves room for local custom, and most later orders used it. They kept the apostles, the Visitation, John the Baptist and Michaelmas at a lower rank.

4.2 Homberg, 1526: only the mysteries of redemption

Hessen, *Reformatio ecclesiarum Hassiae (Homberg)*, 1526, cap. 8 (Sehling 8, p. 49):

De festis et commemorationibus cap. 8 [38] Praeter Dominicam diem nullum festum celebretur, nisi pro mysteriis nostrae redemptionis. Adeo haec sola de caetero habeantur: Nativitatis Christi, Circumcisionis, Epiphaniae, Praesentationis Domini in templum, Incarnationis Verbi Dei sive Annuntiationis, diei Parasceves, Paschae die primo, Ascensionis et Pentecostes die primo, item dies Visitationis Beatae Mariae. [...] Horum quippe celebratio non in factis superstitiosis, sed in verbi sancti frequentia et operibus misericordiae est sita.

Of feasts and commemorations, chapter 8. [38] Beside the Lord's day let no feast be celebrated, save for the mysteries of our redemption. Wherefore let these only be kept henceforth: of the Nativity of Christ, of the Circumcision, of the Epiphany, of the Presentation of the Lord in the temple, of the Incarnation of the Word of

God or Annunciation, of the day of the Preparation, of Easter the first day, of the Ascension, and of Pentecost the first day; item the day of the Visitation of the Blessed Mary. [...] For the celebration of these standeth not in superstitious deeds, but in the frequent use of the holy Word and in works of mercy.

Note. This is the strictest one-rank calendar of any Lutheran-leaning order in the corpus:

- **Nothing between Sunday and the feasts of redemption.** There are no apostles, no John the Baptist and no Michaelmas.
- **One day each.** Easter and Pentecost are kept for their "first day" only.

The Homberg *Reformatio* was never put into force. The later Hessian orders keep more (§4.6, §6.1).

4.3 "Not for the days' sake, but for the histories": Bugenhagen

Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung* (Bugenhagen), 1528 (Sehling 6/1, p. 380):

Wy sind vor Gade in unsen conscientien an neyne tidt verbunden, overs sulck schüt deme gemeynen volke to denste, dewile alle stucken der hilgen scrift up eyne tidt nicht gehandelt konen werden. Darumme holde wy ock de hogen feste Christi unde andere, darvan in deme evangelio historien synt bescreven, nicht umme der dage willen, welke gelden (vor Gade unde by den rechtvorstendigen Christen) like vele, de eyne so vele alse de andere, sonder umme der historien willen to predigen.

We are before God in our consciences bound to no time; but such is done for the service of the common people, forasmuch as all the parts of holy Scripture cannot be handled at one time. Therefore we keep also the high feasts of Christ, and others whereof histories are written in the Gospel, not for the days' sake, which (before God and with Christians of right understanding) are worth alike, the one as much as the other, but for the histories' sake, to preach them.

Note. The same words stand in Hamburg 1529 (Sehling 5, pp. 513–514) and, in shorter form, in the other Bugenhagen orders. The test, "whereof histories are written in the Gospel", is the one most later orders use to rank a feast.

Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 (Sehling 23, p. 95):

Van Vyerdagen. Denne wy möthen etlike Feste beholden, nicht um der dage willen, sonder van wegen der Predige des Gödtliken wordes, dat alle stücke des Hilligen Evangelii mögen bequemlick uthgelecht werden. Wy nemen nene vyerdage an, den allene de gewöntlike Sondage, Darmede men van dem arbeide rouwen, dat Word Gades hören, Dat Sacrament entfangen unde ynt gemene vor alle nodturfft bidden, ock Gade vor syne woldadt dancken mögen.

Of holy days. For we must retain certain feasts, not for the days' sake, but because of the preaching of the divine Word, that all the parts of the holy Gospel may be conveniently expounded. We accept no holy days save only the wonted Sundays, whereon men may rest from labour, hear the Word of God, receive the Sacrament, and pray in common for every need, and also thank God for his benefits.

4.4 A school timetable of doctrine

Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528 (Sehling 1, p. 164):

Welche feste also geordnet sind, denn man kann "nicht alle stücke des evangelii einmals lernen. Darümb man solche lere ins jar geteilet hat. Wie man in einer schule ordnet, auf einen tag Virgilium, auf den

ändern Homerum zu lesen.

Which feasts are so ordained because one cannot teach all the parts of the Gospel at once. Therefore such doctrine hath been divided through the year, as in a school one ordaineth to read Virgil on one day and Homer on another.

Württemberg, Kirchenordnung, 1536 (Sehling 16, p. 105). The feasts of Christ are to follow the order of his acts:

Haben wir für gut angesehen, das man ein fest nach dem andern begee unnd in den festen Christi eben die ordnung halte, die in den thaten selbs, natürlicher ordnung und übernatürlicher götlicher anschickung unnd würckung nach, sich von anfang der empfencknus unnd menschwerdung Christi, unsers liebsten heilands, uns zu erlösung unnd ewiger herrlicheyt so gnedigklich eines nach dem andern erzeiget hat.

We have thought it good that one feast be kept after another, and that in the feasts of Christ that very order be held which, in the deeds themselves, according to the natural order and to the supernatural divine appointment and working, hath shewn itself so graciously one after another, from the beginning of the conception and incarnation of Christ our dearest Saviour, unto our redemption and eternal glory.

4.5 Not a commandment of God: a civil and pastoral ordinance

Schwäbisch Hall, Brenz, Kirchenordnung, 1527 (Sehling 17/1, p. 53):

Bey den kristen ist kein eusserlicher, von Got gebotner Feyertag, wie by den Juden der Sabath und ander Festen gewesen sein, sonder ist ein stetter, ewiger Sabbath oder Feyertag, vom Tauff anhebend, biß in den tod werdendt, darin nimer kein unrecht gescheft volnbracht sol werden. Doch in einer cristenlichen versamlung zur eusserlichen noturfft mag ein ordnung in tagen und Zeytten mit Feyertagen und wercktagen gehalten werden in zuchtiger ordnung und eusserlicher ainikait, nit zu einem gewißen, als von Got gebotten und zur frumckait und selsellikait notig

Among Christians there is no outward holy day commanded of God, as the Sabbath and other feasts have been among the Jews; but there is a continual, everlasting Sabbath or holy day, beginning from baptism and lasting unto death, wherein no unrighteous business shall ever be performed. Yet in a Christian congregation, for outward necessity, an order in days and times, with holy days and working days, may be kept in seemly order and outward unity; not for the conscience, as commanded of God and needful to godliness and salvation

Schwäbisch Hall, Brenz, sermon on the magistrate's ordinance of holy days, 1527 (Sehling 17/1, p. 78):

Est autem regia via festos non existimare necessarios esse ad felicitatem eternam, sed ad honestam civilem pacem et concordiam ac quietem a labore. Quod enim caret alterna requie, durable non est. Atque hac via incedit mandatum magistratus civilis de festis. Ordinavit enim dies festos non ad iusticiam divinam necessarios, sed ad publicam pacem et quietem, ut hec sit civilis ordinacio, non papatus supersticio.

Now the royal way is to hold feast days not necessary to eternal felicity, but to honest civil peace and concord and to rest from labour. For that which lacketh alternate rest is not durable. And in this way goeth the commandment of the civil magistrate concerning feasts. For he hath ordained feast days not as necessary to

divine righteousness, but for the public peace and quiet, that this may be a civil ordinance, not a superstition of the papacy.

Northheim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1539 (Sehling 6/2, p. 934):

Wiewol es unnötig ist, viel festtage anzurichten, und auch aus kraft christlicher freiheit niemand an solche feirtage gebunden sein sol, wie die epistel zun Colossern am andern bezeugt, so hat man dennoch umb der schwachen willen, dieweil das evangelion bey uns noch etlichermasse neue ist, etliche furnemliche feste, damit das wort deste statlicher getrieben und gehort werde, verordnen müssen.

Although it is needless to set up many feast days, and no man also ought to be bound to such holy days, by virtue of Christian liberty, as the epistle to the Colossians in the second chapter witnesseth; yet for the weak's sake, forasmuch as the Gospel is among us yet in some measure new, certain principal feasts have had to be ordained, that the Word may be the more worthily set forth and heard.

Hessen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532 (Sehling 8, p. 75). The apostles' days are also justified by the need for rest:

Nicht sagen wir, daß dise tage besser oder heiliger seint dan andere, sonder daß solchs des gemeinen mans und der ungelerten jugent, dermaßen furgnommen, hohe notturft erfordert, welches sonst, durch ihre arbeit verhindert, nicht zeit haben, zum wenigsten die notturftigest stuck christelichs glaubens zu leren; uberdas ist auch sonst bruderlich und civile, daß man beide, menschen und viehe, zun zeiten ihre reuw lasse.

We say not that these days are better or holier than others, but that the great need of the common man and of the unlearned youth, taken in this wise, requireth it; who otherwise, hindered by their labour, have no time to learn at the least the most needful parts of the Christian faith. Moreover it is also otherwise brotherly and civil that both men and cattle be let have their rest at times.

Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553 (Sehling 16, p. 266). This preamble was copied into the Kurpfalz order of 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Nördlingen 1579 and others:

Dieweil dann die ordnung der Feyertag gmeiner Kirchen dahin dienstlich, das sie bestimpte zeit wisse, die Predig und die außtheilung der Heiligen Sacrament zu besuchen, und die gemeinen, weltlichen Recht zubeweisung ires gehorsamen diensts gegen Christo, dem Son Gottes, und seiner Kirchen ire besondere freiheit den fürnembsten Feirtagen geben, So wöllen wir, das hie nachbenannte tag zu Feirtag verkündiget und Christlich gebür nach gehalten werden

Forasmuch then as the order of holy days serveth the common Church to this end, that it may know an appointed time to resort to the sermon and to the ministering of the holy Sacraments; and the common temporal laws, to shew their obedient service toward Christ the Son of God and his Church, give their special freedom to the chieftest holy days: we will that the days hereafter named be proclaimed for holy days, and kept according to Christian duty

4.6 "The feast of all feasts": Hessen, 1566

Hessen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Sehling 8, pp. 257–258):

haben wir uns auch fürgenommen, etliche festa Christi zu halten. [...] Chrysostomus [...] in einer predig vom heiligen Philogonio erzelet etlich festa Christi und nennet die menschwerdung und geburt Christi

das fest aller festen. Denn aus diesem haben ihren grund und ursprung Epiphania, Ostern, Himmelfart und Pfingsten.

we also have purposed to keep certain feasts of Christ. [...] Chrysostom [...] in a sermon on the holy Philogonius rehearseth certain feasts of Christ, and calleth the incarnation and birth of Christ the feast of all feasts. For out of this have Epiphany, Easter, the Ascension and Pentecost their ground and origin.

Note. This is the only place in the corpus where one feast is ranked above all the others, and it is done by patristic argument. The order does not draw a liturgical consequence. Its feasts of Christ are kept "in the form of the Sunday", with only the chants, lessons and prayers changed (p. 258).

4.7 The test of Scripture history

Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung* of Duke Heinrich, 1539 (Sehling 1, p. 274):

Über die gemeinen sonntage sollen gehalten werden die hohen heuptfeste des herrn Christi, welche von alters her in der christenheit darzu geordnet sind, das die sondern stücke der historien oder geschicht von Christo, so man im glauben bekennet, in gedechtnis des gemeinen volks behalten und daran dieselben artikel des christlichen glaubens gehandelt werden. Zu solchen festen Christi gehören auch etliche von denen, so man bisher der jungfrauen Marie gefeiert hat.

Over and above the common Sundays shall be kept the high chief feasts of the Lord Christ, which from of old in Christendom were ordained to this end: that the several parts of the history or story of Christ which are confessed in the Creed might be kept in the remembrance of the common people, and those same articles of the Christian faith handled thereon. To such feasts of Christ belong also some of those that were hitherto kept for the Virgin Mary.

Note. This paragraph, the list that follows it (§5.2) and the rule for the apostles' days became the model for the Mecklenburg order of 1552. Through that order it reached the Brunswick, Lüneburg, Oldenburg, Lippe, Verden and Palatinate-Zweibrücken orders.

Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 (Sehling 13, p. 71). The same test is used to decide which days break the continuous reading of Scripture:

Doch ausgenommen die hohen fest, die ir historien, darumb sie aufgesetzt sein, in der heiligen schrift haben als Weihennacht, Obersten, Lichtmeß, Annunciationis, Palmtag, Ostern, Auffartstag, Pfingstag, Johannis des taulers, Visitationis etc.; dann an disen festen sol man die capitel aus der bibel lesen, für die epistel und evangelia, darin die historia des festes beschrieben und die sonst darzu verordnet sein.

Yet excepted the high feasts which have their histories, for the sake whereof they were set up, in holy Scripture, as Christmas, Twelfth Day, Candlemas, the Annunciation, Palm Sunday, Easter, Ascension Day, Whitsunday, John the Baptist, the Visitation, etc.; for on these feasts one shall read, for the epistle and Gospel, the chapters out of the Bible wherein the history of the feast is written and which are otherwise appointed thereto.

Gera, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1556 (an extract of the order of the Vogtland superintendents made at Plauen in 1552; Sehling 2, p. 158):

III. Festa und feiertage. Neben den gewöhnlichen sonntag sollen die feste Christi und der heiligen apostel, so evangelia und historien in der schrift geben, in allen gemeinen feierlich gehalten, daran

gottes wort mit vleis gepredigt, auch das göttlich ampt mit reichung der sacrament, do communicanten vorhanden, und sonderlich der catechismus nachmittage stets getrieben werden. Es sollen aber damit diese nachfolgende und keine andere der heiligen oder sonsten papistische feste gemeint sein.

III. Feasts and holy days. Beside the wonted Sunday, the feasts of Christ and of the holy apostles which give Gospels and histories in the Scripture shall be solemnly kept in all congregations; and on them God's Word shall be diligently preached, and the divine office also held with the ministering of the sacraments, where there be communicants, and in especial the catechism be always taught in the afternoon. But hereby shall be meant these following, and no other feasts of the saints or otherwise papistical.

Transylvania, Honterus, *Reformationsbüchlein*, 1543 (Latin; Sehling 24, p. 189):

Dies festos propter multiplices abusus in angustum contraximus observatis tamen omnibus iis, qui in ecclesia generali ob historias in sacris literis comprehensas sunt recepti.

The feast days, because of manifold abuses, we have drawn into a narrow compass, yet keeping all those which have been received in the general Church for the histories contained in the holy writings.

Kosd and Schelken chapters (Transylvania), statutes, 1577 (Sehling 24, p. 400):

Nolumus omnino in nostris ecclesiis ullam esse celebrandorum festorum varietatem, sed catalogus festorum dierum in Reformatione Coronensis Ecclesiae traditus observetur. Qui vero in eo adscripti non sunt (ut puta in sacris nullam habentes historiam) omittantur.

We will in no wise that there be in our churches any variety in the feasts to be celebrated, but let the catalogue of feast days delivered in the Reformation of the church of Kronstadt be observed. But those that are not written therein (as having, namely, no history in holy writ) let them be omitted.

Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530 (Sehling 5, p. 17). This order gives a reason of this kind for keeping the Visitation:

Alle festa Christi unsers herrn und erlösers, woll wir halten, auf das man das gedechtnus der heilsamen und grossen gnadenreichen werck, die uns zu trost geschehen sind, mit predigten und ermanung des volcks jerlich begehe, als nemlichen weinachten, circumcissionis, epiphanie, purificationis, annunciationis, ostern, pfingsten, mit den andern folgenden tagen, auch ascensionis Christi, und visitationis, die weil das die erste offenbarung Christi ist gewesen, da er noch in mutter leib war

All the feasts of Christ our Lord and Redeemer will we keep, that the remembrance of the wholesome and great gracious works which were done for our comfort may be kept yearly with sermons and exhortation of the people; namely Christmas, the Circumcision, the Epiphany, the Purification, the Annunciation, Easter, Pentecost, with the other days following, also the Ascension of Christ, and the Visitation, forasmuch as that was the first revelation of Christ, when he was yet in his mother's womb

Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567 (Sehling 13, p. 474). The feasts that the town's Catholics still keep are dropped, because they lack a Scripture history:

Und wiewol in unser stat die papisten viel mehr feirn halten, als Georgii, Corporis Christi, Mariae Magdalенаe, Laurentii, Assumptionis Mariae, Nativitatis Mariae, Omnium sanctorum, Martini, Catharinae, Nicolai, so haben wir sie doch zu feiern entlich faren lassen und mit vorgehender, genugsamer erinnerung an die christlich gemein, wie solche fest nit allein gar kein historien heiliger schrift haben,

sondern als ganz b pstisch mit h chster abg ttereier und zu bestetigung derselben, wider die reine lere unser kirchen vom widerteil gebraucht werden.

And although in our city the papists keep many more holy days, as of George, of Corpus Christi, of Mary Magdalene, of Laurence, of the Assumption of Mary, of the Nativity of Mary, of All Saints, of Martin, of Catherine, of Nicholas, yet we have at last let go the keeping of them, with foregoing sufficient admonition to the Christian congregation, how such feasts not only have no history of holy Scripture at all, but are used by the adverse part, as wholly papistical, with the highest idolatry and to the confirming of the same, against the pure doctrine of our churches.

4.8 The Sabbath argument: Sunday first in dignity

Posen, Bohemian Brethren, synodal order, 1576 (Sehling 4, p. 285). Most Lutheran orders treat the choice of days as free. The Brethren's order, printed among the Posen texts, grounds Sunday's precedence in the moral law:

VII. Consuetudo circa dies festos. Inter dies festos primam tribuimus dignitatem septimo diei, dominico, quem arbitramur nemini hominum ad operas externas et serviles, ullo etiam libertatis christianae praetextu adhibere licere. Idque propterea, quod institutionem eius non pro ceremonia, sed pro parte moralis, aeternum inviolabilis, legis agnoscimus.

VII. The custom concerning feast days. Among the feast days we give the first dignity to the seventh day, the Lord's, which we judge it lawful for no man to employ in outward and servile works, under any pretext even of Christian liberty; and that because we acknowledge its institution not for a ceremony, but for a part of the moral law, everlastingly inviolable.

5. The Lutheran scale of feasts

5.1 The common pattern

Most orders rank the feast days in the same few steps, though the words vary.

Rank	Names used in the orders	Usual days	How kept
Sunday	<i>der Sontag, des Herren Tag, dies dominica</i>	every Sunday	the whole day; the norm by which the feasts are measured
1. The high feasts	<i>hohe Feste, Hauptfeste, heuptfest des herrn Christi, de dre groten feste Christi, summa festa, Vierzeiten, gro�e Feste</i>	Christmas, Easter, Whitsunday, each with one or two following days; often Michaelmas as the fourth; sometimes Ascension	the whole day, usually on two or three days; two or three sermons; Latin chant, sequence and proper preface; figural music; communion; no weddings
2. The other feasts of Christ and	<i>die andern festa Christi, f�rnembste Feste, andere herliche fest,</i>	Circumcision (New Year), Epiphany, Purification, Annunciation, Ascension,	usually the whole day, "as on Sundays", with the introit, sequence and

Rank	Names used in the orders	Usual days	How kept
"Gospel" feasts	<i>gemeine fest, mittelmeßige festa</i>	Trinity; John the Baptist, Visitation, Michaelmas; in some orders Maundy Thursday and Good Friday	preface <i>de tempore</i> ; in some orders only the forenoon
3. Apostles' days and other saints' days	<i>Aposteltage, kleine Feste, halbe Feiertage, festa apostolorum</i>	the apostles; the Conversion of Paul; often Mary Magdalene, the Beheading of John, All Saints	a sermon in the forenoon, work after it; or no holy day, with the Gospel preached on the next Sunday or at a weekday sermon
4. Abolished feasts	<i>papistische feste, abgötterische feste</i>	Corpus Christi, Holy Cross, the Conception, Nativity and Assumption of Mary (in most orders), All Souls, local saints	not kept; sometimes proclaimed and explained so that people know why they are gone

The orders differ in three ways:

- **How many ranks they draw.** Some have two, many three, and a few four.
- **Where the middle feasts stand.** John the Baptist, the Visitation, Michaelmas, and in some orders Purification and Annunciation, sit either with the feasts of Christ or with the apostles.
- **What a lower rank means.** It may mean a half holy day, a single sermon, a transfer to Sunday, or the loss of the holy day altogether.

The families below show the main lines.

5.2 The Saxon and Mecklenburg family: "over and above these chiefest feasts"

The line starts with the Saxon *Unterricht der Visitatoren* of 1528. It speaks of two ranks in its own words.

Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528 (Sehling 1, p. 164):

Were auch gut, das sie eintrechtiglich feierten, die sontage, annunciationis, purificationis, visitationis der reinen jungfrauen Maria, S. Johannis des teufers, Michaelis, der aposteln, Magdalene, die selben feste weren denn bereit abgangen, und künnten nicht bequemlich alle wider aufgericht werden. Und in sonderheit sol man halten den christag, beschneidung, epiphanie, die osterfeier, auffart, pfingsten, doch abgethan, was unchristlich legenden oder gesang darinnen gefunden werden.

It were good also that they should keep holy day with one accord on the Sundays, the Annunciation, the Purification, the Visitation of the pure Virgin Mary, St John the Baptist, Michaelmas, the apostles', Magdalene; unless those feasts be already fallen away and could not conveniently all be set up again. And in especial one shall keep Christmas, the Circumcision, the Epiphany, the Easter holy days, the Ascension, Whitsuntide; yet with all things done away that are found therein of unchristian legends or chants.

Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539 (Sehling 1, p. 274). The feasts of Christ follow the preamble quoted in §4.7. Sehling gives this part of the order in his own summary but quotes the text:

Der tag nativitatis oder der geburt Christi sampt den andern und auch dem dritten nechstfolgenden, so man daran communicanten hat. Der tag circumcisionis oder der beschneidung Christi. Der tag epiphanie, das ist der erscheinung oder offenbarung Christi, da die weisen aus morgenland durch erscheinung des sterns zu Christo kamen. Dieser tag wird auch gehalten von der taufe Christi. Der tag der offenbarung Christi in dem tempel, so man nennet purificationis Mariae. Der tag annuntiationis seu conceptionis Christi, da Christus in der jungfrauen leib empfangen ist. Der tag coenae domini, so man nennet den grünen donnerstag, daran von dem abendmal und hochwürdigen sakrament zu predigen ist. Der tag des leidens Christi, so der karfreitag genennet wird. Der ostertag von der auferstehung des herrn sampt dem nechstfolgenden und dritten, so man communicanten hat. Der tag der himelfart Christi. Der pfingstag von der sendung des heiligen geists. Der heiligen dreifaltigkeit fest gefellet auf den nehesten sonntag nach pfingsten. Hierüber sollen auch diese fest gehalten werden. Der tag S. Johannis des teufers zu ehren dem heiligen predigampt des evangelii von Christo. Der tag visitationis, da Maria ihre mume Elisabeth heimgesucht hat von wegen derselben historien des evangelii. Der tag Michaelis, daran von den heiligen engeln zu predigen. [...] Man mag auch die tage der heiligen aposteln halten, das man vor mittag daran predige und, so es fürfelt, die communio halte. Nachmittage aber mag man wol der teglichen arbeit warten, oder, wo man wil, mag man die evangelia und gedechtnis von den heiligen aposteln auf die nehesten sonntag, so darnach gefallen, zur mittags oder vesper predigt verlegen. Desgleichen mag es auch mit etlichen anderen festen der heiligen, welcher historien im evangelio beschrieben sind, gehalten werden, als da sind S. Paulus bekerung, Marie Magdalena, S. Johannis enthauptung, S. Stephan etc.

The day of the Nativity or birth of Christ, with the second and also the third next following, if there be communicants thereon. The day of the Circumcision of Christ. The day of the Epiphany, that is, of the appearing or manifestation of Christ, when the wise men from the east came to Christ by the appearing of the star; this day is also kept of the baptism of Christ. The day of the manifestation of Christ in the temple, which is called the Purification of Mary. The day of the Annunciation or Conception of Christ, when Christ was conceived in the Virgin's womb. The day of the Lord's Supper, which is called Maundy Thursday, whereon one is to preach of the Supper and the most worthy Sacrament. The day of the Passion of Christ, which is called Good Friday. Easter day, of the resurrection of the Lord, with the next following and the third, if there be communicants. The day of the Ascension of Christ. Whitsunday, of the sending of the Holy Ghost. The feast of the holy Trinity falleth on the next Sunday after Pentecost. Over and above these, these feasts also shall be kept: the day of St John the Baptist, to the honour of the holy office of preaching the Gospel of Christ; the day of the Visitation, when Mary visited her cousin Elisabeth, because of that history of the Gospel; the day of Michael, whereon one is to preach of the holy angels. [...] One may also keep the days of the holy apostles, so that one preach thereon before noon and, if occasion serve, hold the communion. But in the afternoon one may well attend to the daily work; or, if one will, one may put over the Gospels and remembrance of the holy apostles to the next Sunday that followeth, to the midday or evening sermon. Likewise it may be done also with certain other feasts of the saints whose histories are written in the Gospel, as are St Paul's conversion, Mary Magdalene, St John's beheading, St Stephen, etc.

Merseburg, Synodalunterricht, 1544 (Sehling 2, p. 20). This order sets the two ranks side by side, and its title for the lower rank is a phrase worth noting: "doch ohne gebotene feir", without a commanded holy day.

Den ganzen tag zu feiren fur und nachmittage zu predigen: Alle sonntage und folgende evangelische festa: nativitas Christi sampt dem andern auch dem dritten tage, so man daran communicanten hat [...] Hierüber sollen diese feiertage gehalten werden: der tag S. Johannis des teufers zu ehren dem heiligen predigtampt des evangelii von Christo der tag visitationis, da die junkfrau Maria ihre mume Elisabet

heimgesucht hat von wegen der feinen historien des evangelii der tag Michaelis dar von den lieben engeln zu predigen. An volgenden tagen solle fur mittage predigt und communion, do es fur fiele, gehalten und die dem volk auf den sontag zuvor doch ahne gebotene feir vorkundiget werden. Als nemlich der tag cene domini, so man den grunen donnerstag nennet, daran von dem abentmahl und hochwirdigen sacrament zu predigen der tag des leidens Christi, so der karfreitag genennet wirt, dar man die ganz historia des leidens Christi dem volk furtragen solt der tag Petri und Pauli und aller apostel zu ehren des heiligen apostelampts

To keep holy day the whole day, and to preach before and after noon: all Sundays, and the following evangelical feasts: the Nativity of Christ with the second and also the third day, if there be communicants thereon [...] Over and above these, these holy days shall be kept: the day of St John the Baptist, to the honour of the holy office of preaching the Gospel of Christ; the day of the Visitation, when the Virgin Mary visited her cousin Elisabeth, because of the fine history of the Gospel; the day of Michael, whereon to preach of the dear angels. On the following days preaching and communion, if it so fall out, shall be held before noon, and they shall be declared to the people on the Sunday before, yet without a commanded holy day: namely the day of the Lord's Supper, which is called Maundy Thursday, whereon to preach of the Supper and the most worthy Sacrament; the day of the Passion of Christ, which is called Good Friday, whereon the whole history of the Passion of Christ should be set forth to the people; the day of Peter and Paul and of all apostles, to the honour of the holy apostolic office

Note. Maundy Thursday and Good Friday stand in the lower rank here, beside the apostles. The feasts of Christ are placed by their standing as holy days, not by their theological weight.

Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552 (Sehling 5, pp. 200–201). This is the fullest form of the Saxon scheme, and it is the one most often copied:

Von den besondern festen oder feiertagen, so man im jar halten sol. Über die gemeinen sontage sollen gehalten werden die hohen heubtfest des herrn Christi, als da sind. Der tag Nativitatis oder der geburt Christi, samt dem andern und dritten folgenden. Der tag Circumcisionis oder der beschneidung Christi. Der tag Epiphanie, das ist der erscheinung oder offenbarung Christi, den man nennet der heiligen drei könig tag. Der tag der opferung Christi im tempel, genant Purificationis Mariae. Der tag Annunciationis Mariae oder Conceptionis Christi, da Christus in der jungfrauen leib empfangen ist. Der tag Coenae domini, den man den grünen donnerstag nennet, daran von des herrn abendmal sol gepredigt werden. Der tag Passionis domini oder des leidens und sterbens Christi, welcher der karfreitag genennet wird. Der ostertag oder Pasca, der tag der ufferstehung Christi, samt dem folgenden montag und dienstag. Der tag Ascensionis oder himelfart Christi. Der pfingstag, samt dem folgenden montag und dienstag. Der tag Trinitatis gefelt uff den nehesten sontag nach pfingsten. Uff diese fest sol es mit ordnung der lection, gesange, predigten und communio gehalten werden, wie den gemeinen sontagen, allein, das die introitus, sequenz und prefationes de tempore gesungen werden. [...] Über diese furnemsten fest sollen auch die gehalten werden. Die tage der aposteln. Der tag S. Johannis des teufers. Der tag Visitationis, da Maria ire mume Elisabeth heimsucht. [...] Der tag Michaelis, an welchem die lere von den heiligen engeln dem volk sol furgetragen werden. An diesen tagen sol man vor mittage predigen, und so communicanten da sind, die communion halten, wie an den sontagen. Nach mittage aber mag man wol der gewöhnlichen erbeit warten. Ausgenomen den tag Michaelis, an welchem vor und nach mittage sol gepredigt werden. Das fest aber Assumptionis, oder himelfart Marie, sol hinfurder ganz abgethan sein, und an des selben stat das fest S. Michaelis als ein viergezeiten fest gehalten werden.

Of the special feasts or holy days which shall be kept in the year. Over and above the common Sundays shall be kept the high chief feasts of the Lord Christ, which are these: the day of the Nativity or birth of Christ, with the second and third following; the day of the Circumcision of Christ; the day of the Epiphany, that is, of the appearing or manifestation of Christ, which is called the day of the Three Kings; the day of the offering of Christ in the temple, called the Purification of Mary; the day of the Annunciation of Mary or Conception of Christ, when Christ was conceived in the Virgin's womb; the day of the Lord's Supper, which is called Maundy Thursday, whereon shall be preached of the Lord's Supper; the day of the Passion of the Lord, or of the suffering and death of Christ, which is called Good Friday; Easter day, or Pascha, the day of the resurrection of Christ, with the Monday and Tuesday following; the day of the Ascension of Christ; Whitsunday, with the Monday and Tuesday following; the day of the Trinity falleth on the next Sunday after Pentecost. On these feasts it shall be done, as touching the order of lessons, chants, sermons and communion, as on the common Sundays; only that the introits, sequences and prefaces *de tempore* be sung. [...] Over and above these chiefest feasts these also shall be kept: the days of the apostles; the day of St John the Baptist; the day of the Visitation, when Mary visiteth her cousin Elisabeth; [...] the day of Michael, whereon the doctrine of the holy angels shall be set forth to the people. On these days one shall preach before noon, and if there be communicants, hold the communion, as on Sundays; but in the afternoon one may well attend to the wonted work. Except the day of Michael, whereon there shall be preaching before and after noon. But the feast of the Assumption, or Ascension of Mary, shall henceforth be wholly done away, and in the stead of the same the feast of St Michael be kept as a feast of the four times.

Note. Michaelmas has a place of its own in this scheme:

- It is listed with the second rank, but it is preached "before and after noon" like a feast of Christ.
- It takes the Assumption's place as one of the four *Vierzeiten* (§9).

The Mecklenburg text, with small changes, stands in these orders:

Order	Sehling	Changes of note
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1557	18, pp. 205– 206	apostles' days not named one by one (listed in the <i>Feiertagsordnung</i> of 1561, §6.2)
Lüneburg, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1564	6/1, pp. 550– 551	follows Mecklenburg closely, including the prefaces <i>de tempore</i>
Wolfenbüttel, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1569	6/1, pp. 151– 152	"Aber an solchen apostelntagen nach der predigt mag ein jeder seiner arbeit woll warten"; Corpus Christi explicitly abolished
Oldenburg, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1573	7/2.1, pp. 1096–1097	Michaelmas "anstadt des fests assumptionis oder himelfart Mariae als ein viergezeitenfest"; Te Deum for the harvest
Lüneburg (city), <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1575	6/1, pp. 660– 661	as Lüneburg 1564
Lippe, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1571	21, pp. 391– 392	prefaces <i>de tempore</i> only "auff den Viergezeiten Festagen" (§9)
Verden, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1606	7/1, p. 166	Trinity "hochfeyerlich"

Order	Sehling	Changes of note
Waldeck, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1556	9, pp. 272–273	Michaelmas "fur das virte heuptfest"; Good Friday "halb feierlich biß auff den mittag" (§6.1)
Kronstadt (Transylvania), <i>Agende</i> , 1547	24, p. 255	the list itself follows the Nürnberg model (§5.7, §8.3); the closing admonition is taken from the Saxon order of 1539/40

5.3 The Württemberg family: holy days proclaimed by the magistrate

The Württemberg orders make the magistrate's proclamation the mark of a holy day (§4.5). At first they drew only one clear line: the high feasts of Christ kept the whole day, and the rest kept only in the forenoon.

Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536 (Sehling 16, pp. 105–106):

Es sollen aber in unserm Fürstenthumb nachvolgende fest- und feyrtag gehalten werden: Erstlich alle Sontag, Item, alle hohe fest Christi als namlich Weyhennächt, Beschneidung, Ostertag, Auffarttag, Pfingstag. Und sollen dise tag doch auch ungefar gehalten und niemand sein gewissen damit beschwert werden [...] Weiter aber sollen all pfarrer auff nachverzeichnet tag morgens predigen und als dann dem volck anzeigen, das sich nachmittag meniglich an sein arbeit verfügen möge unnd hierinn niemandt verstrickt sein sol. Namlich auff der heiligen drey künig oder den zwölfften tag, da soll man predigen aus dem Mattheo das ander Capitel, den grünen donnerstag, den karfreitag, so man den passion prediget, unser frawen verkündung tag Annuntiationis, unnsere frawen Reynigung Purificationis, aller apostel tag, Sant Johannis des täuffers tag.

But in our principality the feasts and holy days following shall be kept: first all Sundays; item, all the high feasts of Christ, namely Christmas, the Circumcision, Easter day, Ascension day, Whitsunday. And these days also shall be kept without constraint, and no man's conscience burdened therewith [...] But further, all parsons shall preach in the morning on the days hereafter noted, and then shew the people that every man may betake himself to his work in the afternoon, and that herein no man shall be bound: namely on the day of the Three Kings or Twelfth Day, whereon shall be preached out of Matthew the second chapter; Maundy Thursday; Good Friday, when the Passion is preached; our Lady's Annunciation day; our Lady's Purification; all apostles' days; St John the Baptist's day.

Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553 (Sehling 16, p. 266). The list that follows the preamble of §4.5:

Alle Sontag Der Christag Der nächst tag darnach Der Jars tag Der öberst, Epiphania genannt Der Ostertag sampt dem nächsten darnach Die himelfart Christi Der Pfingstag sampt volgendem Montag Die Liechtmeß Purificationis Mariae Verkündigung Mariae, genannt Annuntiationis Aller Aposteln tag Joannis Baptisten

All Sundays. Christmas day. The next day after. New Year's day. Twelfth Day, called the Epiphany. Easter day with the next after. The Ascension of Christ. Whitsunday with the Monday following. Candlemas, the Purification of Mary. The Annunciation of Mary. All apostles' days. John the Baptist's.

Note. In 1553 every day on the list is a holy day, with no half days. The distinction came back in later orders of the family:

- **Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1561** added half days (§6.2).
- **Pfalz-Veldenz 1574** added half days as well (§6.2).

- **Baden 1603** has the same list but allows field-work after the morning service:

Baden, *Kirchenordnungsmandat*, 1603 (Sehling 16, p. 559):

Die Sontag seyndt aller dings stricte zufeyren undt alle Feldt- und andere arbeit einzustellen, zugleich auch die ordentliche Fest- und Aposteltag vormittag simpliciter gefeyret, nachmittag allein mit der discretion zur Feldtarbeit zugelaßen werden soll

The Sundays are to be kept holy altogether strictly, and all field-work and other labour to cease; likewise the ordinary feast days and apostles' days shall be kept holy in the forenoon without condition, and in the afternoon field-work shall be allowed only with discretion

5.4 The Bugenhagen family: "the three great feasts of Christ"

Bugenhagen's orders count feasts from the three great feasts of Christ. Each is kept three full days. The rest are "full" holy days for their Gospel histories. The apostles are commemorated on the next Sunday.

Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528 (Sehling 6/1, p. 397):

De dre groten feste Christi, de de Christene stedes hebben gehalten, alse Winachten, Paschen unde Pynxten, eyn jewelick fest dre dage vullen to vyren, darinne geprediget schal werden up den morgen, vor middage, na middage unde up den avent, darto gesungen, alse na gesecht schal werden. Darto nyejarsdach, Epiphanie, dat is der apenbaringe edder koningedach, purificationis, dat is Marien kerckgank, Marien vorkundinge, des Heren hemmelvart, Joannis Baptiste, Marien berchgank vullen to vyren, nicht umme der dage willen, sonder umme des predigens willen, dewile de historien in den evangelien begrepen synt unde bedrapen unsen Heren Christum etc. Item Michaelis vor eyn vehrtidenvest, to offeren dat vehrtidenoffer in de gemeyne schatkaste, ock vullen to vyren. [...] Der hilgen apostelen unde Magdalene unde Laurentii, des hilgen kastenheren edder diakens, gedechtnissen scholen gelecht werden up den negesten Sundach na öreme kalenderdage, also dat me vlitich predigen schal dat evangelium vamme Sundage alse up eyenen anderen Sundach unde deme jo nichts affbreken; alle sank unde misse schal ock syn vamme Sundage, alleyne amme ende des sermons schal de predicante seggen: Myne frunde in Christo, in disser weke plecht me gedenken des hilgen apostels N., van deme lest me so in evangelio, in Actis apo. etc.

The three great feasts of Christ which the Christians have always kept, as Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide, every feast to be fully kept holy three days, wherein there shall be preaching in the morning, before noon, after noon and at evening, and singing thereto, as shall be said hereafter. Thereto New Year's day, the Epiphany, that is the day of the manifestation or the Kings' day, the Purification, that is Mary's church-going, Mary's Annunciation, the Lord's Ascension, John the Baptist, Mary's going over the hills, to be fully kept holy; not for the days' sake, but for the preaching's sake, forasmuch as the histories are contained in the Gospels and concern our Lord Christ, etc. Item, Michaelmas for a feast of the four times, to offer the four-times offering into the common treasure-chest, also to be fully kept holy. [...] The memorials of the holy apostles, and of Magdalene, and of Laurence the holy chest-master or deacon, shall be laid upon the next Sunday after their calendar day; so that one shall diligently preach the Gospel of the Sunday as upon another Sunday, and take nothing at all from it; all chant and mass also shall be of the Sunday; only at the end of the sermon the preacher shall say: My friends in Christ, in this week it is wont to be remembered of the holy apostle N., of whom one readeth thus in the Gospel, in the Acts of the apostles, etc.

Note.

- **Why the apostles lost their holy day.** The editor records that Bugenhagen first meant to keep the apostles' days as feasts. He gave up the plan when it was objected that a town of craftsmen would then have too many holy days.
- **Hamburg 1529.** Hamburg has the same text (Sehling 5, p. 514).
- **Lübeck 1531.** Lübeck adds the list of the four times (§9).

Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535 (Sehling 4, p. 343):

Unde de historien van unserm leven heren Jesu Christo nicht vorgeten werden, wille wi de festa Christi alle behouden, als winachten dree dage, osteren dree dage, pinxsten dree dage, dar negest Circuncisionis, Epiphanie, Purificationis, Annunciationis, Ascensionis, Trinitatis, Johannis Baptiste to predekende, van siner entfanginge, van siner gebort, van sinem predekende unde amt, unde van siner enthovedinge, dat fest hört ock up Christum, unde de historie is ock in den evangelien geschreven. Visitationis des geliken. Item wi willen ock behouden dat fest Michaelis to predikende van den engeln ut der hiligen schrift.

And that the histories of our dear Lord Jesus Christ be not forgotten, we will keep all the feasts of Christ: as Christmas three days, Easter three days, Whitsuntide three days; next thereafter the Circumcision, the Epiphany, the Purification, the Annunciation, the Ascension, the Trinity; John the Baptist, to preach of his conception, of his birth, of his preaching and office, and of his beheading, for that feast also pertaineth to Christ, and the history is also written in the Gospels. The Visitation likewise. Item, we will also keep the feast of Michael, to preach of the angels out of holy Scripture.

Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 (Sehling 23, p. 95). The list that follows the principle quoted in §4.3:

De dre groten Feste Christi vyren wy ein ytlick dre dage lanck umme der Historien Christi willen. Darbeneven vyren wy ock dat Fest Circumcisionis, Epiphaniae, Purificationis unde Annunciationis Marie. [...] Ock vyre wy de Festa Ascensionis und Visitationis [...] Thom lesten dat fest Johannis Baptiste, Dat fest Michaelis thor dancksegginge Unde dat fest Omnium Sanctorum. Der Apostel Feste schal men apentlick affkündigen und thogelick dem feste Magdalene unde Laurentii am negst folgenden Sondage darna Predigen.

The three great feasts of Christ we keep holy each three days long, for the histories of Christ. Beside these we keep holy also the feast of the Circumcision, of the Epiphany, of the Purification and of the Annunciation of Mary. [...] We keep holy also the feasts of the Ascension and of the Visitation [...] Last of all the feast of John the Baptist, the feast of Michael for thanksgiving, and the feast of All Saints. The apostles' feasts one shall openly proclaim, and preach them, together with the feast of Magdalene and of Laurence, on the next following Sunday thereafter.

Note. The editor explains the "Festa Ascensionis" as the Assumption of Mary, on 15 August. The Danish-Holstein order of 1542 is thus one of the few Lutheran orders that keeps the Assumption as a holy day (§8.3). The Kiel draft behind it follows the Danish *Ordinatio ecclesiastica* of 1537.

5.5 Numbered classes

Some orders number their ranks outright.

Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544 (Sehling 6/2, pp. 1032–1033). Three classes are named, and each is given its reason:

VI. Von den feyertagen, welche man feyeren soll. Festum nativitatis Christi, S. Stephanstagk, des ersten merterers, S. Johannistagk, des evangelisten, der unschuldigen kinderlein tagk, weil die predigt wart, festum resurrectionis Christi, den Mondagk und auch den Dinstagk, festum Pentecostae, Pfingsten, den Mondagk und auch den Dinstagk zu feyeren, festum Michaelis archangeli. Das sind also die vier hauptfest, an welchen man den vierzeitpenning sammelt. Nun folgen andere herliche fest, die man auch feyren soll: Festum circumcisionis Domini, f. epiphaniae vel trium regum, f. purificationis Mariae, f. anuntiacionis Mariae, f. visitationis Mariae, f. ascensionis Jesu Christi, f. S. Johannis Baptistae. Das sind also andere sieben festage, die auch zum höchsten von wegen der historien zu feyren nöttig. 1. S. Andres tagk, 2. S. Thomas tagk, 3. S. Matthias tagk, 4. den grünen Donnerstagk, 5. den stillen Freytagk, 6. S. Philippi et Jacobi tagk, 7. S. Petri et Pauli tagk, 8. S. [...] Jacobs tagk, 9. S. Bartholomei tagk, 10. S. Matthäi apostoli tagk, 11. S. Simonis et Judä tagk. Diese tage der lieben heiligen und jünger unsers Hern Jesu Christi soll man vormittage alleine, weil das ampt wart, schuldig sein zu feyren.

VI. Of the holy days which shall be kept. The feast of the Nativity of Christ; St Stephen's day, of the first martyr; St John's day, of the evangelist; the day of the innocent children, while the sermon lasteth; the feast of the resurrection of Christ, the Monday and also the Tuesday; the feast of Pentecost, Whitsuntide, the Monday and also the Tuesday to be kept holy; the feast of Michael the archangel. These are therefore the four chief feasts, whereon the four-times penny is gathered. Now follow other glorious feasts, which shall also be kept holy: the feast of the Circumcision of the Lord; the feast of the Epiphany or of the Three Kings; the feast of the Purification of Mary; the feast of the Annunciation of Mary; the feast of the Visitation of Mary; the feast of the Ascension of Jesus Christ; the feast of St John the Baptist. These are therefore seven other feast days, which also are in the highest degree needful to be kept holy because of the histories. 1. St Andrew's day, 2. St Thomas's day, 3. St Matthias's day, 4. Maundy Thursday, 5. Good Friday, 6. St Philip and James's day, 7. St Peter and Paul's day, 8. St [...] James's day, 9. St Bartholomew's day, 10. St Matthew the apostle's day, 11. St Simon and Jude's day. These days of the dear saints and disciples of our Lord Jesus Christ one shall be bound to keep holy in the forenoon only, while the office lasteth.

Note. The first class is defined partly by a church payment. The four chief feasts are the days on which the four-times penny is collected (§9). The Ascension stands in the second class, and Maundy Thursday and Good Friday in the third. The editor notes that this departs from the Wolfenbüttel order of 1543, which moved the apostles' days to the next Sunday.

Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567 (Sehling 13, p. 474):

[5.] Welche fest in unserer kirchen gefeiert werden. Über die gemeinen sontäge werden mit verstand christlicher freiheit gehalten: Erstlich alle festa Christi: Nativitatis mit den folgenden zweien tagen, Circumcisionis, Epiphaniae, Purificationis, Annunciationis, Ostertag samt den zweien nachfolgenden tagen, Ascensionis, Pfingstag samt den folgenden zweien tagen. Zum andern werden gehalten alle aposteltage. Zum dritten: Johannis baptistae, Michaelis archangeli.

[5.] Which feasts are kept holy in our church. Over and above the common Sundays are kept, with understanding of Christian liberty: first, all the feasts of Christ: the Nativity with the two days following, the Circumcision, the Epiphany, the Purification, the Annunciation, Easter day with the two days next following, the Ascension, Whitsunday with the two days following. Secondly are kept all the apostles' days. Thirdly: John the Baptist, Michael the archangel.

Note. Regensburg's numbering is an order of listing, not of dignity. Communion and first vespers, which mark the rank in this order, are given only "an festen Christi, allen und jeden", on each and every feast of Christ (p. 475; see §10.10).

Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571 (Sehling 6/2, p. 1186). Four ranks, the fourth being the abolished Assumption:

Die vier hohen fest belangende, ordnen wir, das Weynachten, Ostern, Pfingsten mit den zweyen folgenden tagen sollen geruhet, gefeyert und mit übung göttliches worts zugebracht werden. Dieweil aber das fest der himelfart Mariae ohne grund und gezeugnis der schrift durch den antichrist eingefüret ist, sol es in unser graffschaft hiemit ganz abgethan sein und seiner hinfüro nicht gedacht werden. Wir ordnen aber anstadt desselben das fest S. Michaelis und wollen, das die pfarrkinder den tag feyerlich halten, auch ihrem pastorn an demselben tage ihr opfer und gebürliche pflicht gütlich entrichten und ohne hindernis dargeben sollen. Zum andern ordnen wir, das nachgeschriebene und verzeichnete fest und tage in unser herrschaft genzlich geruhet, gefeyret und geheiligt werden sollen, als des neuen jhars tag, der heiligen drey könig tag, das festum purificationis Mariae, verkündigung Mariae, der himelfart Christi, Johannis des teufers tag, visitationis Mariae, der tag coenae Domini, an welchem man vom h. nachtmal predigen sol, den Kahrfreytag [...] Zum dritten ordnen wir, das man nachgesetzte apostel- und heiligtage, biß die sernnon geendet, feyren sol: als Andreae Thomae bekerung Pauli Matthiae Petri et Pauli Philippi et Jacobi Magdalenen Jacobi Bartholomaei decollationis Johannis Matthaee Simonis et Judae aller heiligen tag.

As touching the four high feasts, we ordain that Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide, with the two days following, shall be rested, kept holy, and spent in the exercise of God's Word. But forasmuch as the feast of the Ascension of Mary was brought in by the Antichrist without ground and witness of Scripture, it shall hereby be wholly done away in our county, and no more be mentioned henceforth. But in the stead thereof we ordain the feast of St Michael, and will that the parishioners keep the day solemnly, and also render to their pastor on the same day their offering and due duty kindly and without hindrance. Secondly we ordain that the feasts and days hereafter written and set down shall in our lordship be wholly rested, kept holy and hallowed: as New Year's day, the day of the Three Kings, the feast of the Purification of Mary, the Annunciation of Mary, the Ascension of Christ, John the Baptist's day, the Visitation of Mary, the day of the Lord's Supper, whereon one shall preach of the holy Supper, Good Friday [...] Thirdly we ordain that the apostles' and saints' days hereafter set shall be kept holy until the sermon be ended: as Andrew, Thomas, the Conversion of Paul, Matthias, Peter and Paul, Philip and James, Magdalene, James, Bartholomew, the Beheading of John, Matthew, Simon and Jude, All Saints' day.

Harlingerland (East Frisia), *Kirchenordnung*, 1573/74 (Sehling 7/1, pp. 735–736). This is Hoya's text, divided into titled *Sectiones*:

Der eilfte articull. Von den festen. Sectio prima. Von den vier zeiten. Die vier hohen festtage belangende, ordnen wir auch, daß Wihnachten, Paschen, Pfingsten mit den zween folgenden tagen sollen gerouwet, gefyret und mit öving deß gottlichen wordeß geheiligt werden. Von der himmelfahrt Mariae. Dieweile daß fest ohne grund und gezeugniß der schrift durch dem antechrist ist angerichtet, soll idt ganz abgetaen sein und seiner nit gedacht werden. Ordnen derohalben, daß der [!] letzte und vierte hochfesttagzeit solle S. Michaelis tag sein. [...] Sectio secunda. Von den fürnembsten festtagen. [...] Sectio tertia. Von den aposteltagen. Ordnen wir, daß man undergeschriebene aposteltage, beht der sermön geendiget, führen solle

The eleventh article. Of the feasts. Section the first. Of the four times. As touching the four high feast days, we ordain also that Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide, with the two days following, shall be rested, kept holy and hallowed with the exercise of the divine Word. Of the Ascension of Mary. Forasmuch as that feast was set up by the Antichrist without ground and witness of the Scripture, it shall be wholly done away and not be mentioned. We ordain therefore that the last and fourth high feast-tide shall be St Michael's day. [...] Section

the second. Of the chiefest feast days. [...] Section the third. Of the apostles' days. We ordain that the apostles' days underwritten shall be kept holy until the sermon be ended

Sayn, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1582 (Sehling 19/1, p. 368). Four classes, set out as a principle before the list. The margin heads the paragraph *Festa quadrupli*:

Unndt konden die festen durch gantze jahr in vierley artt oder unterschiedliche hauffe getheilt werden: 1. Etzliche festa, das seind haubtfesta also zu nennen, die man solenniter den gantzen tag feiern unndt darauff die gemeine wochentliche arbeit soll underlaßen werden. 2. Die ander seind nur mittelmeßige festa, die da halb gefeiret werden also unndt der gestalt, das man vormittag zur kirchen komme, predigt haltte unndt hör, nach mittag aber in wochentlicher arbeit vortfahre. 3. Die dritte festag könnenn ohn nachteil unndt ergernus verlegt unndt auffgehoben werden auf den gemeinen bettag, so sonst in der wochen zur predigt deputirt unndt geordenet ist. 4. Die viertten festtage, so zu bestettigung öffentlicher abgotterei im bapstumb eingeführt unndt gehalten worden, sollen in unserm evangelischen kirchen gar abgeschafft unndt underlaßen werden.

And the feasts through the whole year might be divided into four kinds or several companies:

1. Some feasts are to be called chief feasts, which men shall keep holy solemnly the whole day, and whereon the common weekly work shall be left off. 2. The others are but middling feasts, which are kept half holy, in this wise and manner, that men come to church in the forenoon, hold and hear a sermon, but in the afternoon go on in the weekly work. 3. The third feast days may without hurt and offence be removed and taken up upon the common day of prayer, which otherwise is deputed and ordained in the week for preaching. 4. The fourth feast days, which were brought in and kept in the papacy for the confirming of open idolatry, shall in our evangelical churches be wholly done away and left off.

The list attached to it (pp. 372–373):

Hauptvesta, so den gantzen tagh feierlich gehalten undt daruff die gemeine wochentliche arbeit soll underlassen werdenn. Der heilige christagh. S. Stephani tagh. S. Joannis tag vormittagh. Der neue jars tag vor- und nachmittagh. Epiphania Domini oder der heiligen drey konig tag. Purificationis Mariae oder liechtmeß. Annunciationis Mariae oder conceptionis christi, welches fest, so es in der marterwoch oder nach ostern gefelt, sol es auf den sonabend palmarum stets gelegt werden. Der ostertag sampt den zweien nachfolgenden, montag und dienstagh. Der himelfartstag Christi durch auß. Der pfingstag und beide folgende, montag und dinstag in pfingsten. Das fest der heiligen dreyfaltigkeit, so allwege acht tage nach pfingsten volget. [...] Der tag Johannis des täuffers. S. Michaels tag, dar man pfleget von den h. engeln zu predigen und gott fur den guten schutz der guten geister zu dancken. Nachfolgende tage werden nur halb gefeiret also und der gestalt, das man vor mittage zur kirchen komme, predigt halte und hore, nach mittag aber in wochentlicher arbeit fortfahre. Alle apostel tage sollen gehalten werden, wen undt wie sie des jars fallen, doch allein mit einer predigt vormittag halb feierlich. Der aposteln tage sollen gleich geachtet und fur halbe feiertag gerechnet werden: Der grüne donnerstag [...] Der charfreitag [...] Pauli bekehrungstag umb der furtreflichen historien willen. Mariae visitationis oder heimsuchungfest. Diese folgende und dergleichen tage mogen auf denn verordneten bettagen in der wochen gelegt werden, als: S. Laurentii tagh. S. Marci, des evangelisten. S. Lucas, des evangelisten. [...] Vincula Petri. Decollationis Joannis Baptistae. [...] Aller heyiligen, omnium sanctorum. Mariae Magdalenen fest umb der schonen text und historien willen, so daruf zue handeln verordnet, damit [sie] in gedechtnus bleiben. Unten verzeichnete tag sollen gar abgeschafft und underlaßen werden, als die da zur abgotterey und aberglauben anleitung und vorschub geben. Alle Marienfest, sie haben nahmen wie sie wollen, welche hiebevorn nicht benennet worden. Sonderlich aber festum conceptionis,

nativitatis, praesentationis, assumptionis Mariae sollen in unsern evangelischen kirchen gar auffgehoben und abe sein

Chief feasts, which shall be kept solemnly the whole day, and whereon the common weekly work shall be left off. The holy Christmas day. St Stephen's day. St John's day in the forenoon. New Year's day, before and after noon. The Epiphany of the Lord, or the day of the Three Kings. The Purification of Mary, or Candlemas. The Annunciation of Mary, or Conception of Christ; which feast, if it fall in the week of the Passion or after Easter, shall always be laid on the Saturday before Palm Sunday. Easter day with the two following, Monday and Tuesday. The day of the Ascension of Christ, throughout. Whitsunday and both the following, Monday and Tuesday in Whitsuntide. The feast of the holy Trinity, which followeth always eight days after Pentecost. [...] The day of John the Baptist. St Michael's day, whereon men are wont to preach of the holy angels and to thank God for the good protection of the good spirits. The days following are kept but half holy, in this wise and manner, that men come to church before noon, hold and hear a sermon, but in the afternoon go on in the weekly work. All apostles' days shall be kept, when and as they fall in the year, yet only with one sermon in the forenoon, half holy. With the apostles' days shall be counted alike, and reckoned for half holy days: Maundy Thursday [...] Good Friday [...] St Paul's conversion day, for the excellent history's sake. The feast of Mary's Visitation. These days following, and the like, may be laid on the appointed days of prayer in the week: as St Laurence's day; St Mark the evangelist's; St Luke the evangelist's; [...] Peter's Chains; the Beheading of John the Baptist; [...] All Saints; Mary Magdalene's feast, for the sake of the fair text and history appointed to be handled thereon, that [they] may remain in remembrance. The days noted beneath shall be wholly done away and left off, as those that give occasion and furtherance to idolatry and superstition: all feasts of Mary, be their names what they will, which have not been named heretofore; but in especial the feasts of the Conception, Nativity, Presentation and Assumption of Mary shall in our evangelical churches be wholly taken up and be gone

Note. This is the fullest four-rank system in the corpus. The Sayn *Kirchenordnung* of 1590 (Sehling 19/1, p. 389) later reduced it to a single list of holy days, with the harvest apostles kept in the forenoon only (§6.4).

Aschersleben, Kirchen-Agenda, 1575 (Sehling 2, p. 479). The town agenda has a middle rank of eight feasts over and above the three chief feasts:

Über die drei heubtfeste, sollen auch in dieser christlichen gemeinde diese nachfolgende gehalten werden. 1. Circumcisionis domini. 2. Epiphania domini. 3. Purificationis Mariae. 4. Annunciationis Mariae. 5. Ascensionis domini. 6. Johannis baptistae. 7. Visitationis Mariae, 8. Michaelis. In diesen festen soll es durchaus, wie an sonntagen gehalten werden, allein das mit singen und predigen auf die fest gesehen und figurirt werde. [...] Von den festis apostolorum. Andreae, Thomae, Matthiae, Philippi Jacobi, Petri et Pauli, Jacobi, Bartholomaei, Matthaee, Simonis et Judae: Sollen in unser gemeine fruehe eine predigt und das officium gehalten werden vormittage alleine. Die arbeitsleute aber mögen ein jeder seiner hantierung warten

Over and above the three chief feasts, these following shall also be kept in this Christian congregation: 1. The Circumcision of the Lord. 2. The Epiphany of the Lord. 3. The Purification of Mary. 4. The Annunciation of Mary. 5. The Ascension of the Lord. 6. John the Baptist. 7. The Visitation of Mary. 8. Michael. On these feasts it shall be done throughout as on Sundays; only that in singing and preaching regard be had to the feast, and that figural music be used. [...] Of the feasts of the apostles. Andrew, Thomas, Matthias, Philip and James, Peter and Paul, James, Bartholomew, Matthew, Simon and Jude: in our congregation there shall be held early a sermon and the office, before noon only. But the working people may each attend to his handiwork

5.6 Great feasts and small feasts: Danzig and Thorn

In Danzig the rank of a feast was marked above all by the bells (§10.8). The church fathers of St Mary's set down the custom in 1612. Article 16 lists every feast of the year as *ein gross fest* or *ein klein fest*.

Danzig, St Mary's, *Kirchenordnung*, 1612 (Sehling 4, pp. 203–204):

Art. 14. Vom beigern auf die grossen feste. Wan ein gross fest einfellet, welches allezeit mit drei predigten gehalten wird, alsdan wird des tages zuvor vormittage geleutet, wie sonst auf den tag in der woche gebreuchlich. [...] Art. 15. Wie man auf die kleinen feste beigert. Auf die kleinen feste, welche allzeit nur mit einer predigt gehalten werden, es sei dan, das etwa eines auf einen sonntag einfeilet, oder vom sonntage dahin verlegt wird, alsdann wird des tages zuvor nach mittage, wen es eins geschlagen hat, mit der Dominical und Apostolica gebeigert und mit der Osanna darein geleutet und dis heisset man mit der Osanna beiern [...] Art. 16. Namen der grossen und kleinen feste, nach dem lauf des jahres, an welchem man beigert.

Art. 14. Of chiming for the great feasts. When a great feast falleth, which is always kept with three sermons, then on the day before it is rung in the forenoon as is otherwise used on a day in the week. [...] Art. 15. How one chimeth for the small feasts. For the small feasts, which are always kept with one sermon only, unless one of them fall on a Sunday, or be removed thither from the Sunday, then on the day before, in the afternoon, when it hath struck one, it is chimed with the Dominical and the Apostolica, and rung in with the Osanna; and this is called chiming with the Osanna [...] Art. 16. The names of the great and small feasts, according to the course of the year, whereon one chimeth.

The Danzig list of 1612 (Art. 16, p. 204). It is condensed here from the two-column print. The first entry, a small feast before Epiphany, has lost its name in the digitized text.

Great feasts (<i>ein gross fest</i>)	Small feasts (<i>ein klein fest</i>)
Epiphany; Purification; Annunciation; Easter day, Easter Monday, Easter Tuesday ("mit einer predigt"); Ascension; Whitsunday, Whit Monday, Whit Tuesday ("mit einer predigt"); Trinity; Visitation ("mit predigt"); Christmas, St Stephen, St John the Evangelist ("mit 1 predigt")	Matthias; Philip and James; John the Baptist; Peter and Paul; James; Bartholomew; Matthew; Michaelmas ("mit 3 predigten ... ein klein fest"); Simon and Jude; Andrew; Thomas

Two entries on the list are "no feast". The Dominicans' day (5 August) and St Laurence's day are rung with the great bell to open and close the town's market, and the list says of Laurence: "ist kein fest".

Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575 (Sehling 4, p. 239). This order sets the same two ranks in prose, and also speaks of the "small or half feasts":

Alle feste unsers herrn und erlösers, als nemlich nativitat Christi, circumcissionis, epiphaniae, purificationis, annunciationis, coenae dominicae, parasceves, paschae, ascensionis et pentecostes sollen so wohl ordentlich als ehrlich und mit grossem ernst, gebührlicher reverenz zum gedächtniss und vermahnung gehalten werden, sonderlich weinachten, ostern und pfingsten drei tage nacheinander: die ersten zwei tage mit dreien predigten wie sonst am sonntage; am dritten tage, wo er nicht auf einen sonntage gefällt, mit zween predigten [...] Belangende aber die feste oder feiertagen conversionis Pauli, Johannis Baptistae, visitationis Mariae, Michaelis, samt den zwölf aposteltagen, sollen mit zwei predigten gehalten werden [...] wann aber solche kleine oder halbe feste auf einen sonntag kommen,

mögen dieselben wohl auf den folgenden tag, nemlich auf den sonntag, verleget und zur vesper gehalten werden.

All the feasts of our Lord and Redeemer, namely the Nativity of Christ, the Circumcision, the Epiphany, the Purification, the Annunciation, the Supper of the Lord, the Preparation, Easter, the Ascension and Pentecost, shall be kept as well orderly as honourably, and with great earnestness and due reverence, for remembrance and admonition; in especial Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide three days one after another: the first two days with three sermons, as otherwise on the Sunday; on the third day, where it fall not on a Sunday, with two sermons [...] But touching the feasts or holy days of the Conversion of Paul, of John the Baptist, of the Visitation of Mary, of Michael, together with the twelve apostles' days, they shall be kept with two sermons [...] but when such small or half feasts come upon a Sunday, the same may well be removed to the following day, namely to the Sunday [afternoon], and be kept at vespers.

Note. The sentence "auf den folgenden tag, nemlich auf den sonntag" is confused in the print. The meaning, as the next sentence shows, is that a small feast falling near a Sunday is handled at the Sunday vespers. Compare §11.

5.7 Wider calendars: the conservative orders

A number of orders keep much more than the pattern of §5.1. Some are early, and some come from princes who were cautious about change. They show where the Lutheran lists started from.

Brandenburg (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540 (Sehling 3, p. 87):

Folgen die festa, so furnemlich in unsern landen, ausserhalb der sontage, gehalten und gefeiert werden sollen. Nemlich: Der Christtag. Der tag Stefani. Der tag Johannis Evangeliste. Des neuen jarstag oder Circumcisionis domini. Der heiligen dreier könig tag. Der tag Purificationis Marie. Der tag Matthie Apostoli. Der tag Annunciationis Marie. Der Ostertag. Ostermontag. Der tag Philippi et Jacobi. Ascensionis domini oder himelfart Christi. Der Pfingsttag. Montag. Dinstag. Der sontag Trinitatis. Der tag Corporis Christi. Der tag Johannis Baptiste. Der tag Petri und Pauli. Der tag Visitationis Marie. Der tag Marie Magdalene. Der tag Jacobi. Der tag Assumptionis Marie. Der tag Bartholomei. Der tag Nativitatis Marie. Der tag Matthei Apostoli. Der tag Simonis et Jude. Der tag Omnium Sanctorum. Der tag Martini. Der tag Andree. Der tag Laurentii. Der tag' Michaelis.

There follow the feasts which, besides the Sundays, shall chiefly be kept and held holy in our lands. Namely: Christmas day. St Stephen's day. St John the Evangelist's day. New Year's day, or the Circumcision of the Lord. The day of the Three Kings. The day of the Purification of Mary. The day of Matthias the apostle. The day of the Annunciation of Mary. Easter day. Easter Monday. The day of Philip and James. The Ascension of the Lord. Whitsunday. Monday. Tuesday. Trinity Sunday. The day of Corpus Christi. The day of John the Baptist. The day of Peter and Paul. The day of the Visitation of Mary. The day of Mary Magdalene. The day of James. The day of the Assumption of Mary. The day of Bartholomew. The day of the Nativity of Mary. The day of Matthew the apostle. The day of Simon and Jude. All Saints' day. St Martin's day. St Andrew's day. St Laurence's day. St Michael's day.

Note. The list goes on with Catherine and Thomas. It is a single rank that keeps Corpus Christi, the Assumption, the Nativity of Mary, All Saints, Martin, Laurence and Catherine. It matches the conservative character of the Brandenburg order as a whole.

Anhalt, Nicolaus Hausmann's order, 1532 (Sehling 2, p. 542). An early, one-rank list with the apostles already reduced to the forenoon:

Festa im jar sollen frei gehalten werden, zum exempel des glaubens zu uben, damit das junge und grobe volk gemussiget mügen zur prediget kommen [...] und sint mit namen dise: Nativitas Christi mit zweien tagen. Neu jar, circumcisionis. Epiphanie, wilchs heist drei könig. Purificationis Christi et Marie. Annunciacionis Christi. Pascha mit zweien tagen, ostern. Ascensionis, himmelfart Christi. Pentecostes, pfingsten mit zwei tagen. Corporis Christi, des heiligen warlichnames tag. Johannis baptiste. Visitacionis, conceptionis Marie. Magdalene. Marie. Laurencii. Assumpcionis Nativitatis Michaelis. Omnium sanctorum. Martini. Aller apostel tage fur mittage.

The feasts in the year shall be kept free, for the exercise of faith, that the young and rude people may be at leisure to come to the sermon [...] and they are these by name: the Nativity of Christ with two days; New Year, the Circumcision; the Epiphany, which is called Three Kings; the Purification of Christ and of Mary; the Annunciation of Christ; Pascha with two days, Easter; the Ascension, the ascending of Christ; Pentecost, Whitsuntide with two days; Corpus Christi, the day of the holy true Body; John the Baptist; the Visitation, the Conception of Mary; Magdalene; Mary; Laurence; the Assumption; the Nativity; Michael; All Saints; Martin; all apostles' days in the forenoon.

Pfalz-Neuburg, Kirchenordnung, 1543 (Sehling 13, p. 94). The editor places this list between Brandenburg 1540 and Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533:

so wöllen wir, das dise nachfolgende fest und feirtag, wie vor alters her, noch gehalten und gefeiret werden - doch, damit die andern tag der gedechtnus Christi und der rechten, waren heiligen, so in der heiligen schrift oder sonst irs christlichen glaubens, lebens, wunderwerk, leidens und seligen absterbens gewise zeugnus haben, nicht aufgehebt noch in vergessen gestellt, sonder ungefeiret in gedechtnus, wie vor alters her, lassen bleiben. Die fest, so man feiern sol. Der Neujarstag, Circumcisionis genannt, der Oberstag, Epiphaniae genannt, Lichtmeß, Purificationis Mariae genannt, Matthie des zwölf boten, Verkündung, Annunciationis Mariae genannt, der Palmtag, der Ostertag mit montag und aftermontag darnach, Philippi und Jacobi der zwölf boten, der Auffartstag, Ascensionis Domini genannt, der Pfingstag mit montag und aftermontag darnach, der Heiligen Dreifeltigkeit, Trinitatis genannt, Johannis des taulers, Petri und Pauli der zwölf boten, Jacobi des zwölf boten, Unser Frauen schidung, Assumptionis genannt

so will we that these following feasts and holy days be yet kept and held holy, as of old; yet so that the other days of the remembrance of Christ, and of the right and true saints who have sure witness in holy Scripture or otherwise of their Christian faith, life, miracles, suffering and blessed departing, be not taken away nor put in forgetfulness, but let remain unhallowed in remembrance, as of old. The feasts that shall be kept holy: New Year's day, called the Circumcision; Twelfth Day, called the Epiphany; Candlemas, called the Purification of Mary; Matthias the twelve-messenger; the Annunciation, called the Annunciation of Mary; Palm Sunday; Easter day with the Monday and the Tuesday after; Philip and James the twelve-messengers; Ascension day, called the Ascension of the Lord; Whitsunday with the Monday and the Tuesday after; the Holy Trinity, called Trinity; John the Baptist; Peter and Paul the twelve-messengers; James the twelve-messenger; our Lady's departing, called the Assumption

Note. This order makes a second rank of its own: days that are "unhallowed in remembrance" (*ungefeiret in gedechtnus*). Their memory is kept, but they are not holy days.

Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537 (Sehling 10, p. 74). This order keeps Corpus Christi, as a day to teach the right use of the Sacrament, and keeps the Assumption and the Nativity of Mary. The summer feasts are moved to Sunday for the harvest (§6.4, §8.9).

Teschen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1584 (Sehling 3, p. 461). One of the longest lists in the corpus:

IX. Welche fest man halten soll. Über die gemeine sontage sollen gehalten und feierlich begangen werden die hohen hauptfest unsers christlichen glaubens, darmitte dieselbe dem gemeinen volk mit vleiss vorgetragen und eingebildet werden. Als nemlichen den tag Nativitatis Christi sampt dem anderen und drietten fest, den tag Circumcisionis Domini, Epipha., Conversionis Pauli, Purificationis Mariae, Mathiae Apost., Annunciationis Mariae, gruen donnerstag, charfreitag, der ostertag sampt dem nachfolgenden und drietten fest, Philippi et Jacobi, hiemmelfahrt Christi, pfingsten mit nachfolgenden feiertagen, demnach der heiligen dreifaltigkeit, Mariae gebuert, Johannis Baptistae, Petri et Pauli, Visitationis Mariae, Mariae Magdalene, Jacobi Apost., Transfigurationis Domini, Bartholomei Apostoli, Decolationis Joannis, Mathei, Michaelis Arch., Simonis et Judae, Andreae Apostoli, Martini et Catharinae. An diesen beruerten festen mag man nach gelegenheit der zeit biessweilen alleine den vormittag feiern und nachmittag widerum ein jeder seines beruefs und handarbeit warten

IX. Which feasts shall be kept. Over and above the common Sundays shall be kept and solemnly celebrated the high chief feasts of our Christian faith, that the same may be diligently set forth and imprinted on the common people: namely the day of the Nativity of Christ with the second and third feast; the day of the Circumcision of the Lord; the Epiphany; the Conversion of Paul; the Purification of Mary; Matthias the apostle; the Annunciation of Mary; Maundy Thursday; Good Friday; Easter day with the following and third feast; Philip and James; the Ascension of Christ; Whitsuntide with the following holy days; thereafter the holy Trinity; the Nativity of Mary; John the Baptist; Peter and Paul; the Visitation of Mary; Mary Magdalene; James the apostle; the Transfiguration of the Lord; Bartholomew the apostle; the Beheading of John; Matthew; Michael the archangel; Simon and Jude; Andrew the apostle; Martin and Catherine. On these aforesaid feasts one may, as the season serveth, sometimes keep holy the forenoon only, and in the afternoon every man attend again to his calling and handiwork

Note. Every day in Teschen is formally a "high chief feast". The real ranking is left to the season: in time of work any of them may be a half day.

Weißenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528 (Sehling 11, p. 662):

Die fürnemsten fest und feiertäg aber weren dise: alle sonetag, aller apostl tag, den Cristag mit sambt sant Steffans tag und sant Joanes tag dofuer und in einen tag gefeiert, den Neuen jaerstag, der heiligen Dreikönigtag, Marie Liechmeß oder Rainigung, Marie Verkündung, Ostern und den montag henach, Auffart Christi, Pfingstag und montag hernach, Johannis des taufers, Marie Heimsuchung, Marie Himelfahrt, Marie Magdalene, sant Michael und Allerheiligen tag.

But the chiefest feasts and holy days should be these: all Sundays; all the apostles' days; Christmas, together with St Stephen's day and St John's day, kept holy therefor and in one day; New Year's day; the Three Kings' day; Mary's Candlemas or Purification; Mary's Annunciation; Easter and the Monday after; the Ascension of Christ; Whitsunday and the Monday after; John the Baptist; Mary's Visitation; Mary's Assumption; Mary Magdalene; St Michael; and All Saints' day.

6. Whole holy days and half holy days

In practice the most important mark of rank was civil: whether a day was a holy day for the whole of it, for the forenoon only, or not at all. Many orders give the working population this information in the form of a list of "whole" and "half" days, to be declared from the pulpit on the Sunday before. The half holy day, kept "until noon" or "until the sermon is ended", is the Lutheran successor of the late-medieval distinction between *feſta fori* and lesser feasts. It is also the chief place where economic pressure (harvest, markets, craftsmen's work) shaped the calendar.

6.1 The half holy day: "until noon"

The form appears as early as Nicolaus Hausmann's Anhalt order of 1532, with "aller apostel tage fur mittage" (§5.7). It is then fixed by the Saxon order of 1539 and by Mecklenburg 1552 (both in §5.2): a sermon in the forenoon, communion if there are communicants, and work after noon. Other examples:

Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568 (Sehling 4, p. 87):

Die aposteltage sollen hinfürder auch, aber allein vormittag gefeiret werden, die pfarrkinder der alten wahren apostolischen lehr in den verordneten evangelien, item der heiligen apostel ihres glaubens und guten exempels erinnert und berichtet werden [...] Wann die predig geschehen und das heilige abendmahl (so ferne communicanten sind) gehalten ist, soll jedermann diese tage nachmittag zu arbeiten frei sein. Es sollen aber die pfarrherren allezeit den nechsten sonntag zuvor die festa und aposteltag verkündigen und anzeigen, auf welchen tag in der wochen dieselbigen gefallen und das der aposteltag nicht lenger dann vormittag soll gefeiret werden, damit sich ein jeder hausvater habe darnach zu richten etc.

The apostles' days shall henceforth also be kept holy, but only in the forenoon, and the parishioners be reminded and instructed, in the appointed Gospels, of the old true apostolic doctrine, and also of the holy apostles' faith and good example [...] When the sermon hath been held and the holy Supper (in so far as there be communicants) celebrated, every man shall be free to work on these days in the afternoon. But the parsons shall always, on the next Sunday before, proclaim and shew the feasts and apostles' days, on what day in the week the same fall, and that the apostles' day shall be kept holy no longer than the forenoon, that every householder may order himself thereafter, etc.

Osnabrück (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 (Sehling 7/1, p. 259). The city had sermons five times a week, and so needed "no special holy days":

Dewyle nu der wecken viiffmal geprediket wert baven die sondagesprediken, so bedarve wy nener besondern virdagen, damit men dem gemeinem volke nicht orsake geve to lediggande und in de kröge to gan und de tidt unnütlicken tobringen etc. Idt schall ock neen fest edder hillig dag geholden werden dann allene, dat man Gades wort predicken höre und Gott bidde und danke vor syne genade dorch Christum. De aposteldage sollen gefyret wurden wente to middage.

Now forasmuch as there is preaching five times in the week beside the Sunday sermons, we need no special holy days, that we give not the common people occasion to go idle, and to go into the taverns, and to spend the time unprofitably, etc. Neither shall any feast or holy day be kept save only that men may hear God's Word preached, and pray to God and thank him for his grace through Christ. The apostles' days shall be kept holy until noon.

Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 (Sehling 9, pp. 272–273). The half day extends even to Good Friday:

der tag des leidens Christi, so der carfreitag genennet wirdt, soll halb feierlich biß auff den mittag gehalten werden, des abents aber die sepultura Christi verhandelt werden [...] Diese vorgeschriebene Feiertage ausserhalb den außgezogenen sollen gantz unnd durchauß gefeieret unnd dem Volck allwege des Sontags zuvor verkündiget werden [...] S. Petri [und] Pauli, S. Jacobi, S. Bartholomei tag sol man vor mittag heylig halten, dem volck eyne predigt thun und darnach an ire arbeyt gehen lassen

the day of the Passion of Christ, which is called Good Friday, shall be kept half holy until noon, but in the evening the burial of Christ shall be handled [...] These holy days aforewritten, beside those excepted, shall be kept holy wholly and throughout, and be proclaimed to the people always on the Sunday before [...] St Peter and Paul's, St James's and St Bartholomew's day one shall keep holy before noon, make the people a sermon, and thereafter let them go to their work

Note. Waldeck's text is printed by the editor with a second recension set into the apparatus, and the two are not always easy to separate. In the other recension Michaelmas is kept "fur das virte heuptfest", as the fourth chief feast (p. 272).

6.2 Tables of whole and half holy days

From the 1560s the orders of the Harz counties and of the Rhine and Main set out the whole and half days in formal lists.

Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*, 1580 (Sehling 2, pp. 239–240):

Von gemeinen festen. Weil auch aus ungleichem halten der festage, viel unrichtigkeit einfellet, so sollen die pfarherren wissen, welche feiertage in dieser grafschaft ganz, welche aber nur halb gehalten werden. Diese nachfolgende fest helt man den ganzen tag durchaus feierlich. Den christag, sampt den zweien folgenden tagen, Stephani und Johannis. Den neuen jars tag. Den tag der offenbarung Christi, den man den tag der heiligen drei könige nennet. Den tag der reinigung Mariae. Den tag der verkündigung Mariae. Den ostertag, mit den zweien folgenden tagen. Den tag , der himmelfart Christi. Den tag der heiligen pfingsten, mit den zweien nechst folgenden tagen. Den tag Johannis des teufers. Den tag visitationis Mariae. Den tag Michaelis. [...] Nachfolgende tage werden nur halb gefeiert. Der tag S. Andreae. Der tag des apostels S. Thomae. Der tag der bekerung S. Pauli. Der tag des apostels Matthiae. Der grüne donnerstag. Der charfreitag. Der tag Philippi Jacobi. Der tag Petri und Pauli. S. Jacobus tag. S. Laurentii tag. Der tag Bartholomei. Der tag Matthei. Der tag Simonis und Judae.

Of common feasts. Forasmuch also as much disorder ariseth from the unequal keeping of the feast days, the parsons shall know which holy days in this county are kept wholly, and which but half. These feasts following are kept holy the whole day throughout: Christmas day, together with the two days following, Stephen and John; New Year's day; the day of the manifestation of Christ, which is called the day of the Three Kings; the day of the Purification of Mary; the day of the Annunciation of Mary; Easter day, with the two days following; the day of the Ascension of Christ; the day of holy Whitsuntide, with the two days next following; the day of John the Baptist; the day of the Visitation of Mary; the day of Michael. [...] The days following are kept but half holy: the day of St Andrew; the day of the apostle St Thomas; the day of the conversion of St Paul; the day of the apostle Matthias; Maundy Thursday; Good Friday; the day of Philip and James; the day of Peter and Paul; St James's day; St Laurence's day; the day of Bartholomew; the day of Matthew; the day of Simon and Jude.

Wintzingerode (Gericht Bodenstein), *Kirchen-Ordnung* (after the Hohnstein order; undated; Sehling 2, p. 256). The whole days (the same list as Mansfeld) are graded again by sermons:

Und soll auf einen jeden tag zweimal gepredigt und von allerhand arbeit denselben ganzen tag stille gehalten werden. Auf den dritten tag der treien hauptfeste als auf Johannistag, in den heiligen weinachten, auf den oster und pfingst dinstag soll nur ein mal gepredigt werden. Nachfolgende tage werden nur halb gefeiert: Der tag des apostels S. Andreae. Der tag des apostels S. Thomae. Der tag der bekerung S. Pauli. Der tag des apostels S. Matthiae. Der grüne donnerstag. Der charfreitag. Der tag Philippi Jacobi. Der tag Petri und Pauli. Der tag Mariae Magdalenae. Der tag S. Jacobi. Der tag Bartholomaei. Der tag Mathaei. Der tag Simonis, und Judae. [...] Es sollen auch allezeit die fest und aposteltage den sonntag zuvor, darmit sich das volk darnach zu richten, vorkündiget und abgesaget, darneben vormeldet, welche ganz und welche halb solen gefeiert werden.

And on every such day there shall be preaching twice, and rest kept from all manner of work the same whole day. On the third day of the three chief feasts, as on St John's day in holy Christmas, and on the Easter and Whitsun Tuesday, there shall be preaching but once. The days following are kept but half holy: the day of the apostle St Andrew; the day of the apostle St Thomas; the day of the conversion of St Paul; the day of the apostle St Matthias; Maundy Thursday; Good Friday; the day of Philip and James; the day of Peter and Paul; the day of Mary Magdalene; the day of St James; the day of Bartholomew; the day of Matthew; the day of Simon and Jude. [...] Also the feasts and apostles' days shall always be proclaimed and bidden on the Sunday before, that the people may order themselves thereafter, and withal it shall be declared which shall be kept wholly and which half.

Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Feiertagsordnung*, 1561 (Sehling 18, pp. 297–298). The duchy's *Statthalter* and councillors clarify the church order of 1557, which had been read in different ways:

Nemlich also, daß hinfurther nachvollgennde Feyrtag fur hohe fest zuhallten, die gleich den Sonntagen vor- unnd nachmittag sollend gefeyret werdenn, als: [...] 1. Nativitatis, daß ist der Christag. 2. Circumcisionis, die beschneidung Christi. 3. Epiphaniae, daß ist der hailigen drei König tag. 4. Purificationis, daß ist der tag der opfferung Christi. 5. Annuntiationis, der tag, da Christus inn der Jungkfrauen leib empfangen ist wordenn. 6. Caene Domini, der Grun Donnerstag. 7. Passionis Domini, der Charfreitag. 8. Ascensionis Domini, daß ist die Himmelfarth Christi. Waß aber die uberigen gemeine feyrtag, alsda seindt der Apostell tag, Nemlich Sanct Mathias, Philippi Jacobi, Petri unnd Pauli, [...] Andree und Thomastag, item S. Johannstag, Visitationis Marie, S. Michelstag [...] und die zween vollgennde nach dem Christag, Ostern unnd Pfingsten belanngt, an denen soll hinfurther allain morgents vor mittag Gottes Wortt verkundigt werdenn. Doch dergestalt, daß ann solchen tagen vor mittag bei straff zehen gulden niemandts erlaubt seie, felldt [...] oder anndere arbaitt anzufahen, auch sein Kram oder laden nit auffzuthun oder dergleichen ettwas zuhandtieren, die Predig seie dann beschehen. Nach gethaner Predig aber soll niemandt zufeyren gezwungen, sonnder allßdann jederman zuarbaitten erlaubt sein.

Namely thus: that henceforth the holy days following are to be kept for high feasts, which shall be kept holy like the Sundays before and after noon, to wit: [...] 1. The Nativity, that is, Christmas day. 2. The Circumcision, the circumcising of Christ. 3. The Epiphany, that is, the holy Three Kings' day. 4. The Purification, that is, the day of the offering of Christ. 5. The Annunciation, the day whereon Christ was conceived in the Virgin's womb. 6. The Supper of the Lord, Maundy Thursday. 7. The Passion of the Lord, Good Friday. 8. The Ascension of the Lord, that is, Christ's going up to heaven. But as touching the other common holy days, which are the apostles' days, namely St Matthias, Philip and James, Peter and Paul, [...] Andrew's and Thomas's day, item St John's day, the Visitation of Mary, St Michael's day [...] and the two following after Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide: on these God's Word shall henceforth be proclaimed only in the morning before noon. Yet in such wise that on such days before noon no man be suffered, on pain of ten gulden, to begin field-work or

other work, nor to open his booth or shop, or to handle any such thing, until the sermon be done. But after the sermon is done, no man shall be compelled to keep holy, but every man shall then be free to work.

Note. Easter and Whitsunday fall on Sundays and are not listed. The second and third days of Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide are half days here. So are John the Baptist, the Visitation and Michaelmas, which Mecklenburg had kept whole or nearly so.

Landau, *Feiertagsordnung* of the town council, 1562 (Sehling 19/1, p. 61). The "whole" days are only four, and they are called high feasts of Christ:

Und seind das die hohen fest des herrn Christi, so gleich dem sonntag durchauß gefeirt werden sollen: Erstlich der tag nativitat is oder geburt Christi sampt dem andern folgenden tag. Der tag circumcisi onis oder der beschneidung Christi. Der tag epiphaniae, das ist der erscheinung oder offenbarung Christi, den man nennet der h[eiligen] drey könig tag. Jede montag nach ostern unnd pfingsten. Andere feiertag, so allein biß auff mittag gehalten werdenn sollen: Der tag der opferung Christi, genant purificati onis Mariae. Der tag annuntiati onis Mariae oder conceptionis Christi. Der tag caenae domini, der grün durstag genent, daran von des herrn abentmal gepredigt wirdt. [...] Der tag passionis domini oder des leidens unnd sterbens Christi, der karfreitag genent. Der tag ascensionis oder himelfarth Christi. Item die tag der aposteln. Der tag S[anct] Johannis des teuffers. Der tag visitati onis Mariae. Der tag Michaelis von wegen der leer von den heiligen engeln. Unnd an solchen apostel- und feiertagen auserhalb der sonntag unnd hohen fest hierbeiermelt mag ein jeder burger nach mittag sein geschafft unnd arbeit seiner gelegenheit nach wol verrichtenn.

And these are the high feasts of the Lord Christ which shall be kept holy throughout like the Sunday: first, the day of the Nativity or birth of Christ, with the second day following; the day of the Circumcision of Christ; the day of the Epiphany, that is, of the appearing or manifestation of Christ, which is called the holy Three Kings' day; each Monday after Easter and Whitsuntide. Other holy days, which shall be kept only until noon: the day of the offering of Christ, called the Purification of Mary; the day of the Annunciation of Mary or Conception of Christ; the day of the Lord's Supper, called Maundy Thursday, whereon is preached of the Lord's Supper; [...] the day of the Passion of the Lord, or of the suffering and death of Christ, called Good Friday; the day of the Ascension of Christ; item the days of the apostles; the day of St John the Baptist; the day of the Visitation of Mary; the day of Michael, because of the doctrine of the holy angels. And on such apostles' and holy days, beside the Sundays and the high feasts here mentioned, every burgher may well do his business and work after noon, as it serveth him.

Note. In Landau even the Ascension is a half day. The high feasts that fall on weekdays, Christmas, New Year and Epiphany, are whole days. So are the Mondays of Easter and Whitsuntide.

Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574 (Sehling 18, pp. 518–519). The chapter is headed "[X.] Ordnung der Feiertage. [1. Halbe und ganze Feiertage]". It gives a reason for keeping the half days:

so ist doch nit gerathen, die gewohnten Feiertag zu endern oder abzustellen. Sintemahl sie gemeiner kürchen dohin dienstlich, das sie bestimbte zeitt wiß und verursacht werde, die Predig und Administration der Sacramenten zu besuchen, dieweil sonst (wie die erfahrung gibt) das volckh inn den wochenpredigten gar saumhafft unnd fahrlessig ist, wann ihnen erlaubt zu arbeiten. Auch ist ohne das nöttig, das man im jahr etliche gemeine Betttag halte für das gantze Volckh, darzu die verordnete halbe Feyrtage am aller bequembsten sein mögen, do sie ohne Superstition gehalten werden, so wehre auch nit nutzlich, dise tag wider anfangen gantz zu feyren, dann (wie wir sehen) ist der Mißbrauch der Feyrtag sehr groß, gar wenig besuchen Mittags [...] Predigen, werden vilmehr mit [...] dantzen, spilen,

zechen und anndern leichtfertigen dingen zubracht. Derohalben, wölche tag bißanhero gantz oder halb gefeyrt worden, sollen noch also hifürter nach diser Ordnung gehalten werden, dann hierin unnötig, das volckh abermahl irrig zu machen.

yet it is not advisable to change or abolish the accustomed holy days, since they serve the common Church to this end, that it may know appointed times, and be moved to resort to the sermon and the administration of the sacraments; for otherwise (as experience sheweth) the people are very slack and negligent at the week-day sermons, when they are suffered to work. Besides, it is needful that certain common days of prayer be kept in the year for the whole people, for which the appointed half holy days may be most convenient, if they be kept without superstition. Nor were it profitable to begin again to keep these days wholly; for (as we see) the abuse of holy days is very great: very few resort to the midday sermons, but they are rather spent in dancing, playing, carousing and other light things. Therefore the days which hitherto have been kept wholly or half shall be kept so henceforth according to this order; for herein it is needless to lead the people astray once more.

The list itself (p. 519) makes the half days into days of prayer:

Item die zwen folgende tag nach dem Christag, zwen nach Ostern und zwen nach Pfingsten. An disen tagen soll man allein vor Mittag predigen unnd, so Communicanten do seindt nach der Predig, soll man die Letaney singen oder lesen, dann dise tag sollen für gemeine Bettage dem Volckh verkündiget und gehalten werden.

Item the two days following after Christmas, two after Easter and two after Whitsuntide. On these days one shall preach before noon only, and, if there be communicants, after the sermon one shall sing or read the Litany; for these days shall be proclaimed and kept for common days of prayer for the people.

Note. The whole days here are Christmas, Circumcision, Epiphany, Purification, Annunciation, Maundy Thursday and Ascension. The half days are the apostles, Good Friday, John the Baptist, the Visitation, Michaelmas, and the second and third days of the three great feasts. Like Waldeck 1556 (§6.1), this order ranks Good Friday below Maundy Thursday.

Ysenburg-Ronneburg, *Agende*, 1582 (Sehling 10, p. 583). A list that grades each day separately, by sermons, forenoon and afternoon:

Festum Circumcisionis Christi [...] welchs sonst der new jahrs [tag] genänt, soll ganz gefeyert undt gehalten werden. Epiphania Domini oder Trium Regum soll auch vor unndt nach mittag mit einer predig gefeyert werden. Purificationis Mariae soll denn halben tag gefeyert werdenn. Dies Matthiae Apostoli auch nur ein halben tag. Annunciationis Mariae soll den halben tag gehalten werdenn. Nota: Weil dieses fest bisweilenn in die karwochenn gefelt, sols alsdann umbgangen werdenn. Grundonnerstag undt der charfreitag soll ein iglicher nur vor mittag gehalten werdenn. Der ostertag unndt ostermontag sollen beyde vor undt nach mittag mit predigten versehen werden, der osterdinstag nur vor mittag.

The feast of the Circumcision of Christ [...] which is otherwise called New Year's day, shall be kept holy and held wholly. The Epiphany of the Lord, or the Three Kings, shall also be kept holy before and after noon with a sermon. The Purification of Mary shall be kept holy the half day. The day of Matthias the apostle also but half a day. The Annunciation of Mary shall be kept the half day. Note: because this feast sometimes falleth in Holy Week, it shall then be passed over. Maundy Thursday and Good Friday shall each be kept before noon only.

Easter day and Easter Monday shall both be furnished with sermons before and after noon; Easter Tuesday before noon only.

The list continues (p. 583) with the summer days, which are fitted to the harvest and to the market at Gelnhausen:

Der tag Johannis Baptistae soll wegen des marktags zu Gelnhausenn nur vor mittag mit einer predigt celebrirt werdenn. [...] Petri unndt Pauli unndt der tag Visitationis Mariae fallen gemeiniglich in einer wochenn unndt zur erndezeit, soll alsdann under den beydenn der am gelegestenn mit einer predigt vor mittag gehalten werdenn. Bartholomaei, Matthaei, Michaelis, Simonis Judae, S. Tomas, diese sollenn nur vor mittag gehalten werdenn. Der christtag unndt S. Stephans tag soll vor unndt nach mittag mit predigten verrichtet werden. S. Johannis tag aber, des evangelistenn, mag nur mit einer predigt vor mittag beschlossenn werdenn.

The day of John the Baptist, because of the market day at Gelnhausen, shall be celebrated only before noon with a sermon. [...] Peter and Paul and the day of the Visitation of Mary commonly fall in one week and in harvest-time; then of the two, the one that is most convenient shall be kept with a sermon before noon. Bartholomew, Matthew, Michael, Simon and Jude, St Thomas, these shall be kept only before noon. Christmas day and St Stephen's day shall be performed with sermons before and after noon. But St John the Evangelist's day may be concluded with one sermon only before noon.

Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1576, with the *Agende* of 1618 (Sehling 10, p. 228). The 1576 text lists twelve feasts, and in 1618 a sentence was added to divide them:

Diese Feyertage, so zur gedächtnuß der wolthaten unsers Herrn Jhesu Christi verordenet seind, werden mit Gesang, Predigen unnd Communion gleich den gemeinen Sontagen gehalten, allein daß die Introitus, Sequentz und andere Geseng de Tempore für die andern gemeine Gesenge gebraucht werden. Der Aposteln tage aber sollen alle mit einer Predigt gehalten werden.

These holy days, which are ordained for the remembrance of the benefits of our Lord Jesus Christ, are kept with chant, sermons and communion like the common Sundays; only that the introits, sequences and other chants *de tempore* are used instead of the other common chants. But the apostles' days shall all be kept with one sermon.

The 1618 *Agende* reads instead (in the editor's apparatus):

den gemeinen Sontagen gleich und gantz feyrlich celebrirt. Der dritte Tag aber zu Weihenachten, Ostern und Pfingsten sampt dem Tag Visitationis Mariae, S. Iohannis Baptistae wie auch Michaelis und der Heyligen Apostel Tage sollen mit einer Predigt gehalten werden, unnd gehet das Volck nach Mittag widerumb zu seiner Arbeit. Damit aber das gemeine Volck sich destobaß darnach hab zu richten, so sollen unsere Kirchendiener allewegen den Sontag zuvor von der Cantzel verkündigen, was für Fest- und Feyertage dieselbige zukünfftige Wochen einfallen und ob die mit einer Predigt halb oder gantz feyerlich nach der Kirchenordnung sollen gehalten werden.

celebrated like the common Sundays and wholly solemnly. But the third day at Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide, together with the day of the Visitation of Mary, of St John the Baptist, and also Michaelmas and the holy apostles' days, shall be kept with one sermon, and the people go again to their work after noon. But that the common people may the better order themselves thereafter, our ministers shall always on the Sunday before proclaim from the pulpit what feasts and holy days fall in the same coming week, and whether they shall be kept half with one sermon, or wholly solemnly, according to the church order.

Nassau-Weilburg, *Visitationsabschied*, 1609 (Sehling 10, p. 352). The rule in its final form:

Von feiertagen undt wochenpredigten 1. Wir wollen unndt verordnen, daß hienfuro die gantze feyertage mit zwo predigten unndt andern göttlichen ubungen, der dritte tag in den weyhnacht-, oster- unndt pfingstfeiertagen mit einer predigt, wie auch der tag Johannis Baptistae, visitationis Mariae unndt Michaelis gleich den aposteltagen, halb feyerlich gehalten werden unndt die leute nach mittag, wann der gottesdienst verrichtet, ahn ihre arbeit gehen. [...] 3. Wo uff den gründonnerstags, qui dies institutionis caenae dominicae est, daß nachtmal deß herrn zue celebriren gewönlich, darbey laßen wir es verpleiben, sonsten soll derselbige sampt dem charfreytag nur halb feyerlich gehalten werden

Of holy days and week-day sermons. 1. We will and ordain that henceforth the whole holy days be kept with two sermons and other divine exercises; the third day in the Christmas, Easter and Whitsun holy days with one sermon; as also the day of John the Baptist, of the Visitation of Mary, and of Michael, like the apostles' days, half solemnly; and that the people go to their work after noon, when the divine service is performed. [...] 3. Where it is wont to celebrate the Lord's Supper on Maundy Thursday, *which is the day of the institution of the Lord's Supper*, we let it remain so; otherwise the same, together with Good Friday, shall be kept but half solemnly

Ritzebüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 (Sehling 5, p. 559). A Low German list in two columns:

Die virdage overst, an welckeren unse gadesdienst in der kercken gehalten wert, sin desse na beschrevene und sint den ganzen dag virlich. Alle sondage. Die ersten twe dage [...] in den winachten Nihe jars dag. Die ersten 2 dage in den h. pfingsten. Drie könig dag. Item [...] Johannis Baptistae dag. Marien berggang. S. Michaelen dae; lichtmessen dag. Marien redeschop. Die ersten 2 dage in der heil, paschen. Der herren hemmelfart. De na vortekenden dage werden virlick gehalten up den halven dag edder bet to middage umb der predige willen, also: Alle apostel dage. Dingstag in den paschen. Pingesten. Marien Magdalenen dag. Pauli bekehrunge dag. Aller hilligen dag.

But the holy days whereon our divine service is held in the church are these hereafter written, and are holy the whole day: all Sundays; the first two days in Christmas; New Year's day; the first two days in holy Whitsuntide; the Three Kings' day; item St John the Baptist's day; Mary's going over the hills; St Michael's day; Candlemas day; Mary's message; the first two days in holy Easter; the Lord's Ascension. The days hereafter noted are kept holy for the half day, or until noon, for the sermon's sake, thus: all apostles' days; the Tuesday in Easter; [the Tuesday in] Whitsuntide; Mary Magdalene's day; St Paul's conversion day; All Saints' day.

Solms-Laubach, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1603 (Sehling 9, p. 356):

Von den feyertagen, cap. 1 Nachvolgende tage sollen den gantzen tag feyerlich gehalten und an denselben keine ausserliche, grobe arbeit verrichtet, sondern mit predigen, singen, beten, lesen und betrachtung gottliches worts zubracht werden: Alle sontage, der tag der geburt Christi sambt zweien nachvolgenden tagen, der newe jars tag oder circumcissionis, der tag epiphaniae [...] der tag der opferung Christi im tempel, genant purificationis Mariae, der tag annunciationis Mariae oder conceptionis Christi [...] der tag coenae Domini [...] der tag passionis Christi [...] der ostertag und uferstehung des hern Christi sambt volgendem montag und dinstag, [...] der tag ascensionis oder uffhart Christi zum hiemel, der pfingstdag sambt volgenden montag und dinstag. Über das sollen volgende tage vormittage feirlich gehalten und daran geprediget werden: alle aposteltage, sanct Johannis des tauffers tag, visitationis Mariae

Of the holy days, chapter 1. The days following shall be kept holy the whole day, and no outward gross work be done thereon, but they be spent with preaching, singing, praying, reading and meditating of God's Word: all Sundays; the day of the birth of Christ with two days following; New Year's day, or the Circumcision; the day of the Epiphany [...] the day of the offering of Christ in the temple, called the Purification of Mary; the day of the Annunciation of Mary or Conception of Christ [...] the day of the Lord's Supper [...] the day of the Passion of Christ [...] Easter day and the resurrection of the Lord Christ, with the following Monday and Tuesday, [...] the day of the Ascension, or of Christ's going up to heaven; Whitsunday with the following Monday and Tuesday. Beside these the days following shall be kept holy in the forenoon, and preaching held thereon: all apostles' days, St John the Baptist's day, the Visitation of Mary

Leiningen-Hardenburg, *Kirchenordnungsmandat for Dürkheim, 1584* (Sehling 19/1, pp. 277–278):

Nachdem in unserer kirchenordnung versehen, das man alle Son- und hohen Festag, als den heyligen Oster-, Pfingst und Cristag sambt dem negst nachfolgenden tag, deßgleichen auch den neuen jars tag, der heyligen drei könig tag, Marie Lichtmeß, Marie verkundigung und Himelfart Cristi [...] den gantzen tag durchaus feyren und heyligen, auch vor- und nachmittag gottes wort verkundigen und predigen soll [...] Sovil aber der heyligen apostel tag anbelangt, die sollen vormittag mit verkundigung gottliches worts gehalten und gefeiert werden, aber nach volendter predig mag ein jeder in sein arbeit dretten.

Whereas it is provided in our church order that all Sundays and high feast days, as the holy Easter, Whitsun and Christmas day, together with the next day following, likewise also New Year's day, the holy Three Kings' day, Mary's Candlemas, Mary's Annunciation and the Ascension of Christ [...] shall be kept holy and hallowed the whole day throughout, and God's Word be proclaimed and preached before and after noon [...] But as touching the holy apostles' days, these shall be kept and hallowed in the forenoon with the proclaiming of God's Word; but after the sermon is ended every man may go to his work.

Osnabrück (city), *Kirchenordnung, 1613* (Sehling 7/1, p. 267). Here a local day of penance stands among the half days:

Folgende tag werden nur mit einer predigt halb gefeyret: 1. Johannis evangelistae tag. 2. Der tag Mariae reinigung. 3. Der tag Matthiae apostoli. 4. Der eilfte tag Martii, an welchem eine bußpredigt wegen deß anno 1613 am 11. Martii erlittenen brandschadens gehalten wird. Item Osterd. und Pfingstdinstag. 5. Der tag der verkündigung Mariae. 6. Der tag Philippi und Jacobi. 7. Der tag Johannis baptistae. 8. Der tag Petri und Pauli. 9. Der tag der heimsuchung Mariae. 10. Der tag Jacobi apostoli. 11. Der tag Bartholomaei, welcher ein tag der danksagung ist vor die eingeerndte frucht. 12. Der tag Matthaei. 13. Der tag Simonis und Judae. 14. Der tag Andreae.

The days following are kept but half holy, with one sermon: 1. St John the Evangelist's day. 2. The day of the Purification of Mary. 3. The day of Matthias the apostle. 4. The eleventh day of March, whereon a sermon of repentance is held because of the damage by fire suffered on the 11th of March in the year 1613. Item Easter Tuesday and Whitsun Tuesday. 5. The day of the Annunciation of Mary. 6. The day of Philip and James. 7. The day of John the Baptist. 8. The day of Peter and Paul. 9. The day of the Visitation of Mary. 10. The day of James the apostle. 11. The day of Bartholomew, which is a day of thanksgiving for the fruits gathered in. 12. The day of Matthew. 13. The day of Simon and Jude. 14. The day of Andrew.

Note. In Osnabrück St Bartholomew's day, not Michaelmas, is the harvest thanksgiving. The sentence before this list puts St Stephen's day among the days "nur mit zweyen predigten ganz gefeyret", kept wholly but with

two sermons only. The editor explains that the chief feasts had three: the catechism sermon, the chief (Gospel) sermon and the Epistle sermon.

Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 (Sehling 22, p. 245). The half day is defined by the sermon alone:

Up doße apostel- und andere kleine festdage sal nemant onder dem sermone arbeiden; darvoor edder na tho arbeyden, sal vryg staen.

On these apostles' and other small feast days no man shall work during the sermon; to work before or after it shall be free.

Ermsleben, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1564 (Sehling 2, p. 486). The rule in two lines, from a town's report to the visitors:

Alle aposteltage wird gepredigt und vor mittags gefeiert. In den hohen festtagen feieret man den ganzen tag, predigt zweimal.

On all apostles' days there is preaching, and holy day is kept before noon. On the high feast days holy day is kept the whole day, and there is preaching twice.

Brieg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1592 (Sehling 3, p. 445). A Silesian order in which the three Marian feasts of Christ, with John the Baptist and Michaelmas, are whole days:

Die drei Marien-fest, als Annunciationis, Visitationis und Purificationis, item festum Johannis Baptae und Michaelis sollen den ganzen tag feierlich, wie sie fallen, gehalten werden; die apostelfest aber mit einer predigt, die da früh soll geschehen, doch dass die leute können zur kirchen kommen.

The three feasts of Mary, as the Annunciation, the Visitation and the Purification, item the feast of John the Baptist and of Michael, shall be kept solemnly the whole day, as they fall; but the apostles' feasts with one sermon, which shall be held early, yet so that the people can come to church.

6.3 Counting the rank in sermons

Many orders measure a day by its number of sermons: three, two, or one. At Penig the second day of a high feast has two sermons and the last day one.

Penig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575 (Sehling 1, p. 634):

Alle hohe fest geschehen den ersten tag drei predigten zur matin, zum ampt und vesper zeiten, folgenden festtag zwo, zum letzten eine.

On all high feasts there are three sermons on the first day, at the times of matins, the office and vespers; on the following feast day two; on the last, one.

Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung of Georg Ernst*, 1582 (Sehling 2, pp. 312–313). The four chief feasts have two sermons and all other feasts one. The Ascension is one of the four:

Von den festen. Über die sonntag sollen zu betrachtung der wolthaten Jesu Christi, unsers geliebten herrn und heilands, nachfolgende festtage feierlich gehalten, und darauf die gewöhnlichen evangelia mit den ceremonien, wie an den sonntagen geordnet, gehandelt werden. Erstlich die vier heupt fest, mit zweien predigten, vor und nach mittage, als: Der erst und ander christag. Der erst und ander ostertag. Auffartstag. Erst und ander pfingstag. Desgleichen auch Circumcisionis. Trium regum. Purificationis

oder lichtmess. Zum andern die gewöhnliche andere festa, als: Aller aposteltage. Item : Pauli bekehrung. Annunciationis. Donnerstag und freitag in der palmwochen. Johannis Baptistae. Visitationis. Mariae Magdalene. Michaelis, von den engeln. Diese alle sollen erstlich auf den sonntag zuvor verkündiget, darnach wenn und wie sie gefallen, [...] nachfolgender gestalt mit einer predigt gehalten werden. [...] Und sol als denn des folgenden morgends mit den ceremonien, wie auf die gemeine sonntage, doch ohne orgeln, gehalten werden. Wann nun solche predigt vor mittage volbracht ist, sol ein jeder an seine gebührende arbeit und beruf gehen.

Of the feasts. Over and above the Sundays, for the considering of the benefits of Jesus Christ, our beloved Lord and Saviour, these feast days following shall be kept solemnly, and thereon the wonted Gospels handled with the ceremonies as ordained on the Sundays. First, the four chief feasts, with two sermons, before and after noon, as: the first and second Christmas day; the first and second Easter day; Ascension day; the first and second Whitsunday. Likewise also the Circumcision, the Three Kings, the Purification or Candlemas. Secondly the wonted other feasts, as: all apostles' days; item St Paul's conversion; the Annunciation; Thursday and Friday in Palm week; John the Baptist; the Visitation; Mary Magdalene; Michael, of the angels. All these shall first be proclaimed on the Sunday before, and thereafter, when and as they fall, [...] be kept in manner following with one sermon. [...] And then on the following morning it shall be kept with the ceremonies as on the common Sundays, yet without the organs. And when such sermon is performed before noon, every man shall go to his due work and calling.

Note. In Henneberg the Annunciation is a lower-rank feast, but the Circumcision, Epiphany and Purification go with the chief feasts. Also on the lower feasts the organ is silent.

6.4 Harvest, markets and the working year

The rank of the summer feasts was often cut down because of the harvest. The feasts of Peter and Paul (29 June), the Visitation (2 July), James (25 July), Mary Magdalene (22 July), Laurence (10 August), the Assumption (15 August) and Bartholomew (24 August) are the ones most affected.

Transylvanian Saxons, Mediasch synod, 1578 (Sehling 24, pp. 427–428; the report printed in the apparatus from Teutsch's *Urkundenbuch*). This gives the only technical term for the half day in the corpus, *intercise*:

In hac synodo ex deliberatione pastorum quorundam remota fuerunt duo festa apostolorum Petri et Pauli et divi Iacobi propter opera rustica, quae passim in istum mensem incidunt disputatoque de celebratione aliorum festorum apostolis dedicatarum conclusum est, ut isti apostolici dies intercise, hoc [...] est dimidiatim sacri haberentur et post officium matutinum sacrum concessum liberumque sit. cuilibet operas faciendi manuaras, dies autem domini nostri Iesu Christi ut Annunciationis, Ascensionis, Paschatis, Pentecostes, Nativitatis totaliter.

In this synod, by the deliberation of certain pastors, two feasts of the apostles, of Peter and Paul and of St James, were removed because of the country works which everywhere fall in that month; and, it being disputed of the celebration of the other feasts dedicated to the apostles, it was concluded that these apostolic days should be held holy *intercise*, that is, by halves, and that after the morning office it be granted and free to every man to do handiwork; but the days of our Lord Jesus Christ, as the Annunciation, the Ascension, Easter, Pentecost, the Nativity, wholly.

Note. *Intercisi dies* was the Roman calendar's term for days that were holy in the morning and evening but lawful for business in between.

Burzenland (Transylvania), Visitationsartikel, 1578 (Sehling 24, p. 452; German version B in the apparatus).

The article is headed *De feriis hebdomadatibus*:

Der wochen gemeiner feuer-täge wegen ist verordnet von der geistlicher universität, daß sie irer alle vom cantzel sollen verkündiget werden. Doch sollen sie voriges mißbrauchs wegen nur biß auf den mittag gefeyert werden mit handlung des worts Gottes und der heiligen sacramente. Denmnach kan ein jeder seiner und gemeiner arbeit auswarten.

Concerning the common holy days of the week, it is ordained by the spiritual university that they shall all be proclaimed from the pulpit. Yet because of the former abuse they shall be kept holy only until noon, with the handling of God's Word and the holy sacraments. Thereafter every man may attend to his own and the common work.

Note. The Latin note in the same apparatus records how the article went: it had been abolished "sic ut nullum divorum festum celebraretur", so that no saint's feast was celebrated, and was brought back at the synod of Birthälm in 1580.

Mansfeld, Kirchen-agenda, 1580 (Sehling 2, p. 240). Apostles' Gospels in the harvest are moved to the Sunday, but only in the villages:

Nach dem aber in der ernte zeit die tage Petri Pauli und Jacobi gefallen, und die leute in solcher zeit an der arbeit nicht gerne verhindert werden, so können dieselbigen evangelia obgetachter tage, auf den dörfern, ein jedes auf nehest folgenden sonntag verleget werden. In stedten aber kan man sie halten auf den tag, darauf sie gefallen oder komen, wo sie auf einen sonnabent kemen, auch auf die nehesten sonntag transferirt werden.

But forasmuch as the days of Peter and Paul and of James fall in the harvest-time, and the people are loath at that time to be hindered at their work, the Gospels of the said days may in the villages be laid, each one, on the next following Sunday. But in the towns one may keep them on the day whereon they fall or come; if they come on a Saturday, they may also be transferred to the next Sunday.

Nassau-Dillenburg, Kirchenordnung, 1537 (Sehling 10, p. 74). The whole block of summer feasts is moved to Sunday:

Sanct Johans des tauffers tag, item sanct Peter unnd Paulus, Maria haimsuchung, visitationis genant, sanct Maria Magdalenen tag, sanct Jacobs, des apostels, sanct Laurentius, Maria Hymmelfart tag. Diese alle, dieweil sie in der rechten erndten khomen, sollen auff den nechsten sonntag nach dem calendertag gehalten werden, sover sie nit auff den sonntag gefallen. Eß soll auch ein jeglicher pharher auff die sonntag, darauff jetztbenante feiertag verlegt, nach mittag fur der khinderzucht das evangelion, so auff den tag zuhalten verordnet ist, predigen.

St John the Baptist's day; item St Peter and Paul; Mary's Visitation, called *visitationis*; St Mary Magdalene's day; St James the apostle's; St Laurence; the day of Mary's Assumption. All these, because they come in the very harvest, shall be kept on the next Sunday after the calendar day, unless they fall on the Sunday. And every parson shall, on the Sundays to which the said holy days are removed, preach after noon, before the catechising of the children, the Gospel appointed to be kept for that day.

Sayn, Kirchenordnung, 1590 (Sehling 19/1, p. 389):

Der Tag Petri und Pauli. Der Tag visitationis Mariae. Der Tag Iacobi Apostoli. Der Tag Bartholomaei. Weil gemeldte Apostel Fest in die Ernde fallen, sollen sie allein vor Mittag gefeyret werden.

The day of Peter and Paul. The day of the Visitation of Mary. The day of James the apostle. The day of Bartholomew. Because the said apostles' feasts fall in the harvest, they shall be kept holy before noon only.

Nürnberg, Veit Dietrich, *Agendbüchlein*, 1545 (Sehling 11, p. 538). To avoid too many summer holy days, the Visitation is moved to 15 August, where it takes the place of the Assumption:

Weil aber gemeinlich das fest Visitationis Marie in ein wochen, mit S.Peter und Paul felt und der feiertage umb der feldarbeit willen dazumal zu vil wöllen sein, ists also bedacht, das solchs fest Visitationis Marie auf den 15.tag Augusti verschoben wer, da man sonst das fest von der Himelfart Marie helt, welchs doch kein grund in der schrift und zu großer abgötterei vil ursach geben hat. Darumb soll man auf solchen tag Assumptionis die historien halten von der Heimsuchung, welche in der schrift gegründet und derhalb ein nütze lehr geben kan.

But since the feast of the Visitation of Mary commonly falleth in one week with St Peter and Paul, and the holy days would be too many at that time because of the field-work, it is thus devised that the same feast of the Visitation of Mary be put off to the fifteenth day of August, whereon otherwise the feast of the Ascension of Mary is kept, which yet hath no ground in the Scripture and hath given much occasion to great idolatry. Therefore on that day of the Assumption one shall hold the history of the Visitation, which is grounded in the Scripture and can therefore give a profitable doctrine.

Note. The same text is repeated in Hohenlohe 1578 (Sehling 15, p. 296), Wolfstein 1574 (Sehling 13, p. 587) and a Schwäbisch Hall draft of 1614 (Sehling 17/1, p. 191).

7. How many days: the high feasts and their following days

The late-medieval octave, a week-long observance of a great feast, has left almost no trace. Its place is taken by the "following days" (*nachfolgende Tage*, *Feiertage*) of Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide. How many of them are kept, and how fully, is itself a mark of rank.

- **Three days** in all the Bugenhagen orders (§5.4), in Saxony, Mecklenburg and their successors (§5.2), and in Regensburg, Thorn, Danzig, the Harz counties and Schwarzburg.
- **Two days** (the feast and the next day) in the Württemberg family (§5.3), in the Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1533 and its successors (§8.3), and in Kurpfalz.
- **A graded third day:** the third day is still a holy day but with fewer sermons, no communion, or no figural music.

7.1 Three days

Amt Grimma, *Generalia der dorfer*, 1529 (Sehling 1, p. 576):

Die hohe feste sollen allzeit drei tag mit predigen und andern cerimonien ganz feierlich gehalten, und in den messen, so communicanten vorhanden, messgewant gebraucht werden.

The high feasts shall always be kept three days, wholly solemnly, with preaching and other ceremonies, and in the masses, where there are communicants, the mass vestment be used.

Schwarzburg, *Ordnung der fest und feiertage*, 1587 (Sehling 2, p. 137):

Die drei hauptfeste weihenachten, ostern und pfingsten sollen drei tage feierlich gehalten werden, die ersten zween tage vor und nachmittage, der dritte aber allein vormittag mit predigten und do communicanten vorhanden, sollten alle drei tage das ampt gehalten werden. Gleichfalls sollen vor und nachmittag feierlich gehalten und solenniter celebriert werden, diese nechst folgende fest, als: Circumcisionis, Trium regum oder Epiphaniae, Purificationis [...] Adnunciationis [...] Mariae Virginis, Visitationis [...] Johannis Baptistae, S. Michaelis.

The three chief feasts, Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide, shall be kept solemnly three days: the first two days before and after noon, but the third in the forenoon only, with sermons; and where there be communicants, the office shall be held on all three days. Likewise these feasts next following shall be kept solemnly before and after noon and celebrated with solemnity, as: the Circumcision; the Three Kings or Epiphany; the Purification, the Annunciation and the Visitation of the Virgin Mary; John the Baptist; St Michael.

Danzig, draft *Feiertagsordnung* and St Mary's order of 1567 (Sehling 4, p. 187). The St Mary's order made the third day lesser, with two early sermons. In the margin a sixteenth-century hand wrote the contrary:

Der dritte festtag soll gleich den andern zween gehalten werden.

The third feast day shall be kept like the other two.

Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567 (Sehling 13, p. 475). All three days are kept, but the third has neither communion nor the midday sermon:

An festen Christi, allen und jeden, wird neben den predigten frue auch das abendmahl gehalten und derhalben abends zuvor auch die vesper umb der communicanten willen. An Weihnachten, Ostern und Pfingsten wird doch das abendmahl nur die ersten zween tage gehalten und den dritten tag, als dem erichtag, die mittagspredig in beiden kirchen unterlassen, wie unten volget.

On the feasts of Christ, each and every one, the Supper is held beside the sermons in the morning, and therefore also vespers on the evening before, for the communicants' sake. Yet at Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide the Supper is held only the first two days, and on the third day, being the Tuesday, the midday sermon is left off in both churches, as followeth below.

Anhalt, *Kirchenordnung* of Prince Bernhard, 1568 (Sehling 2, p. 569). The third day is graded by its music:

Zu hohen festen soll man zwene heilige tage figural und den dritten tag den lateinischen coral und den sequens de tempore singen.

On high feasts one shall sing two holy days in figural music, and on the third day the Latin plain-song and the sequence *de tempore*.

The Wintzingerode order (§6.2) and Penig 1575 (§6.3) also make the third day lesser, with one sermon instead of two or three. Nassau-Weilburg 1609 (§6.2) makes it a half holy day.

7.2 Two days, and "two only"

Most Upper German orders keep the feast and the next day: "Der Ostertag sampt dem nächsten darnach" (Württemberg 1553, §5.3). Two orders show the difference plainly.

Goldlauter (Henneberg), parish order, 1566 (Sehling 2, p. 333; printed "Grolldlauter"). The pastor's report to the visitors:

Also pfleg ich es auch zu halten auf die hohe fest, wie oben stehet, one allein die lieder von einem idlichen fest werden gesungen an statt der vorigen und auf weinachten feiern wir drei tage, auf ostern und pfingsten nur zwen wie in der agend stehet.

So am I wont to keep it also on the high feasts, as standeth above, save only that the songs of each feast are sung instead of the former; and at Christmas we keep holy three days, at Easter and Whitsuntide but two, as standeth in the agenda.

Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582 (§6.3) keeps "Der erst und ander christag. Der erst und ander ostertag ... Erst und ander pfingstag": two days at each feast, and so no third day at Christmas either.

7.3 St Stephen and St John in Christmas week

In the medieval calendar 26 and 27 December were the feasts of St Stephen and St John the Evangelist, both of high grade. Luther's *Formula missae* keeps "the office of the Nativity" on those days (§4.1). The orders then choose among three answers:

- **They become the second and third days of Christmas**, with the Christmas Gospel and at most a mention of the saint. This is the common Lutheran solution.
- **They are kept as saints' days** within Christmas.
- **They are joined into one day**, as at Weißenburg 1528 (§5.7) and in one recension of Brenz's Hall order.

Schwäbisch Hall, Brenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527, variant B (Sehling 17/1, p. 53):

B: den Christag mitsampt Sant Stephans tag also, das man Sant Stephans und Sant Johans, nachfolgenden tag, fur ein und nit zwen feyrtag halte

B: Christmas day together with St Stephen's day, so that St Stephen's and St John's, the day following, be kept for one holy day and not two

Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 (Sehling 6/1, p. 62). The saints are joined to the "festival sermon" of the second and third Christmas days as themes of their own:

Am dage Stephani neven der festpredike schal men ock prediken van den diaken edder gemeinen kastendenern, darby antheen dat exempel Stephani und Laurentii, darmit den lüden ein sorchfeldicheit ingebildet werde vor de armen. Am dage Johannis des evangelisten is tho reden neven der festpredike van dem berope edder eschinge eines jeweliken mynschen.

On St Stephen's day, beside the festival sermon, one shall also preach of the deacons or common chest-servants, and allege thereby the example of Stephen and Laurence, that a carefulness for the poor may be imprinted on the people. On the day of John the Evangelist one is to speak, beside the festival sermon, of the calling or vocation of every man.

Note.

- **Grubenhagen 1544** adds the Holy Innocents on 28 December as a fourth day of Christmas, kept "while the sermon lasteth" (§5.5).
- **Braunschweig 1528** tells the preacher to remember St John after the sermon of the third day of Christmas, and St Stephen after the sermon of the second (p. 398).

8. Individual feasts and where they stand

8.1 Purification and Annunciation: Marian names, feasts of Christ

Following Luther ("Festum purificationis et annunciationis pro festis Christi ... habemus", §4.1), almost every order keeps these two days and counts them among the feasts of Christ. The orders often rename them to make the point:

- "Der tag der offenbarung Christi in dem tempel, so man nennet purificationis Mariae" (Saxony 1539, §5.2).
- "Der tag der opferung Christi im tempel" (Mecklenburg 1552, §5.2).
- "Annunciationis Mariae oder conceptionis Christi" (Mecklenburg 1552, Sayn 1582 and others).
- "Purificationis Christi et Marie. Annunciacionis Christi" (Hausmann, Anhalt 1532, §5.7).

Their rank is still not fixed:

- **Whole holy days:** in Mecklenburg, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1561, Mansfeld 1580 and Brieg 1592.
- **Half days:** in Landau 1562 and Ysenburg 1582 (§6.2).
- **Forenoon only:** in Württemberg 1536 (§5.3).

When the Annunciation falls in Holy Week it has to be moved, and the orders' rules for this show how its rank was understood (§11.2).

8.2 The Visitation

The Visitation (2 July) was a late-medieval feast, but its Gospel (Luke 1:39–56, with the *Magnificat*) made it acceptable. Homberg 1526 already keeps it (§4.2). Riga 1530 keeps it "because that was the first revelation of Christ, when he was yet in his mother's womb" (§4.7). Saxony 1539 keeps it "because of that history of the Gospel" (§5.2).

It usually stands in the second rank, beside John the Baptist and Michaelmas. In the Nürnberg family its date was moved to 15 August, to take the place of the Assumption and to spare the harvest (§6.4).

8.3 The Assumption: abolished, replaced, or kept "for the working peasants"

No feast shows the range of the orders better than the Assumption (15 August). It has no Gospel history. But in north Germany it was one of the four feasts on which the "four-times" offering was paid (§9), and elsewhere it was a harvest holiday. The orders deal with it in three ways.

1. Kept, but preached as the Visitation.

Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533 (Sehling 11, p. 204):

Unser Frauen tag irer himelfart, nit darumb das der in der heiligen schrift grund hab, sunder von des gemainen arbeitenden pauersvolks wegen. Doch soll an solichem fest in den kirchen die historien von unser frauen fest Visitationis genant, derhalben man in dem heiligen evangelio zeugnus hat, mit singen und lesen gehalten werden

Our Lady's day of her Ascension, not because it hath ground in holy Scripture, but for the sake of the common labouring country-folk. Yet on that feast the history of our Lady's feast called the Visitation, whereof there is witness in the holy Gospel, shall be kept in the churches with singing and reading

Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 (Sehling 22, p. 245). The same text in Low German. Here the day also counts as one of the four chief feasts:

Unser leven frouwen hemelvaertdes dag, assumptionis genant, alß ein veerhochtydsfeest, nicht darum, dat et in der hilligen schrift grundt hebbe, [...] sonder von des gemeinen arbeitenden werckvolcks wegen; doch sol an solchen fest in der kercken de historia visitationis Mariae, der men in dem evangelio tuighniße hefft, mit singen und lesen geholden werden.

Our dear Lady's Ascension day, called the Assumption, as a feast of the four high times; not that it hath ground in the holy Scripture, [...] but for the sake of the common labouring work-folk; yet on that feast the history of the Visitation of Mary, whereof there is witness in the Gospel, shall be kept in the church with singing and reading.

Note. The Stift Osnabrück order of 1543 (Sehling 7/1, p. 223) forbids the feast outright. Its editor notes that some territories kept it as a *Vierzeitenfest* on the Nürnberg model. Veit Dietrich's *Agendbüchlein* of 1545 moves the Visitation itself to 15 August (§6.4).

2. Abolished, and Michaelmas made the fourth chief feast in its place. This is the northern solution: Mecklenburg 1552 (§5.2), Hoya 1571 and Harlingerland 1573/74 (§5.5), Lippe 1571 and Oldenburg 1573 (§9). The Mecklenburg visitors of 1557 insisted on it.

Mecklenburg, *Visitations-Instruction*, 1557 (Sehling 5, p. 224):

Auch wirt angezeigt, wie es mit den festen oder feiertagen hinfurder uber das jar eintregtiglich soll gehalten werden, nemlich das uber die fest Cristi allein der apostel tage sollen gefiert werden, wie in der kirchenordnung nach der leng ausgedruckt und insonderheit das man das fest Assumptionis Marie hinfurder nicht halten noch dulden will, sondern den tag Michaelis an desselben stadt ein vierzeiten fest sein soll.

It is also shewed how it shall be kept henceforth with one accord through the year with the feasts or holy days: namely that, beside the feasts of Christ, only the apostles' days shall be kept holy, as is set out at length in the church order; and in especial that the feast of the Assumption of Mary shall henceforth be neither kept nor suffered, but that the day of Michael shall be a feast of the four times in its stead.

3. Simply kept. A number of orders keep the Assumption as a holy day:

- the conservative lists of Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Hausmann 1532 and Weißenburg 1528 (§5.7);
- Nassau-Dillenburg 1537, among the harvest feasts moved to Sunday (§6.4);
- the Danish-Holstein order of 1542, "Festa Ascensionis" (§5.4).

8.4 The other Marian feasts

The Conception (8 December), Nativity (8 September) and Presentation (21 November) of Mary have no Gospel history. Most orders drop them in silence. A few name them in order to abolish them, among them Sayn 1582, "Sonderlich aber festum conceptionis, nativitatis, praesentationis, assumptionis Mariae", and Regensburg 1567 (§4.7). A few keep one or more:

Order	Treatment
Anhalt, Hausmann, 1532 (§5.7)	"Visitacionis, conceptionis Marie", Assumption and Nativity all kept
Nassau-Dillenburg 1537 (Sehling 10, pp. 74–75)	Assumption and "Mariae geburt, nativitatis genant" kept
Brandenburg 1540 (§5.7)	Assumption and Nativity kept
Wied 1564 (§3.5)	Nativity of Mary a sermon day ("tantum fiet concio")
Anhalt 1568 (§3.5)	Visitation and Nativity of Mary kept <i>ferialiter</i> , with their Gospels, not as holy days
Teschen 1584 (§5.7)	"Mariae gebuert" among the holy days

8.5 Michaelmas: the angels and the harvest

Michaelmas (29 September) rises highest of all the saints' days. Most orders give the day three themes, as Saxony 1539 does: "daran von den heiligen engeln zu predigen":

- the doctrine of the holy angels;
- thanksgiving for the harvest;
- in the north, the fourth payment of the four-times offering (§9).

Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 (Sehling 23, p. 95):

De dach Michaelis ys eine gemene dancksegginge vor alle fruchte, de wy des Jars gesamlet und entfangen hebben. Darumme schal de gantze vorsamlinge vorth na der predigen singen tho der dancksegginge mit groter andacht: Te Deum Laudamus etc. Averst den gantzen dach aver, so wol des morges also des namiddages, schal men Predigen van den Engeln, up dat yderman vorsta, wat gudes wy van Gade dorch eren denst entfangen hebben, dat wy ock Gade darvor dancken mögen.

The day of Michael is a common thanksgiving for all fruits which we have gathered and received in the year. Therefore the whole congregation shall straightway after the sermon sing for the thanksgiving, with great devotion, *Te Deum laudamus*, etc. But the whole day through, as well in the morning as in the afternoon, one shall preach of the angels, that every man may understand what good we have received from God through their service, that we also may thank God therefor.

Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528 (Sehling 6/1, p. 397). The *Te Deum* is sung before the Gospel:

Denne schal eyn predicante, wen de epistole gelesen is, vor deme evangelio vormanen dat volk, Gade to danken vor alle woldät unde besondergen vor de fruchte disses jares, de he uns gegeven hefft intosamelen [...] schal he singen laten Te Deum etc., ehr me dat evangelion lest.

Then shall a preacher, when the epistle is read, before the Gospel, exhort the people to thank God for all benefits, and especially for the fruits of this year which he hath given us to gather in [...] he shall let *Te Deum* be sung, etc., before the Gospel is read.

Note. Michaelmas's rank still varies from place to place:

- **A chief feast:** the fourth *Vierzeitenfest* in Braunschweig, Hamburg, Lübeck, Grubenhagen, Mecklenburg, Hoya, Lippe, Oldenburg and Waldeck.
- **Preached "before and after noon":** in Mecklenburg, where it formally stands in the second rank.
- **A whole day with Te Deum:** in the Brunswick orders.
- **A half day:** in Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1561 (§6.2) and Nassau-Weilburg 1609.
- **A sermon day only:** in Wied 1564 (§3.5).
- **A "small feast", though with three sermons:** in Danzig 1612 (§5.6).

8.6 John the Baptist

The Nativity of John the Baptist (24 June) is kept by nearly every order, usually in the second rank. The reason given is either the Gospel history of his birth or the office of preaching: "zu ehren dem heiligen predigampt des evangelii von Christo" (Saxony 1539, Merseburg 1544). The Pomeranian order of 1535 counts him with the feasts of Christ: "dat fest hört ock up Christum" (§5.4). The Wolfenbüttel order of 1543 gives his day a polemical theme.

Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 (Sehling 6/1, pp. 62–63):

Am dage Johannis Baptistae schal men prediken van dem uthwendigen denste des göttliken wordes wedder de wedderdöpere, welcke [...] up dem sproke stan: Se werden alle van Gade geleret werden. Darmede se alle scholen wüste maken.

On the day of John the Baptist one shall preach of the outward ministry of the divine Word against the Anabaptists, who [...] stand upon the saying, They shall be all taught of God; wherewith they would lay all the schools waste.

8.7 Trinity

The feast of the Trinity falls on a Sunday. It is usually listed at the end of the feasts of Christ with the note that it "gefellet auf den nehesten sonntag nach pfingsten" (Saxony 1539, Mecklenburg 1552). Its rank is shown in four ways:

- **The Kyrie.** It shares the *Kyrie summum* with Pentecost at Nördlingen and Buxtehude (§3.2).
- **The Latin Mass.** It is one of the "Hogen Festen Christi" with a Latin Mass in Schleswig-Holstein 1542 (§10.2).
- **The Athanasian Creed.** It is read on the day and its vigil in the Thüngen lessons of 1587.
- **Solemnity.** It is kept "hochfeyerlich" in Verden 1606.

The Brandenburg-Ansbach chapter order of 1533 notes only that its office "ist rain" (§3.4).

8.8 Mary Magdalene, the Conversion of Paul, the Beheading of John: kept for their Gospels

Three days that are not apostles' days are often ranked with them, because they have a story in the New Testament. These are the Conversion of Paul (25 January), Mary Magdalene (22 July, Luke 7:36–50) and the Beheading of John the Baptist (29 August). Where they are not holy days, the orders keep their Gospels on the nearest weekday or Sunday.

Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552 (Sehling 5, p. 201):

Wenn solche heilige tage gefallen, die man nicht pflaget zu feiren, und doch ire historien im evangelio beschrieben sind, als da ist der tag Conversionis Pauli, Marie Magdalene, S. Johannis entheubtung etc. mögen die prediger den selben text und historien an einem solchen werktage, nemlich, mitwoch oder freitage, der solchem heiligen tag am nehesten ist, in der predigt lesen und handeln.

When such holy days fall as are not wont to be kept holy, and yet their histories are written in the Gospel, as is the day of the Conversion of Paul, Mary Magdalene, St John's beheading, etc., the preachers may read and handle the same text and histories in the sermon on such working day, namely Wednesday or Friday, as is next to such holy day.

Solms-Laubach, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1603 (Sehling 9, p. 356). A reason for keeping the Beheading of John:

Der tag Johannis enthauptung oder [decollatio Johannis] mag uf ein gemeinen wochenpredigttag (dieweil derselb eine herliche histori und zeugnus hat, wie die weldt frommen predigern pflegt zulohnen) verlegt werden, wie dan auch das evan[...]gelium von Marien Magdalenen, dieweil es eine nutzliche und tröstliche historiam inhelt.

The day of John's beheading may be laid on a common week-day sermon day (since the same hath a glorious history and witness how the world is wont to reward godly preachers), as also the Gospel of Mary Magdalene, since it containeth a profitable and comfortable history.

Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568 (Sehling 4, p. 87). Mary Magdalene's Gospel is given a fixed Sunday:

Das evangelium Mariä Magdalenä Luc. 7 soll ordinarie und hinfort jährlich Dominica septima nach Trinitatis gelesen und gepredigt werden

The Gospel of Mary Magdalene, Luke 7, shall ordinarily and henceforth yearly be read and preached on the seventh Sunday after Trinity

8.9 Corpus Christi, the Holy Cross, local and new feasts

Corpus Christi. Most orders abolish it, and some order it to be explained so that people will know why it has gone.

Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1096):

Das fest corporis Christi sol vermüge Gottes worts abgetan sein und sollen die prediger den Sontag zuvor das volk erinnern, was für ein grosser misbrauch und abgötterey damit getrieben worden, deren sich ein jeder Christ nach dem ernstlichen befehl Gottes enthalten sol.

The feast of Corpus Christi shall be done away according to God's Word, and the preachers shall on the Sunday before remind the people what great abuse and idolatry hath been practised therewith, which every Christian ought to shun according to the earnest commandment of God.

Two early orders keep it: Northeim for civic reasons, and Nassau-Dillenburg to teach the right use of the Sacrament.

Northeim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1539 (Sehling 6/2, p. 935):

Des Herrn waren leichnams tag hat man umb sonderlicher politischer, das ist bürgerlicher ursach willen müssen bleiben lassen. Aber doch also, das die processio sampt allen andern unchristlichen ceremonien abgeschafft und allein Gottes wort und das nachtmal des Herrn zu handeln und halten gestatet werden sol.

The day of the Lord's true Body men have had to let stand for special political, that is, civil causes; yet so that the procession, with all other unchristian ceremonies, be done away, and only God's Word and the Lord's Supper be suffered to be handled and held thereon.

Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537 (Sehling 10, p. 74):

Unnsers herren leichnams tag, corporis Christi genant, soll darumb werden behalten, das man daran von dem rechten gebrauch unnd frucht des hohen hailigen sacraments des leibs unnd bluts Christi richtig lere unnd predige. Es soll aber das sacrament weder an dem noch an keinem anndern tagk im jar außgestellt noch umbgetragen werden

Our Lord's Body day, called Corpus Christi, shall be retained to this end, that one may rightly teach and preach thereon of the right use and fruit of the high holy Sacrament of the body and blood of Christ. But the Sacrament shall be neither set out nor carried about, on that nor on any other day in the year

The Holy Cross. Luther's "Festa S. Crucis anathema sunt" (§4.1) is echoed in Sayn 1582, "die beiden creutz tage, inventionis und exaltationis crucis" (§5.5). No order keeps them.

Local and civic feasts. Some towns kept days of their own, and the orders treat them in different ways:

- **Braunschweig.** St Autor had been honoured with a civic procession under a vow. It was turned into alms and a Sunday thanksgiving (Sehling 6/1, p. 398).
- **Wied 1564.** Patronal feasts are kept with a sermon (§3.5).
- **New days.** Some towns added days of their own: a day of penance for the Osnabrück fire of 1613 (§6.2); a thanksgiving in Nördlingen for the town's deliverance from a planned surprise attack in 1440 (Sehling 12, pp. 387–388); and in Regensburg a dedication festival in October for the beginning of evangelical preaching in 1542 (Sehling 13, p. 475).

A new feast of Christ. Bugenhagen proposed a feast the medieval calendar did not have.

Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528 (Sehling 6/1, p. 380):

Id is wunder, dat me nicht hefft gehat eyn fest van der döpe Christi, dewile me doch so vele unnutte feste hefft gehat, to vorderve lives unde der selen. [...] Dat also de Vastelavendessundach by uns moge heten dat fest der döpe Christi, me mach id denne nömen, wo me wil.

It is a wonder that there hath been no feast of the baptism of Christ, seeing there have been so many unprofitable feasts, to the destruction of body and soul. [...] So that the Shrovetide Sunday may with us be called the feast of the baptism of Christ; one may then name it as one will.

Note. Wolfenbüttel 1543 keeps this "feast of the baptism" on the Sunday before Lent, with the Gospel of Matthew 3 preached "den ganzen dach över", all day long (Sehling 6/1, p. 62).

9. The *Vierzeiten*: the four chief feasts and the four offerings

In north and central Germany the highest rank of feasts had a name that came from church finance, not liturgy. These were the *vier Zeiten* (Low German *veer tide*), or the four *Hochzeiten*. They were the four feasts on which the "four-times penny" (*Vierzeitenpfennig*, *veertide pennink*) or offering was paid to the pastor or the church chest. Three of the four were fixed: Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide. The fourth varied by region, as the editors' notes show. It was most often the Assumption (so at Minden, Sehling 21, p. 138). The Bergedorf order names St John the Baptist's day instead (Sehling 5, p. 389, cited by the Buxtehude editor, Sehling 7/1, p. 79). At St John's in Halberstadt the penny was collected quarterly, on John the Baptist's day, Michaelmas, and the Tuesdays of Christmas and Easter (Sehling 2, p. 488).

The Lutheran orders kept the payment, and with it the rank. Most of them replaced the Assumption with Michaelmas, which fell in the same season (after the harvest) and had a lawful Gospel theme (the angels). The *Vierzeiten* are the Lutheran north's equivalent of the *summa festa*. A *Vierzeitenfest* is a whole holy day, often with first vespers and a sermon on the eve, and with a Latin Mass.

9.1 The four times named

Lübeck, *Kirchenordnung* (Bugenhagen), 1531 (Sehling 5, p. 362). The treasure-chest:

In desse caste schal kamen de veer tide pennink ut allen caspelen. De veer tide sint: paschen, pinxten, michaelis, winachten. Denne schal ein grot becken stan in allen kerken up dem altare vor dem chore. Twe kerkvedere schölen dar acht up hebben und nicht verne dar van sin , und alle lüde van twelf iaren und dar baven iunk und olt, schölen dar bringen den tide pennink.

Into this chest shall come the four-times penny out of all the parishes. The four times are Easter, Whitsuntide, Michaelmas, Christmas. Then shall a great basin stand in all churches on the altar before the choir. Two churchwardens shall have an eye thereon and not be far from it; and all folk of twelve years and above, young and old, shall bring thither the times-penny.

Waldeck, *Landordnung*, 1525 (Sehling 9, p. 179). A pre-Reformation police ordinance names the four *Hochzeiten* first among the days on which attendance at Mass is enforced:

Auch setzen, ordiniren und wollen wir, ernstlich gebietthende, das ein ider unßer undersaße, so zu seinen mundigen jharen khommen, uff die vier hochzeitliche feste und sonntage, auch uff alle unßer lieben frawen- und apostelltage in seiner pfarkirchen das ampt der heiligen meß und das heilige evangelium von ihrem pfarherrn heeren sollen

We also set, ordain and will, earnestly commanding, that every one of our subjects that is come to his years of discretion shall, on the four high-tide feasts and Sundays, and also on all our Lady's and apostles' days, hear in his parish church the office of the holy mass and the holy Gospel from their parson

Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1569 (Sehling 4, p. 414). The due itself:

De veertiden pennink, alle quartal van jeder person bauen 12. jar, ein veerken, schal gegeven werden, entwedder dem pastori edder der kercken, wo idt jeders ordes gebrücklick.

The four-times penny, every quarter, from every person above twelve years, a farthing, shall be given either to the pastor or to the church, as is the custom in every place.

Jülich-Cleves-Berg, *Visitationsinstruktion*, 1559 (Sehling 21, p. 87). The same dues in the lower Rhineland, where they are called the "four high-tide offerings":

yedoch das einem yeden die vier hochzeitoffer unnd -broder, wie hiebevordent, gegeben werden

yet so that to every one the four high-tide offerings and loaves be given, as heretofore ordained

9.2 Michaelmas in the Assumption's place

The replacement was made by Braunschweig 1528 ("Item Michaelis vor eyn vehrtidenvest", §5.4) and Hamburg 1529. It became standard through Mecklenburg 1552 (§5.2) and the visitation of 1557 (§8.3). The later orders write it into their feast lists.

Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571 (Sehling 21, pp. 391–392):

Der tag Michaelis, welcher an statt des Festes Assumptionis Mariae in unsern Kirchen als ein viergezeiten Fest feirlich gehalten [...] und darauff die notwendige tröstliche Lere von den lieben heiligen Engeln der Gemeine Gottes fürgetragen und gehandelt wirdt. Auff diesen Festen sol es mit Ordnung der Lectionen, Gesengen, Predigten und Communion gehalten werden wie an den gemeinen Sontagen, Allein, das die Introitus, Sequentz und auff den Viergezeiten Festagen die Praefationes de tempore, Item die Teutsche Alte Festliedlein, wie oben ermelt und bey uns gewöntlich, gesungen werden.

The day of Michael, which in the stead of the feast of the Assumption of Mary is kept solemnly in our churches as a feast of the four times [...] and whereon the needful comfortable doctrine of the dear holy angels is set forth and handled to the congregation of God. On these feasts it shall be done, as touching the order of the lessons, chants, sermons and communion, as on the common Sundays; only that the introits and sequences, and on the four-times feast days the prefaces *de tempore*, item the old German feast-songs, as above mentioned and customary with us, be sung.

Note. Lippe ranks the *Vierzeiten* above the other feasts of Christ by one liturgical mark, the proper preface. The same order calls them "die herrliche, schöne, heilige, fürnembste viergezeiten Fest", the glorious, fair, holy, chieftest four-times feasts (p. 392).

Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 (Sehling 7/2.1, pp. 1096–1097):

Der tag Michaelis, welcher anstadt des festis [...] assumptionis oder himelfart Mariae als ein viergezeitenfest gehalten, an welchem die lere von den heiligen engeln dem volk sol fürgehalten werden. Desgleichen sol auch an demselbigen fest nach verlesener epistel ein gemeine danksagung geschehen für die empfangene fruchten und darzu das Te Deum laudamus gesungen werden.

The day of Michael, which is kept as a feast of the four times in the stead of the feast [...] of the Assumption or Ascension of Mary, whereon the doctrine of the holy angels shall be set forth to the people. Likewise also on the same feast, after the epistle is read, a common thanksgiving shall be made for the fruits received, and the *Te Deum laudamus* be sung thereto.

Harlingerland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573/74 (Sehling 7/1, p. 735). The payment is the reason given for Michaelmas taking the place:

Ordnen derohalben, daß der [!] letzte und vierte hochfesttagzeit solle S. Michaelis tag sein. Und sollen die kaspelbleute dem pastorn am selben tag öhre opfer, gebührlichen pflicht und landheur guedtlischen entrichten und ohne hinderung dorgeben und bezahlen.

We ordain therefore that the last and fourth high feast-tide shall be St Michael's day. And the parishioners shall on the same day render kindly to the pastor their offering, due duty and land-rent, and give and pay it without hindrance.

9.3 The *Vierzeiten* as a liturgical rank

Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 (Sehling 6/1, p. 62). The same words stand in Hildesheim 1544 (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 858). A sermon at first vespers is allowed only on the four:

In den grösten festen edder veer tyden: Wynachten, Paschen, Pinxsten und Michaelis mach men thor ersten vesper eine stunde prediken. In den andern festen is dat nicht van nöden.

On the greatest feasts, or four times, Christmas, Easter, Whitsuntide and Michaelmas, one may preach for an hour at the first vespers. On the other feasts it is not needful.

Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571 (Sehling 6/2, p. 1151). The Mass in Latin throughout:

VI. Von den vierzeitenfesten. Auf den vierzeitenfesten sol man das meßampt in unsern kirchen, da man es haben kan, durchaus latine, mit dem introitu, Kyrie eleison, gloria in excelsis, collecten, episteln, sequentien, evangelien etc. halten, doch das die gewöhnlichen deudsche psalm, welche auf die fest verordnet (damit auch die kirche singe), nicht vergessen werden.

VI. Of the four-times feasts. On the four-times feasts one shall hold the office of the mass in our churches, where it can be had, throughout in Latin, with the introit, Kyrie eleison, *Gloria in excelsis*, collects, epistles, sequences, Gospels, etc.; yet so that the wonted German psalms which are appointed for the feasts (that the church also may sing) be not forgotten.

Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585 (Sehling 5, p. 421). The *hohe Vierzeitenfeste* are the days for the alms collection. The meal the pastor used to give the churchwardens on those days is abolished:

Zum vierzehenden sollen sie alle sontage und auf den feiertagen und hohen vierzeiten festen die bete von den leuten unter der predigt fleissig samlen, aufschreiben und beilegen [...] Und letztlich sol genzlich abgeschaffet sein auf den hohen vierzeiten festen die collation und frass, welchen der pastor bis daher den kirchgeschworen auf solchen festen hat geben müssen.

Fourteenthly, they shall on all Sundays, and on the holy days and the high four-times feasts, diligently gather the collection from the people during the sermon, write it down and lay it by [...] And lastly there shall be wholly done away on the high four-times feasts the collation and feasting which the pastor hath hitherto had to give the churchwardens on such feasts.

Neumark (Brandenburg), instruction of Margrave Johann for the visitors, 1540 (Sehling 3, p. 36). The churchwardens are to take the collection plate round on the high feasts generally, not only on the four:

Dieselben gottesleute sollen auch alle hohe feier feste, nicht allein die vier zeiten mit der tafel umbgehen in der kirchen

The same churchwardens shall also go about in the church with the plate on all high holy feasts, not only on the four times

Note. Grubenhagen 1544 defines its first rank of feasts by this payment ("die vier hauptfest, an welchen man den vierzeitpenning sammelt", §5.5). Henneberg 1582 has four chief feasts, but they are Christmas, Easter,

Ascension and Whitsuntide (§6.3). It shows that "four chief feasts" could be understood liturgically as well as fiscally.

10. Ceremonial marks of rank

Beyond whole and half holy days, the orders mark the higher feasts with a set of ceremonial additions. None of them is new. Each carries on, in reduced form, a feature of the medieval feast grades. Listed from the commonest to the rarest:

Mark	Higher feasts	Lower feasts and ordinary days	Examples
Sermons	two or three, sometimes four; a sermon at first vespers	one sermon, in the forenoon	§6.3; Wolfenbüttel 1543 (§9.3); Danzig (§5.6)
Latin chant	introit, <i>Gloria</i> , Alleluia, sequence, <i>Patrem</i> , preface, Sanctus, <i>Agnus Dei</i> in Latin	German hymns	§10.1
Kyrie grade	<i>summum, paschale, festivale</i>	<i>dominicale, angelicum, apostolicum, feriale</i>	§3.2, §10.2
Proper preface	preface of the feast (<i>de tempore, solemnis</i>)	common preface, exhortation, or none	§10.3
Sequence	kept on the great feasts	dropped	§10.4
Figural music and organ	figural music, organ	plain-song or German; no organ	§10.5
Vestments, elevation	mass vestment, elevation	choir robe or none	§10.6
Bells	more bells, chiming (<i>beiern</i>) the day before	one bell	§10.7
Creed and <i>Te Deum</i>	<i>Athanasianum</i> , Latin <i>Te Deum</i>	—	§10.8
Communion	communion and first vespers with confession	no communion on apostles' days	§10.9
Civil marks	no weddings, markets or guild feasts	—	§10.10

10.1 Latin chant on the high feasts

The Saxon *Unterricht der Visitatoren* of 1528 set the pattern. Latin is kept for the higher feasts "because it is unseemly always to sing one song".

Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528 (Sehling 1, pp. 165 and 169):

An hohen festen, als christag, ostern, auffart, pfingsten, oder der gleichen, were gut, das zur messe etliche lateinische gesenge, die der schrift gemes, gebraucht würden. Denn es ist ein ungestalt, imerdar ein gesang singen. [...] Mit den festen sol es auch fridlich gehalten werden, also, das wo etliche schlechte feier abgangen sind, das man davon nicht viel zanks mache. Dieweil es auch ein ungestalt ist, das die gesang gar gleich sind an allen festen, were gut, das man an den herrlichsten festen sünge, die lateinische introitus, gloria in excelsis deo, halleluia, die reinen sequenz, sanctus, agnus dei.

On high feasts, as Christmas, Easter, the Ascension, Whitsuntide, or the like, it were good that certain Latin chants, agreeable to Scripture, were used at the mass. For it is an unseemly thing evermore to sing one song. [...] With the feasts also it shall be done peaceably: that where certain plain holy days have fallen away, men make not much strife thereof. And forasmuch as it is also unseemly that the chants be all alike on all feasts, it were good that on the most glorious feasts there were sung the Latin introits, *Gloria in excelsis Deo*, Alleluia, the pure sequences, Sanctus, *Agnus Dei*.

Saxony (Ernestine), *Gemeine Verordnung*, 1533 (Sehling 1, p. 192). The rule depends on the place as well as the day:

In steten und flecken da knabenschulen und leut sind, die lateinisch versteen, mag man an hohen festen lateinisch, sonst deutsch mess halten, auf den dorfern aber do niemands lateinisch versteet, soll man durch aus deutsch mess halten [...] Zu merken, wen man gleich an hohen festen die mess lateinisch heldet, so liset man dennoch die epistel, das evangelion, die wort des sacraments, das vater unser alles deutsch und laut

In towns and market towns, where there are boys' schools and folk that understand Latin, one may hold mass in Latin on high feasts, otherwise in German; but in the villages, where no man understandeth Latin, one shall hold mass in German throughout [...] Note: even when mass is held in Latin on high feasts, yet the epistle, the Gospel, the words of the Sacrament and the Lord's Prayer are all read in German and aloud

Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 (Sehling 23, p. 91). The high feasts are named, and Trinity is one of them:

In den Hogen Festen Christi, alse dar sint Winachten, Paschen, Pingesten und Trinitatis, schal men yn den steden singen up latin de Introitus, Gloria yn Excelsis, Alleluia mit reinen sequentien, Item latinische prefationen, Welcker de Prester also anhevet: Dominus vobiscum etc., Sursum Corda etc., Darna Sanctus, thom lesten Pater noster Mit den wörden des Avendmals, doch de stedes yn düdescher sprake

On the high feasts of Christ, which are Christmas, Easter, Whitsuntide and Trinity, one shall sing in the towns in Latin the introits, *Gloria in excelsis*, Alleluia with pure sequences; item Latin prefates, which the priest beginneth thus: *Dominus vobiscum*, etc., *Sursum corda*, etc.; thereafter the Sanctus; lastly the *Pater noster* with the words of the Supper, yet these always in the German tongue

Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552 (Sehling 7/1, p. 74). The Gloria follows the rank:

Volgende schall gesungen werden dat Kyrie eleison na gelegenheit, Gloria in excelsis unde dat [Et] in terra, in den hogen festen stedes lattinisch, upp den Sondagen und sunst dudesch edder latinisch, wo idt de tydt liden will.

Next shall be sung the Kyrie eleison as occasion serveth, *Gloria in excelsis* and the *Et in terra*: on the high feasts always in Latin, on the Sundays and otherwise in German or in Latin, as the time will allow.

Thorn, Kirchenordnung, 1575 (Sehling 4, p. 238). The reverse rule. On Sundays the chants before the sermon are in Latin, but the small feasts are wholly German:

Sonsten die gesänge, collecten und lectiones für der predigt werden alles lateinisch gehalten. An den aposteltagen und anderen kleinen festen, die man mit halber feier zu halten pflēget, wird das ganze officium deutsch gehalten, beide in der alten und neuenstadt

Otherwise the chants, collects and lessons before the sermon are all held in Latin. On the apostles' days and other small feasts, which are wont to be kept with half solemnity, the whole office is held in German, both in the Old and the New Town

10.2 Chant on the apostles' days

The lower feasts have their own marks in several orders. They are enough to set them off from working days without matching Sundays.

Pomerania, Agenda, 1569 (Sehling 4, p. 469). The apostles' days:

Dise navolgenden aposteldage schal men viren vor middage. Des sondages to vörne schölen se de prediger affkündigen, jederman vormanen, dat he an disen dagen tor kercke kame, des avendes to vörne schal men festivaliter lüden edder beieren, unde vesper holden, des morgens desgeliken festivaliter lüden, to 7. edder to 8. predigen, jedoch neen testament utdele, doch mach men vor dem sermone dat amt vor dem altare holden, gloria, collecta, epistel unde evangelium cum tono lesen, up dat tüschen disen dagen unde gemenen werkeldagen underscheid si. Wennt in der kercke ut is, geit ein jeder to siner arbeit.

These following apostles' days one shall keep holy before noon. On the Sunday before, the preachers shall bid them and exhort every man to come to church on these days. On the evening before one shall ring or chime *festivaliter*, and hold vespers; in the morning likewise ring *festivaliter*, preach at seven or eight, yet deal out no testament [no communion]; but one may hold the office before the altar before the sermon, read the *Gloria*, collect, epistle and Gospel with the tone, that there may be a difference between these days and the common working days. When church is out, every man goeth to his work.

Aschersleben, Kirchen-Agenda, 1575 (Sehling 2, p. 480). The apostles' day Mass and vespers:

Von der vesper an der apostel abend. Die vesper soll gehalten werden wie am sonnabende, doch das man de festo singe und auch die collecten de festo lese. Von der messe an der apostel tage. 1. Nach dem geleute, welches geschehen soll, wie an einem werkeltage, hebt der cantor als palt mit dem introitu an. 2. Darauf folget das kyrie apostolicum. 3. Nochmals wird das teutsche „Allein gott in der höhe“ etc. gesungen. 4. Collecta de festo apostoli, darauf die epistel gelesen. [...] Von der vesper an der apostel tage. Die vesper wird gesungen ohne den organisten wie sonst am werktage, dieweil keine predigt gehalten.

Of vespers on the apostle's eve. Vespers shall be held as on the Saturday, yet so that one sing *de festo* and read the collects *de festo* also. Of the mass on the apostles' days. 1. After the ringing, which shall be done as on a working day, the cantor straightway beginneth the introit. 2. Thereupon followeth the *Kyrie apostolicum*. 3. Then is sung the German "Allein Gott in der Höh", etc. 4. The collect of the feast of the apostle, and

thereafter the epistle is read. [...] Of vespers on the apostles' days. Vespers are sung without the organist, as otherwise on a working day, since no sermon is held.

Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530 (Sehling 5, p. 15). The melody of the Kyrie:

Auf den introit, singt man das kyrie eleison, mit wenig noten (ausgenommen auf die hohen fest, da man notam paschalem nemen mag)

After the introit one singeth the Kyrie eleison with few notes (save on the high feasts, when one may take the paschal note)

10.3 Proper prefaces

Proper prefaces belonged only to the great feasts, and the orders use them to mark those days.

Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528 (Sehling 6/1, p. 441). The same text is in Hamburg 1529, p. 528:

Darnä keret he sick tome altare unde in den groten festen, de sunderge prefatien hebben, unde sus, wen he wil, up etlike Sundage mit der prefatie trinitatis (de wedder de Arrhianer alse ock dat symbolum nicenum gemaket is), schal he anheven latinisch de prefatie Dominus vobiscum unde singen se bet an dat ende, darup singe dat chör eyn latinisch Sanctus.

Thereafter he turneth him to the altar, and on the great feasts which have special prefaces, and else, when he will, on certain Sundays with the preface of the Trinity (which was made against the Arians, as was the Nicene Creed also), he shall begin in Latin the preface *Dominus vobiscum* and sing it to the end; whereupon let the choir sing a Latin Sanctus.

Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung of Ottheinrich*, second printing 1547 (Sehling 14, p. 109). The preface itself has two grades:

Es seind aber auf etliche hohe fest, Osterfest, Auffart, Pfingsten, Trinitatis etc., besondere prefation, von idem fest zwo, ein solemnis und eine dominicalis, die mag ein priester außnotiren oder außschreiben und auf dem pult alwegen neben der kirchenordnung haben

But for certain high feasts, the feast of Easter, the Ascension, Whitsuntide, Trinity, etc., there are special prefaces, two for each feast, a *solemnis* and a *dominicalis*; these a priest may note out or write out, and have always on the desk beside the church order

Note. The *solemnis* and *dominicalis* tones of the preface are the melodic grades of the medieval preface: the festal tone for the feast itself, the ferial or Sunday tone for the days within its season. The order prints the Trinity preface as its example.

Hatzkerode (Harzgerode, Anhalt), *Kirchenordnungen*, 1534(?) (Sehling 2, p. 587). On ordinary days an exhortation, on the great feasts the preface:

Als dan sol sich der priester umb keren und die exhortatio, wie die in der agende stehet, inen vorlesen. Auf den grossen festen aber sol an des stat die prefatio de festo gesungen werden mit dem gewonlichen sanctus latinisch.

Then shall the priest turn him about and read unto them the exhortation, as it standeth in the agenda. But on the great feasts, in the stead thereof, the preface of the feast shall be sung, with the wonted Sanctus in Latin.

Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575 (Sehling 4, p. 237):

Nach der predigt folget ein deutsch lied, darauf die priester in hohen festen die praefation de tempore auf gewöhnliche noten singen, aber in gemeinen sonntagen und feiertagen ohne dieselbige bald nach dem deutschen gesange sich gegen dem volke wendet

After the sermon followeth a German hymn; thereupon the priests on high feasts sing the preface *de tempore* to the wonted notes; but on the common Sundays and holy days [the priest], without the same, turneth to the people straightway after the German hymn

Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570 (Sehling 5, p. 89). German proper prefaces for the high feasts are allowed, "for variety":

Dar man aber auf die hohe fest zur verendrung (wie an dem fürstlichen hofe geschicht) diese nachverzeichnete und notirte praefationes für die quotidian singen wil, sol einem jedern kirchendiener frei sein

But where one will sing on the high feasts, for a change (as is done at the prince's court), these prefaces hereafter set down and noted, instead of the daily one, it shall be free to every minister

Note. Saxony 1539 prints Latin prefaces for Christmas, Epiphany, Easter, Ascension, Pentecost and Trinity, and a *Praefatio quotidiana* for all other days (Sehling 1, p. 274, editor's summary). The Mecklenburg family allows "prefationes de tempore" on the feasts of Christ (§5.2). Lippe 1571 restricts them to the *Vierzeiten* (§9.2).

10.4 Sequences

Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 (Sehling 23, p. 90). Sequences are dropped except on the three great feasts, and each great feast keeps its own sequence:

De Sequentien unde prosen scholen alle underlaten unde nicht gesungen werden, uthgenamen yn dren groten Festen Christi, also van Wynachten wente tho Lichtmissen: Grates nunc omnes, mit synem düdeschen gesange, Van Pa[...]sehen wente tho Pingesten: Victime Paschali, mit synem düdeschen gesange, Den yn den Pingesten: Veni, Sancte Spiritus, mit synem düdeschen gesange.

The sequences and proses shall all be left off and not be sung, save on the three great feasts of Christ: as from Christmas unto Candlemas, *Grates nunc omnes*, with its German song; from Easter unto Whitsuntide, *Victimae paschali*, with its German song; then in Whitsuntide, *Veni, Sancte Spiritus*, with its German song.

Note.

- **Seasons, not days.** The sequence is kept through the whole season of each great feast, from Christmas to Candlemas and from Easter to Whitsuntide.
- **Aschersleben 1575.** The cantor "die sontage nach diesen festen die sequentien in der kirchen singen" (p. 479).
- **The Mecklenburg family.** Sequences are "de tempore" on the feasts of Christ (§5.2).

10.5 Figural music and the organ

Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 (Sehling 5, p. 551):

Ock schal de figuralgesank in den vornemblikesten festen ordentlick in einem carspel sowol als in den andern gewachtet und gesungen werden.

Also the figural song shall on the chiefest feasts be orderly observed and sung in one parish as well as in the others.

Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592 (Sehling 11, p. 477, in the table of contents; the collection itself begins on p. 456). The title of the order's collection of polyphonic music:

XVI. Ordo suavissimarum et optimarum ex prasantissimis artificibus tum veteribus tum recentibus selectarum cantionum, quae in figurali musica cantore duce decantantur ad praecipua festa totius anni directus

XVI. An order of the sweetest and best songs, chosen out of the most excellent masters both old and new, which are sung in figural music under the leading of the cantor, directed to the chief feasts of the whole year

Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569 (Sehling 4, p. 466). In Rogation week there is no figural music or organ, except on the Ascension and its vigil:

Up disen sondach unde in der weke schal men kenen figural sang singen, ock nicht orglen, utgenamen den dach Ascensionis domini, mit der in vigilia

On this Sunday and in the week one shall sing no figural song, nor play the organ, save the day of the Ascension of the Lord, with its vigil

Other examples:

- **Anhalt 1568**: figural music on the first two days of the high feasts, Latin chorale on the third (§7.1).
- **Regensburg 1567**: figural music at the vespers before, and the communion on, the feasts of Christ (p. 475).
- **Henneberg 1582**: lower feasts are kept "one orgeln" (§6.3).
- **Schwarzburg 1587**: the organ is used on the apostles' days in the forenoon (Sehling 2, p. 137).
- **Aschersleben 1575**: the vespers of apostles' days are sung "ohne den organisten" (§10.2).

10.6 Vestments and elevation

Anhalt, *Kirchenordnung of Prince Bernhard*, 1568 (Sehling 2, p. 570). The elevation of the Sacrament is kept only on the high feasts:

Weil die elevation des hochwirdigen sacraments des waren leibes und blutes Christi in einer kirchen gefallen, in der andern aber nicht, so sollen die hern kirchendiener in hohen festen eleviren, ausserhalb denselben ist hochgedachter fürst Bernhart zu frieden, das es nach pleibe, desgleichen soll des sontags zu allen dreien predigten der chorrock gebraucht, die wochen uber auch nachgelassen werden.

Forasmuch as the elevation of the most worthy Sacrament of the true body and blood of Christ hath fallen away in one church but not in another, the ministers shall elevate on high feasts; beyond these the said Prince Bernhard is content that it be left off. Likewise on Sunday the choir robe shall be used at all three sermons, and through the week it may be left off.

Note.

- **Grimma 1529**. The mass vestment is required on the three-day high feasts (§7.1).

- **Querfurt.** According to Sehling's account of the visitation, mass vestments were worn at communion and, for a time, in the pulpit on the three chief feasts (Sehling 2, p. 460).

10.7 Bells

Altenburg, castle chapter, *Verordnung der ceremonien*, 1533 (Sehling 1, p. 516):

Zum dritten, so soll man auch hinfur die unterscheid halden, das man an gemeinen werktagen mit einer grossen glocken und am sontags und andern festen mit mer glocken zum heiligen ampt der predigt zu unterscheid der zeit leüte.

Thirdly, one shall also henceforth keep this difference: that on common working days one ring to the holy office of the sermon with one great bell, and on Sundays and other feasts with more bells, to distinguish the time.

The fullest bell-code is the Danzig one of 1612 (§5.6). It names five bells:

- Osanna;
- Apostolica;
- Dominical;
- Ferial;
- Sybilla.

The great feasts are rung in with the great bell and the three larger bells chimed together (*beiern*). The small feasts are chimed "with the Osanna".

10.8 The Athanasian Creed and the *Te Deum*

Mecklenburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1572 (Sehling 5, p. 258). The convents' matins:

Auf die hohen feste, als weinacht, epiphania, ostern, himmelfahrt, pfingsten, trinitatis, soll nach dem benedictus also balt das symbolum Athanasii teutsch gesungen werden.

On the high feasts, as Christmas, Epiphany, Easter, Ascension, Whitsuntide and Trinity, the Athanasian Creed shall be sung in German straightway after the Benedictus.

For the *Te Deum* in Latin "in maioribus festis" see Transylvania 1547 (§3.3). For the *Te Deum* as the Michaelmas thanksgiving see §8.5.

10.9 Communion and confession

The orders do not give the Supper by rank as such. Communion is held whenever there are communicants. But rank shows in the preparation and in the days on which communion is normally held.

- **Regensburg 1567.** Communion and vespers on the eve go with every feast of Christ, but not with the third day of the great feasts (§7.1).
- **Pomerania 1569.** No communion on apostles' days (§10.2).
- **Stade, *Kirchenordnung*, c. 1620/22** (Sehling 7/1, p. 54). On the three high feasts confession is heard after the afternoon sermon of the first day, and the Supper is given on the second day, "welches am ersten und letzten festage nicht geschicht", which is not done on the first and the last feast day.

- **First vespers.** The vespers of the eve of the higher feasts were also the time for private confession of the next day's communicants (for example Leiningen 1584, p. 278: "an den hohen festagen am abent zuvor ein vesper").

10.10 Weddings, guild feasts and markets

Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*, 1580 (Sehling 2, p. 240):

Von den hochzeiten auf die heuptfeste. Weil es auf die heuptfest sehr unbequem ist, das in den selbigen wirtschaften gehalten werden, so sollen hinfurt dieselben auf solche feste genzlich ein gestellet sein, und auf weinachten acht tage zuvor, und für dem sontage nach trium regum, desgleichen in ostern, für dem sontage quasimodogeniti, auch in pfingsten, für dem sontage trinitatis keine hochzeit gestattet werden

Of weddings at the chief feasts. Forasmuch as it is very unmeet that wedding-feasts be held at the chief feasts, the same shall henceforth be wholly stayed at such feasts: and at Christmas, eight days before, and until the Sunday after the Three Kings; likewise at Easter until the Sunday Quasimodogeniti; and at Whitsuntide until the Sunday Trinity, no wedding shall be allowed

Hadersleben, *Zuchtordnung*, 1573 (Sehling 23, p. 244):

Es sollen auch die gilden auf den hohen festen und sonderlich dem Pfingstdage nicht mehr gehalten, besondern auf den andern tag verschoben werden.

The guild-feasts also shall no more be held on the high feasts, and especially on Whitsunday, but be put off to another day.

Brandenburg, *Visitation- und Consistorialordnung*, 1573 (Sehling 3, p. 129):

Die obrigkeiten sollen auch verordnen, das die wochenmerkte, so an hohen festen gefallen, bis nach mittage oder auf den andern folgenden tag verschoben, auf das gottes wort dadurch nicht möge verhindert werden.

The magistrates also shall ordain that the weekly markets which fall on high feasts be put off until after noon, or to the next day following, that God's Word be not hindered thereby.

11. Occurrence and transfer

The medieval rubrics had detailed tables of "occurrence" (two feasts on the same day) and "concurrence" (the vespers of one feast meeting the first vespers of the next). A feast of higher grade displaced one of lower grade, which was commemorated or transferred. The Lutheran orders keep the principle, but apply it to three practical cases:

- a feast that falls on a Sunday;
- the Annunciation in Holy Week;
- a lesser feast that falls on a Saturday, or in the same week as another.

Their rules show how the ranks of \$5 were understood: Sunday against feast, feast of Christ against Passiontide, apostle against working week.

11.1 A feast on a Sunday

The general rule is that a feast of Christ displaces the Sunday Gospel, while an apostles' day yields to it.

Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560 (Sehling 5, p. 288):

So aber grosse feste auf den sonntag fallen, als weinachten, S. Stephani, S. Joannis evangelistae, den neuen jars, der heiligen kö-nige, purificationis M., annunciationis M., Joannis Baptista, visitationis M. und Michaelis, sol man die evangelia von den festen behalten. [...] 7. Wen aber uff den sontage der apostel fest fallen, sol man die sontags evangelia behalten und die evangelia so uff die apostel fest fallen, auf den nachmittage predigen.

But if great feasts fall on the Sunday, as Christmas, St Stephen, St John the Evangelist, New Year's, the Three Kings, the Purification of Mary, the Annunciation of Mary, John the Baptist, the Visitation of Mary and Michaelmas, one shall keep the Gospels of the feasts. [...] 7. But when the apostles' feasts fall on the Sunday, one shall keep the Sunday Gospels, and preach the Gospels that fall on the apostles' feasts in the afternoon.

Note. St Stephen and St John count here as "great feasts", as days of Christmas, while the apostles do not.

Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*, 1580 (Sehling 2, p. 240). The apostles' days, by the day of the week on which they fall:

Felt ein apostel tag auf einen sontag, so mag er gehalten werden wie er gefellet, doch das man in den stedten in den kirchen, da man des sontags zwei oder drei mal predigt, auf derselbigen predigt eine, das sontags evangelium auch auslege. Felt ein apostel tag auf einen montag, dienstag, mitwoch, donnerstag, oder freitag, kan man in auf den tag, darauf er gefellet in den stedten, wie es gebreuchlich ist, halten, da es aber breuchlich ist, denselben auf den nechstfolgenden tag, darinne man sonst wochen predigten helt, zuverlegen, da mag es bei solcher gewonheit bleiben. Felt aber ein aposteltag auf einen sonnabend, sol er auf den nechstfolgenden sontag verlegt und gehalten werden.

If an apostle's day fall on a Sunday, it may be kept as it falleth; yet so that in the towns, in the churches where there is preaching two or three times on Sunday, the Sunday Gospel also be expounded in one of the same sermons. If an apostle's day fall on a Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday or Friday, it may be kept in the towns on the day whereon it falleth, as is customary; but where it is customary to remove it to the next following day whereon the week-day sermons are otherwise held, it may abide by that custom. But if an apostle's day fall on a Saturday, it shall be removed to the next following Sunday, and kept thereon.

Note.

- **Wintzingerode.** The order (Sehling 2, p. 256) has the same rules. There the apostle's Gospel goes to the Sunday afternoon.
- **Thorn 1575.** Small feasts falling near a Sunday go to its vespers (§5.6).
- **Danzig 1612.** A small feast falling on a Sunday is rung like a great one (§5.6).
- **Nördlingen 1579.** A local thanksgiving day falling on a Sunday is to be kept "solenniter wie andere hohe festa" (Sehling 12, p. 388).

11.2 The Annunciation in Holy Week

The Annunciation (25 March) often falls between Palm Sunday and Low Sunday. The orders count it as a feast of Christ. It cannot simply be dropped, and it may not displace the Passion and Easter. The orders give at least

six solutions:

Solution	Orders
The Saturday before Palm Sunday (<i>Palmabend</i>)	Hadersleben 1528; Schleswig-Holstein 1542; Merseburg 1544; Anhalt 1568; Pomerania 1569; Sayn 1582
Palm Sunday itself, in the forenoon	Aschersleben 1575; Schwarzburg 1587; Wintzingerode (only if it falls Wednesday to Saturday, "per anticipationem")
A weekday of the week before Palm Sunday	Waldeck 1556 (Wednesday after Judica); Hoya 1571 and Harlingerland 1573/74 (Thursday after Judica)
The Sunday after Easter ("nach alter gewonheit")	Prussia 1526, 1544 and 1568
Maundy Thursday	Burzenland chapter, 1573 (a proposal of the dean for that year)
Omitted that year	Ysenburg 1582
A convenient day agreed with the neighbouring churches	Thorn 1575

Hadersleben, *Artikel*, 1528 (Sehling 23, p. 64):

Wnser frowen vorkundinge dach (unnd wen de up den Gronen Donnersdach valt effte darnha, ßo sal me ohn eintrechtlich up den Sonnavent vor Palmarum holden, sunst sal me ohn nicht transfereren)

Our Lady's Annunciation day (and when it falleth on Maundy Thursday or thereafter, it shall be kept with one accord on the Saturday before Palm Sunday; otherwise it shall not be transferred)

Merseburg, *Synodalunterricht*, 1544 (Sehling 2, p. 20):

Mit verlegung aber der fest, das annunciationis Marie, do dis in die marterwoche gefiele, auf den palmabent gelegt wurde. Der andern feste verlegunge solle durch das consistorium bestimbt und idem superattendenten den pfarhern in synodis angezeigt werden.

But as touching the removing of the feasts: that the Annunciation of Mary, if it should fall in the week of the Passion, be laid on the eve of Palm Sunday. The removing of the other feasts shall be determined by the consistory, and shown to the parsons in the synods by the superintendent.

Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569 (Sehling 4, p. 469):

Wenn de dach der vorkündiginge Marie velt in de stilleweke, idt si weckeren dach idt si, schal men dat fest vorlegen up palmavend unde sölckes am sondage Iudica to vörne affkündigen.

When the day of the Annunciation of Mary falleth in the still week, be it what day it be, one shall lay the feast on the eve of Palm Sunday, and bid the same beforehand on the Sunday Judica.

Wintzingerode (Gericht Bodenstein), *Kirchen-Ordnung* (Sehling 2, p. 256):

So das fest annunciationis Mariae in der marterwochen auf einen montag oder dienstag einfellet, so soll es auf dieselbigen gehalten werden. Fellet es aber auf den mittwochen, grünen donnerstag,

charfreitag oder oster abent, soll mans (wie es die alten nennen) per anticipationem zurück auf den palm-sonntag feiern.

If the feast of the Annunciation of Mary fall in the week of the Passion on a Monday or Tuesday, it shall be kept on the same. But if it fall on the Wednesday, Maundy Thursday, Good Friday or Easter Eve, one shall keep it holy (as the ancients call it) *per anticipationem*, back upon Palm Sunday.

Note. *Per anticipationem* is the old term for moving a feast back, before its date. "As the ancients call it" shows that the orders knew they were using the medieval rules of transfer.

Schwarzburg, *Ordnung der fest und feiertage*, 1587 (Sehling 2, p. 137):

Wenn aber das fest Adnunciationis, wie bisweil geschicht, in die marter wochen gefiel, soll er auf den sonntag palmarum gelegt und vormittag solenniter gehalten, das evangelium aber desselben sontags nachmittag geprediget werden

But if the feast of the Annunciation, as sometimes happeneth, fell in the week of the Passion, it shall be laid on Palm Sunday and kept solemnly in the forenoon, but the Gospel of the same Sunday be preached in the afternoon

Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 (Sehling 9, p. 272):

Es soll aber diß fest (ergerliche ungleicheit zue verhuten) mittwochen nach Judica gehalten werden, wens auf den palmtag oder in palmwochen fellet, sonst sol es auff den tag, [auf den] es kompt, gehalten werden

But this feast shall be kept (to avoid offensive inequality) on the Wednesday after Judica, when it falleth on Palm Sunday or in Palm week; otherwise it shall be kept on the day whereon it cometh

Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568 (Sehling 4, p. 87):

Wann der tag Conceptionis Christi oder Annunciationis Mariae auf den palmtag oder in der woche vor ostern oder dieselbige folgende wochen in den ostertagen gefellet, soll er den nechsten sonntag nach ostern gehalten und lauts der vorigen kirchenordnung transferirt werden, damit dieselbige zeit vom einreiten des herrn Christi und sein heiliges leiden sammt der historien der auferstehung unverhindert nach nothdurft müge geprediget werden.

When the day of the Conception of Christ or the Annunciation of Mary falleth on Palm Sunday, or in the week before Easter, or in the same following week in the Easter days, it shall be kept on the next Sunday after Easter, and be transferred according to the former church order; that the same time may be preached, without hindrance and as need requireth, of the riding in of the Lord Christ and his holy Passion, together with the history of the resurrection.

Note. The rule goes back to the Prussian order of 1526 (Sehling 4, p. 38). That order keeps the day after Easter "nach alter gewonheit", after the old custom, which is the medieval practice of transferring the Annunciation to the week after Low Sunday.

Burzenland chapter (Transylvania), resolutions of 25 February 1573 (Sehling 24, p. 371). In 1573 Easter fell on 22 March, so the Annunciation fell on the Wednesday after Easter. The dean writes:

6. In veteri ecclesiae computo festum Annuntiationis Mariae sive Conceptionis Christi assignatum est 25 Martii, qui cadit in diem Mercurii post resuscitatum Christum, ubi alia plura festa concur[...]. Si tunc celebraverimus illud, ingluviem et intemperantiam auxerimus in nostratibus. Calendariorum vulgarium huius anni authores retraxerunt in diem sabbathi ante Palmarum. Is dies profanis mercaturis plus quam celebrationi festorum dicatus est. Ego igitur festum illud celebrabo ad feriam 5 ante Pascha, quae dicitur dies Coena Domini.

6. In the old reckoning of the Church the feast of the Annunciation of Mary, or Conception of Christ, is assigned to the 25th of March, which falleth on the Wednesday after Christ's rising again, when several other feasts concur. If we celebrate it then, we shall increase gluttony and intemperance among our people. The makers of the common calendars of this year have drawn it back to the Saturday before Palm Sunday. That day is more given to profane marketing than to the celebration of feasts. I will therefore celebrate that feast on the fifth day before Easter, which is called the day of the Lord's Supper.

Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575 (Sehling 4, pp. 239–240). The order admits that practice varies:

Weil es aber mit erwehlung eines bequemen tages nicht in allen orten gleichförmig gehalten wird, wie in denen alten und neuen kirchenordnungen zusehen, so ist es am sichersten, auch am bequemsten, dass man sich mit denen um und nahe gelegenen kirchen und städten vergleiche, das fest mii ihnen auf einen tag zuhalten, ob sie gleich nicht [...] alle in der religion mit uns zustimmen, damit nur der schwachen etlicher massen wahrgenommen werde.

But because in the choosing of a convenient day it is not held alike in all places, as is to be seen in the old and new church orders, it is surest and also most convenient that one agree with the churches and towns lying round about and near, to keep the feast with them on one day, though they do not [...] all agree with us in religion; only that the weak may in some measure be cared for.

11.3 Saturdays, harvests and two feasts in one week

Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582 (Sehling 2, p. 313). For the "common feasts" of the second rank:

Wenn aber ein gemein fest auf einen sonntag gefiele, sol desselbigen sontags verordnetes evangelium fort geprediget, das fest verkündiget, und, das auf nechstfolgenden mitwochen die historien oder festes evangelium zu predigen verlegt sei, dem volk angezeigt werden. So aber zwei oder mehr gemeine fest in eine wochen fielen, sol das erste auf den tag, darauf es gefellt, gehalten, des andern festes historia oder evangelium aber auf den folgenden mittwoch der andern wochen ordentlich gehandelt, und solches gleichwol allwege auf den sonntag zuvor verkündiget werden.

But if a common feast should fall on a Sunday, the Gospel appointed for the same Sunday shall be preached as usual, the feast proclaimed, and it shall be shewn to the people that the history or Gospel of the feast is removed to be preached on the next following Wednesday. But if two or more common feasts fall in one week, the first shall be kept on the day whereon it falleth; but the history or Gospel of the other shall be orderly handled on the following Wednesday of the next week; and this nevertheless shall always be proclaimed on the Sunday before.

Aschersleben, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1575 (Sehling 2, p. 479):

Wan aber das fest auf einen sonnabent felt, so wird es vorlegt bis auf den sonntag nachmittage. Weil auch der tag Jacobi apostoli in der ernten kompt, pflegt man das fest, wan es auf einen freitag oder sonnabent gefelt, auf den nechsten sonntag darnach nachmittage zuhandeln.

But when the feast falleth on a Saturday, it is removed until the Sunday afternoon. Also, because the day of James the apostle cometh in the harvest, it is the custom, when it falleth on a Friday or Saturday, to handle the feast on the next Sunday after, in the afternoon.

Schwarzburg, *Ordnung der fest und feiertage*, 1587 (Sehling 2, p. 137). Apostles' days are not moved, except from a Saturday:

die festa der aposteln, sollen ohne unterlassung und ohne einige vorlegung auf den tag, do sie gefallen, feierlich gehalten werden, vormittag dan auch die orgeln, wo man sie hat, gebraucht werden sollen [...] doch wan ein solch apostel fest auf einen sonnabend gefellet, soll es den sonntag hernach zur vesper volgen und gehalten werden

the feasts of the apostles shall be kept solemnly, without omission and without any removing, on the day whereon they fall; in the forenoon also the organs, where there be any, shall be used [...] yet when such an apostle's feast falleth on a Saturday, it shall follow on the Sunday after, at vespers, and be kept then

11.4 Moving not allowed

Against these rules for moving feasts, several orders forbid pastors to move feasts on their own authority, whether for markets or to save themselves work.

Salzwedel (Altstadt), *Visitations-Abschied*, 1579 (Sehling 3, p. 275):

darum verordnen die visitatores, das der pfarherr und caplane allhie die festage, an den tagen, daran sie gefallen, inhalts der kirchen und visitationordenunge christlich und solemniter halten und nicht nach ihren gefallen verschieben oder verlegen, noch einige fest auslassen sollen, ungeachtet, do die gleich auf die marktage gefielen

therefore the visitors ordain that the parson and chaplains here shall keep the feast days on the days whereon they fall, according to the church and visitation orders, in Christian manner and solemnly, and not put them off or remove them at their pleasure, nor leave out any feast, notwithstanding they should fall on the market days

Sayn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1590 (Sehling 19/1, p. 389):

Es soll auch kein Pfarrherr Macht haben, dieselbige Fest oder Feyertage zuverlegen auff andere Tag, sondern sich genügen lassen zu feyren auff die Tag, darauff sie fallen, damit kein Ungleichheit gehalten werde zum Ergerniß und Nachrede, etc.

Neither shall any parson have power to remove the same feasts or holy days to other days, but he shall content himself to keep them holy on the days whereon they fall, that no inequality be held, to offence and evil report, etc.

Kosd and Schelken chapters (Transylvania), statutes, 1577 (Sehling 24, p. 400). Following the sentence quoted in §4.7:

Si quis vero in gratiam suorum colonorum aliquem diem festum celebraverit, qui in cathalogo festorum non est, aut festum in alium diem celebrandum reiecerit, poena capituli punietur

But if any, to please his peasants, shall have celebrated any feast day which is not in the catalogue of feasts, or shall have put off a feast to be celebrated on another day, he shall be punished with the chapter's penalty

12. The short calendars: Upper German towns and the Reformed

At the other end from the conservative lists of §5.7 stand the orders that kept only Sunday and a handful of high feasts. In these the question of rank hardly arises: there is Sunday, and there are the few feasts of Christ that remain. They are mostly Upper German cities under Zwinglian or Bucerian influence, and later Reformed territories. Their history shows how unstable the minimum was.

Mülhausen (Alsace), council decree on processions and holy days, 1524 (Sehling 20/2, p. 196). The first step keeps four "high-tides" with the Marian feasts and the apostles, and abolishes the local and lesser days. Among them is "der achtest Sannt Steffans", the octave of St Stephen, the only octave named in any list of abolished feasts:

Das unnd anders angesehen, ist geordent, das man hinfur den heiligen Sonntag vorab unnd darzu die hohen fest: die vier hochzitt, Unnser lieben frawen unnd der appostel tag eeren unnd began sol, wie ge[...]wonheit ist. Aber dise nachbestimpten tag, mit namen: der Kindlin tag, der achtest Sannt Steffans, Marcus, die zwen heilig crutztag, keyser Heinrich [...] Magdalena, Sant Steffan im Ougsten, Laurentius, kalte kilby, Gallus, Lucas, Katherina, Nicolaus, Ostermitwoch unnd Pfingstmitwoch, die alle sollen hinfur nit mer gebotten werden zu feyren noch fur feyrtag gehalten; aber nütdestminder sollen deren gedechtnuß uff yedes tag in der kilchen beganngen werden, vorab mit verkundung des gotsworts unnd darnach mit den emptern der mesß, wie gewonheit ist

This and other things considered, it is ordained that henceforth men shall honour and keep first the holy Sunday, and thereto the high feasts, the four high-tides, our dear Lady's days and the apostles' days, as the custom is. But these days hereafter appointed, by name: the Children's day, the eighth day of St Stephen, Mark, the two holy Cross days, the Emperor Henry [...] Magdalene, St Stephen in August, Laurence, the cold church-hallowing, Gallus, Luke, Catherine, Nicholas, Easter Wednesday and Whitsun Wednesday: these shall all henceforth be no more commanded to be kept holy, nor held for holy days; but nevertheless their memory shall be kept on each day in the church, first with the proclaiming of God's Word and thereafter with the offices of the mass, as the custom is

Note. The "cold church-hallowing" (*kalte kilby*) is the dedication feast of Basel Minster, 11 October. The "four high-tides" at Mülhausen are Christmas, Easter, Ascension and Pentecost (see the next quotation).

Mülhausen, opinion on the Basel and Strasbourg orders, 1529 (Sehling 20/2, pp. 214–215). Five years later the town adopted the Basel order:

Item mit den feyertagen sols noch Baßler ordnung gehalten werden, die nit meer dann den Winachsdag, den Uffart-, den Ostertag und Pfingstag mit [...] sampt den Sontagen zu fyren verordnet haben.

Item, with the holy days it shall be kept after the Basel order, which hath ordained to keep holy no more than Christmas day, Ascension day, Easter day and Whitsunday, together with the Sundays.

Augsburg, Feiertagsordnung of the council, 22 July 1537 (Sehling 12, p. 84):

so hat ein rat derhalben angesehen und erkenntet, das furohin allein die sonntäg - und alle abent der sambstäg um drei ur nach mittem tag anzufahren desgleichen der Christag, Ostertag und Pfingstag (ußerhalb einiger nachfeier), [...] dazu der Neujarstag, der tag der Auffart Christi und der tag der Verkundigung Mariä gefeiret werden, dardurch alle und jede andere feiertag alhie, keinen

ausgenommen, hiemit aufgehoben sein sollen, also das meniglich an allen und jeden andern tagen außerhalb der obbemelten feiertag wol arbeiten und in schwais des angesichts die narung suchen mag.

therefore the council hath considered and resolved that henceforth only the Sundays (and every Saturday evening, to begin at three of the clock after midday), likewise Christmas day, Easter day and Whitsunday (without any after-holiday), [...] thereto New Year's day, the day of the Ascension of Christ and the day of the Annunciation of Mary, be kept holy; whereby all and every other holy day here, none excepted, shall hereby be taken away, so that every man may on all and every other day, beside the holy days aforesaid, well work and seek his living in the sweat of his face.

Note. "ußerhalb einiger nachfeier", "without any after-holiday", abolishes the second and third days of the great feasts. The Saturday evening, from three o'clock, is treated as part of the Sunday.

Esslingen, council decrees of 1537 (Sehling 17/2, pp. 389–390). The council first abolished everything but Sunday and Christmas (22a), then brought the apostles' days back (22b):

Dweil aber ein ersamer rath vermerckt, das an solchen feiertagen das gemein volck meher zu offen zechen unnd anderer leichtfertigung dann zuverkhindung des gotlichen worts geneigt, damit dann solich ubel, so uß dem miessiggang entsteen, abgestellt und ain jeder zu theglicher arbeit getzogen, hat ein ersamer rath alle feiertag ausserhalb das deß heiligen sontags unnd weihenacht tag gantzlich abgeschafft und will, das der selbigen khainer meher gefeirt, besonder ain jeder sich an solchen tagen zu seiner teglichen arbeit geschickt mache. [...] und aber yetzo augenscheinlichen befunden, das, gleich so wol uff die gute montag also hievor uff die feiertag geschehen, alle fillerei unnd unzucht, sonderlich bey dem jungen folck jern fûrganng haben, aber allein dem hailsamen Gottes wort kein zeit noch weil gegeben werden mag [...] so thut ir ersam [...] weißhait auß disen hievor erzellten unnd anndern mehr beweglichen ursachenn ordnen und will, das hinfiro nebenn denn gepannten sontägen der hailligen apostel tag widerumb gefeirt und an denselben das Gottes wort verkhint unnd gehört werde

But forasmuch as an honourable council perceiveth that on such holy days the common people are more given to open carousing and other lightness than to the preaching of the divine Word; that such evil, which ariseth out of idleness, may be put down, and every man drawn to his daily work, an honourable council hath wholly done away all holy days, beside the holy Sunday and Christmas day, and willeth that none of the same be kept holy any more, but that every man betake himself on such days to his daily work. [...] and now it is found plainly that on the "good Mondays", even as heretofore on the holy days, all drunkenness and unchastity have their course, especially among the young folk, while no time nor leisure can be given to the wholesome Word of God alone [...] therefore their honourable wisdom, for these causes aforesaid and more other weighty causes, ordaineth and willeth that henceforth, beside the commanded Sundays, the holy apostles' days be kept holy again, and God's Word be preached and heard thereon

Note. The "gute Montage" were the "blue Mondays" that craftsmen took off. The Esslingen council learned that abolishing holy days did not abolish holidays, and restored the apostles' days in order to have days for preaching.

Strasbourg, synodal decrees, 1544 (Sehling 20/1, pp. 342–343). Only Sunday is a holy day in the city. The saints are remembered in the sermon, and the countryside may keep its half and whole days:

Weil inn der stat allein der Sonnetag gefeiret würt, sollen die prediger das volck oft und mit allem ernst ver-[...]manen, das sie solche feyre dem Herren gantzlich heiligen. Sollen auch auff die selbigen, wann inn der wochen die tag fallen, auff [...] welche man sunst der fûrnemen werck Gottes, so er an

seinem lieben son oder auch den apostolen und martyren gewürcket, gedechtnüssen und feire haltet, solcher gedechtnüssen, historien, wan man die inn der Schrifft oder sunst inn bewerten bücheren hat, dem volck fürtragen [...] Wa aber auff dem land solche gedechtnüssen noch ire feire den gantzen oder halben tag haben, da solle man sie christlich behalten.

Because in the city only the Sunday is kept holy, the preachers shall oft and with all earnestness exhort the people that they hallow such rest wholly unto the Lord. They shall also on the same [Sundays], when the days fall in the week whereon otherwise memorials and holy days are kept of the chief works of God which he hath wrought in his dear Son, or also in the apostles and martyrs, set forth to the people the memorials and histories of the same, when they are had in the Scripture or else in approved books [...] But where in the country such memorials still have their holy day, the whole or the half day, there they shall be kept in Christian wise.

Nassau-Dillenburg (Reformed), *Kirchenordnung*, 1582 (Sehling 10, p. 163). After the county turned Reformed:

48. Omnia festa sanctorum et abusus feriarum abrogentur et soli Dominici dies atque festa Christi retineantur.

48. Let all feasts of the saints and the abuses of holy days be abrogated, and let the Lord's days only and the feasts of Christ be retained.

Note. The same county's Lutheran order of 1537 had kept Corpus Christi, the Assumption and the Nativity of Mary (§5.7, §8.9).

Kurpfalz (Reformed), *Kirchenordnung*, 1563 (Sehling 14, p. 397). The Palatine order of 1556 had followed Württemberg (§5.3). Its Reformed successor keeps only the three great feasts, New Year and Ascension:

Ordnung der feiertägen. An den feyertagen soll es gehalten werden wie am Sonntag. Diese feyertag aber sollen gehalten werden: Alle Sonntag. Der Christag sampt dem nechsten tag hernach. Der Jarßtag. Der Ostertag sampt dem nechsten tag hernach. Die Himelfahrt Christi. Der Pfingstag sampt volgendem Montag hernach.

Order of the holy days. On the holy days it shall be done as on Sunday. But these holy days shall be kept: all Sundays; Christmas day with the next day after; New Year's day; Easter day with the next day after; the Ascension of Christ; Whitsunday with the Monday following after.

Note. The editor notes that the 1556 order "hatte noch zusätzlich: Epiphantias, die Marien- und Aposteltage, Johannis Baptistae und Michaelis": it still had Epiphany, the Marian and apostles' days, John the Baptist and Michaelmas.

Anhalt, Prince Johann Georg to the superintendent, 4 March 1599 (Sehling 2, p. 535). When Anhalt turned Reformed, the prince ordered a new agenda on the Palatine model:

eine algemeine agenda dieses fursten thums kirchen, auf und nach der pfälzischen gerichtet und derselben gleichförmig, zuvorfassen, und dass in derselben der apostel und andere festa eingestellt, und in den dreien haubt festen mehr nicht dann zwene tage gefeiert, der dritte aber gar abgeschaffet

to draw up a general agenda for the churches of this principality, directed upon and after the Palatine one and conformable to the same; and that therein the apostles' and other feasts be discontinued, and in the three chief feasts no more than two days be kept holy, but the third be wholly abolished

Note. With these reductions, the ranking of §5 falls back to the two ranks of Luther's *Formula missae*: Sunday and the feasts of the Lord.

13. Concordance of the orders quoted

Every order quoted in this guide is listed below by region. The table gives:

- **Sehling**: the volume and pages in Sehling's edition.
- **Doc**: the [eko.db](#) document that holds the text, for full-text lookup. Note that a single database record may hold several orders.
- **Ranking**: a short description of the order's system.
- **§**: the sections where the order is quoted.

Luther; Saxony and Thuringia

Order	Sehling	Doc	Ranking	§
Wittenberg, Luther, <i>Formula missae</i> , 1523	1, pp. 5, 9	2	two ranks: Sundays and "feasts of the Lord"; saints' feasts abolished or folded into Sunday preaching; Purification and Annunciation counted as feasts of Christ; Holy Cross "anathema"	3.3, 4.1
Saxony (Ernestine), <i>Unterricht der Visitatoren</i> , 1528	1, pp. 164–169	9	feasts of Christ "in sonderheit"; Marian, John, Michael, apostles, Magdalene desirable where not fallen away; Latin on high feasts	4.4, 5.2, 10.1
Amt Grimma, <i>Generalia</i> , 1529	1, p. 576	90	high feasts three days, with vestments	7.1
Amt Leisnig, <i>Verordnung</i> , 1529	1, p. 610	105	three high feasts three days, <i>festive</i>	3.5
Ernestine Saxony, <i>Gemeine Verordnung</i> , 1533	1, p. 192	14	Latin Mass on high feasts in towns	10.1
Altenburg castle chapter, 1533	1, p. 516	56	more bells on Sundays and feasts	10.7
Saxony (Albertine), <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1539	1, p. 274	30	high chief feasts of Christ (incl. Purification, Annunciation, Maundy Thursday, Good Friday); then John, Visitation, Michael; apostles forenoon or moved to Sunday	4.7, 5.2
Merseburg, <i>Synodalunterricht</i> , 1544	2, p. 20	1211	whole-day feasts; forenoon feasts "ohne gebotene feir" (Maundy Thursday, Good Friday, apostles); Annunciation to Palm eve	5.2, 11.2
Burg, <i>Kirchen-Ordnung</i> , 1542	2, p. 427	1257	vespers and sermon <i>in vigiliis</i> of high feasts	3.6

Order	Sehling	Doc	Ranking	§
Gera (Plauen extract), 1556	2, pp. 158–159	1234	feasts of Christ and apostles with Gospel histories; Stephen and John as Christmas days	4.7
Penig, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1575	1, p. 634	116	high feasts: 3, 2, 1 sermons on successive days	6.3
Schwarzburg, <i>Ordnung der fest und feiertage</i> , 1587	2, p. 137	1230	three chief feasts three days (third forenoon only); seven feasts whole day <i>solemniter</i> ; apostles forenoon, not moved	7.1, 11.2, 11.3
Henneberg, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1582	2, pp. 312–313	1247	four chief feasts incl. Ascension, two sermons; "common feasts" one sermon, no organ; rules for occurrence	6.3, 11.3
Goldlauter (Henneberg), 1566	2, p. 333	1248	Christmas three days, Easter and Whitsun two	7.2

Harz counties, Magdeburg and Halberstadt, Anhalt

Order	Sehling	Doc	Ranking	§
Mansfeld, <i>Kirchen-agenda</i> , 1580	2, pp. 239–240	1241	whole days and half days listed; apostles by day of the week; harvest apostles moved; no weddings at chief feasts	6.2, 6.4, 10.10, 11.1
Wintzingerode (after Hohnstein), undated	2, p. 256	1243	whole days two sermons, third day of chief feasts one; half days; Annunciation <i>per anticipationem</i>	6.2, 11.2
Aschersleben, <i>Kirchen-Agenda</i> , 1575	2, pp. 479–480	1260	three chief feasts; eight "middle" feasts as Sundays, figural; apostles forenoon, <i>Kyrie apostolicum</i>	5.5, 10.2, 11.3
Ermsleben, <i>Kirchen-Ordnung</i> , 1564	2, p. 486	1260	high feasts whole day, two sermons; apostles forenoon	6.2
Anhalt, Nicolaus Hausmann's order, 1532	2, p. 542	1262	one wide list incl. Corpus Christi, Conception, Assumption, Nativity of Mary; apostles forenoon; night vigil of Christmas and Easter wished for	3.6, 5.7
Anhalt, <i>Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge</i> , 1551	2, pp. 554–555	1262	high feasts / other Sundays and feasts / weekdays <i>ferialiter</i> (no <i>Gloria</i>)	3.5
Hatzkerode (Anhalt), 1534(?)	2, p. 587	1263	preface on great feasts, exhortation otherwise	10.3
Anhalt, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> of Prince Bernhard, 1568	2, pp. 569–570	1262	apostles, John, Magdalene, Purification, Annunciation, Michael kept; Visitation and Nativity of Mary <i>ferialiter</i> ; high feasts two days	3.5, 7.1, 10.6

Order	Sehling	Doc	Ranking	§
			figural, third Latin chorale; elevation on high feasts	
Anhalt, Prince Johann Georg, 1599	2, p. 535	1261	Reformed: apostles' and other feasts discontinued; high feasts two days only	12

Brandenburg, Prussia, Pomerania, the Baltic, Poland and Silesia

Order	Sehling	Doc	Ranking	§
Brandenburg (Electorate), <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1540	3, p. 87	1746	one long list incl. Corpus Christi, Assumption, Nativity of Mary, All Saints, Martin, Laurence, Catherine	5.7
Neumark, visitation instruction, 1540	3, p. 36	1745	collection on high feasts "nicht allein die vier zeiten"	9.3
Crevese nunnery, recess, 1541	3, p. 203	1762	Office <i>de tempore</i> and of high feasts; saints' days from the <i>commune sanctorum</i>	3.4
Brandenburg, <i>Visitation- und Consistorialordnung</i> , 1573	3, p. 129	1748	markets on high feasts moved	10.10
Salzwedel (Altstadt), visitation recess, 1579	3, p. 275	1779	feasts not to be moved to Sundays or market days	11.4
Tangermünde, <i>Ritus</i> , 1603	3, p. 338	1788	<i>summae festivitates</i>	3.2
Prussia, <i>Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien</i> , 1568 (after 1526, 1544)	4, pp. 38, 87	1833	apostles forenoon only; Annunciation in Holy Week to the Sunday after Easter; Magdalene's Gospel on Trinity 7	6.1, 8.8, 11.2
Pomerania, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1535	4, p. 343	1856	three great feasts three days; feasts of Christ, John, Visitation, Michael	5.4
Pomerania, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1542	4, p. 356	1859	Kyrie grades: <i>summum</i> on the higher feasts	3.2
Pomerania, <i>Agenda</i> , 1569	4, pp. 466–469	1865	three great feasts three days, wholly kept; other feasts; apostles forenoon, <i>festivaliter</i> bells, no communion; Annunciation to Palm eve	10.2, 10.5, 11.2
Pomerania, <i>Kerckenordeninge</i> , 1569	4, p. 414	1862	the four-times penny	9.1
Riga, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1530	5, pp. 15, 17	1897	all feasts of Christ, and the Visitation; paschal Kyrie on high feasts	4.7, 10.2
Kurland, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1570	5, p. 89	1907	proper German prefaces on high feasts	10.3

Order	Sehling	Doc	Ranking	§
Danzig, St Mary's, 1567, with draft <i>Feiertagsordnung</i>	4, pp. 186–187	1844	feasts with four sermons and vigils; apostles, angels, Visitation two early sermons; third day disputed	7.1
Danzig, St Mary's, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1612	4, pp. 203–204	1844	great feasts (three sermons) and small feasts (one sermon), marked by bells	5.6, 10.7
Thorn, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1575	4, pp. 237–240	1844	feasts of Christ, great feasts three days; "small or half feasts" two sermons, German office; Annunciation moved by agreement	5.6, 10.1, 10.3, 11.2
Posen, Bohemian Brethren, 1576	4, p. 285	1846	Sunday first in dignity, as moral law	4.8
Teschen, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1584	3, p. 461	1815	one long list incl. Nativity of Mary, Martin, Catherine; any may be a half day	5.7
Brieg, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1592	3, p. 445	1809	three Marian feasts, John, Michael whole day; apostles one early sermon	6.2

The Low German north

Order	Sehling	Doc	Ranking	§
Braunschweig, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> (Bugenhagen), 1528	6/1, pp. 380, 397–398, 441	1983	three great feasts three days, four sermons a day; other Gospel feasts fully kept; Michaelmas a four-times feast; apostles moved to Sunday; proper prefaces; a new feast of Christ's baptism	4.3, 5.4, 8.5, 8.9, 10.3
Hamburg, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1529	5, pp. 513–514, 528	1960	as Braunschweig	4.3, 5.4
Lübeck, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1531	5, p. 362	1949	the four times: Easter, Whitsun, Michaelmas, Christmas	9.1
Hamburg, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1556	5, p. 551	1963	figural music on the chiefest feasts	10.5
Ritzebüttel, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1556	5, p. 559	1963	whole-day holy days; half days until noon	6.2
Lauenburg, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1585	5, p. 421	1953	"hohe vierzeiten feste"	9.3
Mecklenburg, <i>Orderinge der misse</i> , 1545	5, p. 151	1922	German <i>Kyrie summum</i>	3.2

Order	Sehling	Doc	Ranking	§
Mecklenburg, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1552	5, pp. 200–201	1922	high chief feasts of Christ; "over these chiefest feasts" apostles, John, Visitation, Michael (forenoon); Michaelmas replaces Assumption as four-times feast	5.2, 8.8
Mecklenburg, <i>Visitations-Instruction</i> , 1557	5, p. 224	1925	Assumption not to be kept; Michaelmas the four-times feast	8.3
Rostock, <i>Conformitas ceremoniarum</i> , c. 1560	5, p. 288	1936	great feasts on Sunday displace the Sunday Gospel; apostles do not	11.1
Mecklenburg, <i>Klosterordnung</i> , 1572	5, p. 258	1926	Athanasian Creed on high feasts	10.8
Hadersleben, <i>Artikel</i> , 1528	23, p. 64	1576	Latin on "groten feste" (<i>summa festa</i>); holy days listed; apostles not kept; Annunciation to Palm eve	3.2, 11.2
Schleswig-Holstein, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1542	23, pp. 90–95	1576	three great feasts three days; feasts of Christ, Assumption, Visitation, John, Michael, All Saints; apostles on Sunday; Latin and sequences on high feasts	4.3, 5.4, 8.5, 10.1, 10.4
Hadersleben, <i>Zuchtordnung</i> , 1573	23, p. 244	1599	no guild feasts on high feasts	10.10
Gottorf, visitation articles, 1587	23, p. 371	1621	preface <i>in summis festis</i>	3.2

Lower Saxony, Westphalia and the Lower Rhine

Order	Sehling	Doc	Ranking	§
Norheim, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1539	6/2, pp. 934–935	2047	"furnemliche feste" for the weak's sake; Corpus Christi kept for civil reasons	4.5, 8.9
Wolfenbüttel, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1543	6/1, pp. 62–63	1972	four times with first-vespers sermon; Stephen, John, John Baptist themes	7.3, 8.6, 9.3
Grubenhagen, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1544	6/2, pp. 1032–1033	2056	four chief feasts (four-times penny); seven "herliche fest"; apostles forenoon	5.5
Hoya, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1571	6/2, pp. 1151, 1186	2065	four high feasts (Michaelmas for Assumption); feasts wholly kept; apostles until the sermon ends; Latin Mass on four-times feasts	5.5, 9.3
Harlingerland, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1573/74	7/1, pp. 735–736	2122	as Hoya, in three <i>Sectiones</i>	5.5, 9.2

Order	Sehling	Doc	Ranking	§
Oldenburg, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1573	7/2.1, pp. 1096–1097	2150	Mecklenburg scheme; Michaelmas as four-times feast; Corpus Christi abolished	8.9, 9.2
Buxtehude, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1552	7/1, p. 74	2082	<i>Gloria</i> in Latin on high feasts	10.1
Buxtehude, <i>Agende</i> , 1565	7/1, p. 123	2082	Kyrie grades <i>in summis festivitibus, minus summum</i>	3.2
Osnabrück (city), <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1543	7/1, p. 259	2099	no special holy days; apostles until noon	6.1
Osnabrück (city), <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1613	7/1, p. 267	2100	whole days (two or three sermons); half days (one sermon)	6.2
Tecklenburg, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1543	22, p. 245	1505	Nürnberg list; Assumption kept as four-times feast "for the working folk"; small feasts: no work during the sermon	6.2, 8.3
Lippe, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1571	21, pp. 391–392	1462	Mecklenburg scheme; proper prefaces only on the four-times feasts	9.2
Goslar, SS. Simon and Jude, Office, 1534	7/2.2, p. 264	2194	ferial, dominical and festal Office	3.4
Bremen, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1561	7/2.2, p. 513	2221	thirteen feasts with Latin first vespers	3.6
Jülich-Cleves-Berg, visitation instruction, 1559	21, p. 87	1425	"vier hochzeitoffer"	9.1

Hesse, the Rhine and the Main

Order	Sehling	Doc	Ranking	§
Hessen, Homberg <i>Reformatio</i> , 1526	8, p. 49	2249	only feasts of the mysteries of redemption, one day each, and the Visitation	4.2
Hessen, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1532	8, p. 75	2252	named saints' days forenoon only	4.5
Hessen, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1566	8, pp. 257– 258	2257	feasts of Christ; Christmas "das fest aller festen"	4.6
Waldeck, <i>Landordnung</i> , 1525	9, p. 179	2300	four high-tide feasts, Marian and apostles' days	9.1
Waldeck, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1556	9, pp. 272– 276	2300	Mecklenburg scheme; Good Friday half; three apostles forenoon; Michaelmas fourth chief feast; three-lesson matins on high feasts	3.3, 6.1, 11.2

Order	Sehling	Doc	Ranking	§
Nassau-Dillenburg, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1537	10, p. 74	169	wide list incl. Corpus Christi, Assumption, Nativity of Mary; harvest feasts to Sunday	5.7, 6.4, 8.9
Nassau-Dillenburg (Reformed), <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1582	10, p. 163	184	Sundays and feasts of Christ only	12
Nassau-Weilburg, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1576, and <i>Agende</i> , 1618	10, p. 228	198	twelve feasts like Sundays; apostles one sermon; 1618: half and whole	6.2
Nassau-Weilburg, visitation recess, 1609	10, p. 352	199	whole days two sermons; third day, John, Visitation, Michael, apostles half	6.2
Ysenburg-Ronneburg, <i>Agende</i> , 1582	10, p. 583	218	day by day: whole, half, forenoon; harvest and market	6.2
Solms-Laubach, <i>Kirchenzuchtordnung</i> , 1603	9, p. 356	2311	whole days; forenoon days; Beheading and Magdalene to weekday sermons	6.2, 8.8
Sayn, <i>Kirchenzuchtordnung</i> , 1582	19/1, pp. 368, 372– 373	1090	four classes: chief, middle (half), transferable, abolished	5.5
Sayn, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1590	19/1, p. 389	1090	one list; harvest apostles forenoon; no transfers	6.4, 11.4
Wied, <i>Synodalbeschlüsse</i> , 1564	19/1, p. 467	1094	<i>ferialiter</i> (whole) and <i>tantum fiet concio</i> (sermon only); patronal feasts	3.5
Leiningen-Hardenburg (Dürkheim), 1584	19/1, pp. 277–278	1076	high feasts whole day; apostles forenoon	6.2
Landau, <i>Feiertagsordnung</i> , 1562	19/1, p. 61	1044	high feasts of Christ whole; all others until noon	6.2
Pfalz-Zweibrücken, <i>Feiertagsordnung</i> , 1561	18, pp. 297–298	973	eight high feasts whole; all others forenoon only	6.2
Pfalz-Veldenz, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1574	18, pp. 518–519	1011	whole and half days; half days as days of prayer	6.2
Kurpfalz (Reformed), <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1563	14, p. 397	504	Christmas, New Year, Easter, Ascension, Whitsun only	12

Upper Germany

Order	Sehling	Doc	Ranking	§
Württemberg, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1536	16, pp. 105– 106	651	high feasts of Christ; other feasts forenoon only	4.4, 5.3

Order	Sehling	Doc	Ranking	§
Württemberg, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1553	16, p. 266	671	holy days proclaimed by the magistrate; one list (two days at the great feasts)	4.5, 5.3
Baden, <i>Kirchenordnungsmandat</i> , 1603	16, p. 559	715	feasts and apostles forenoon <i>simpliciter</i> , field-work after	5.3
Schwäbisch Hall, Brenz, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1527	17/1, p. 53	755	no holy day commanded by God; a civil list; Stephen and John as one day (B)	4.5, 7.3
Schwäbisch Hall, Brenz, sermon, 1527	17/1, p. 78	756	feasts a civil ordinance	4.5
Esslingen, council decrees, 1537	17/2, pp. 389–390	883	all but Sunday and Christmas abolished; apostles' days restored	12
Brandenburg-Nürnberg, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1533	11, p. 204	270	one list; Assumption kept for the peasants, preached as Visitation	8.3
Brandenburg-Ansbach, chapter order, 1533	11, p. 314	276	no saints' octaves or suffrages	3.4
Nürnberg, Veit Dietrich, <i>Agendbüchlein</i> , 1545	11, p. 538	297	Visitation moved to 15 August	6.4
Weißenburg, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1528	11, p. 662	308	wide list; Stephen and John one day	5.7
Hof, <i>Ordo ecclesiasticus</i> , 1592	11, pp. 411, 472, 477	294	Kyrie and <i>Benedicamus</i> grades; vigils; figural music for the chief feasts	3.2, 3.6, 10.5
Lohr (Rieneck), <i>Vesperordnung</i> , 1588	11, p. 699	318	Latin first vespers of high and other feasts	3.6
Nördlingen, <i>Ordnung der ceremonien</i> , 1544	12, pp. 321–322	373	<i>Kyrie summum</i> at Pentecost and Trinity	3.2
Augsburg, <i>Feiertagsordnung</i> , 1537	12, p. 84	339	Sundays, Christmas, Easter, Whitsun, New Year, Ascension, Annunciation only	12
Pfalz-Neuburg, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1543	13, pp. 71, 77–78, 94–95	386	wide list incl. Assumption; others "ungefeiret in gedechtnus"; Scripture-history feasts break the <i>lectio continua</i>	3.3, 4.7, 5.7
Pfalz-Neuburg, Ottheinrich's order, 1547	14, p. 109	473	prefaces <i>solemnis</i> and <i>dominicalis</i>	10.3
Regensburg, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1567	13, pp. 474–475	450	feasts of Christ; apostles; John and Michael; communion only on feasts of Christ	4.7, 5.5, 7.1

Alsace

Order	Sehling	Doc	Ranking	§
Mülhausen, council decree, 1524	20/2, p. 196	1377	four high-tides, Marian and apostles' days; lesser days abolished	12
Mülhausen, opinion on the Basel order, 1529	20/2, pp. 214–215	1382	Sundays, Christmas, Ascension, Easter, Whitsun only	12
Strasbourg, synodal decrees, 1544	20/1, pp. 342–343	1312	only Sunday in the city; countryside half and whole days	12

Transylvania

Order	Sehling	Doc	Ranking	§
Honterus, <i>Reformationsbüchlein</i> , 1543	24, p. 189	1666	feasts kept for their Scripture histories	4.7
Transylvanian Saxons, <i>Kirchenordnung</i> , 1547	24, p. 222	1669	fuller matins and Latin <i>Te Deum</i> on greater feasts	3.3
Burzenland chapter, 1573	24, p. 371	1694	Annunciation moved to Maundy Thursday that year	11.2
Kosd and Schelken, statutes, 1577	24, p. 400	1704	only feasts with Scripture history; no transfers	4.7, 11.4
Mediasch synod, 1578	24, pp. 427–428	1707	apostles' days <i>intercise</i> ; feasts of Christ <i>totaliter</i>	6.4
Burzenland, <i>Visitationsartikel</i> , 1578	24, p. 452	1710	weekday feasts only until noon	6.4